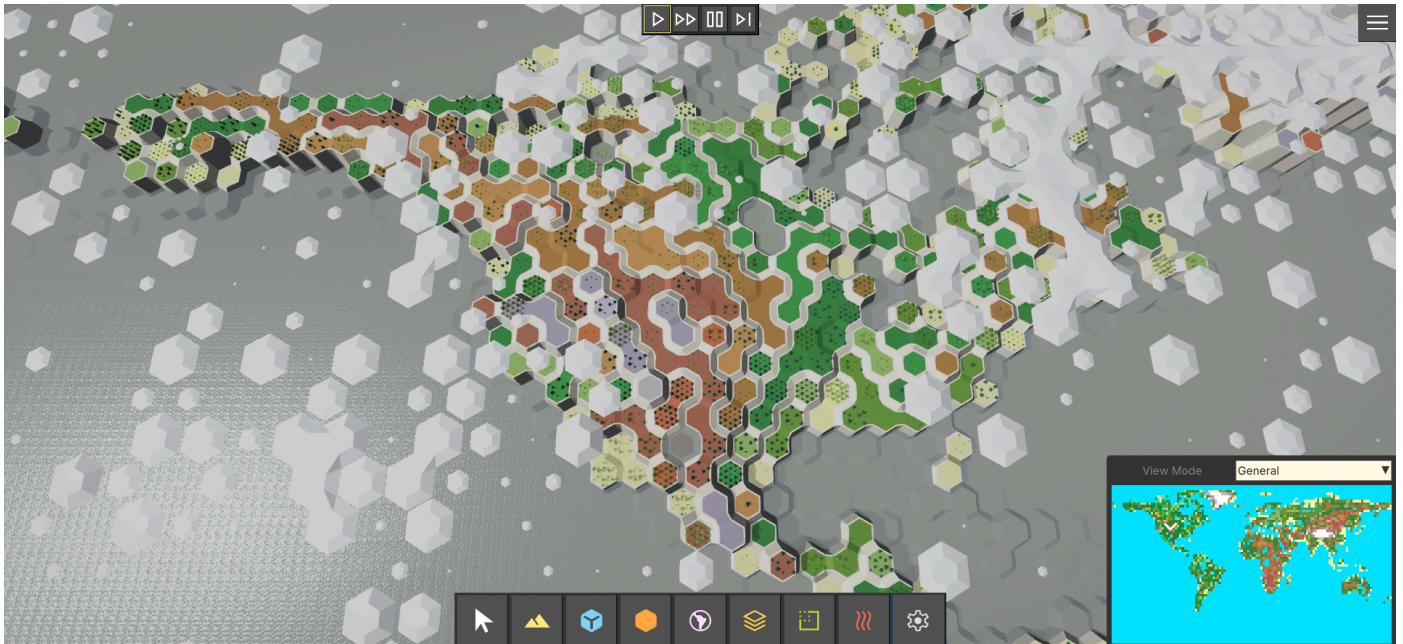
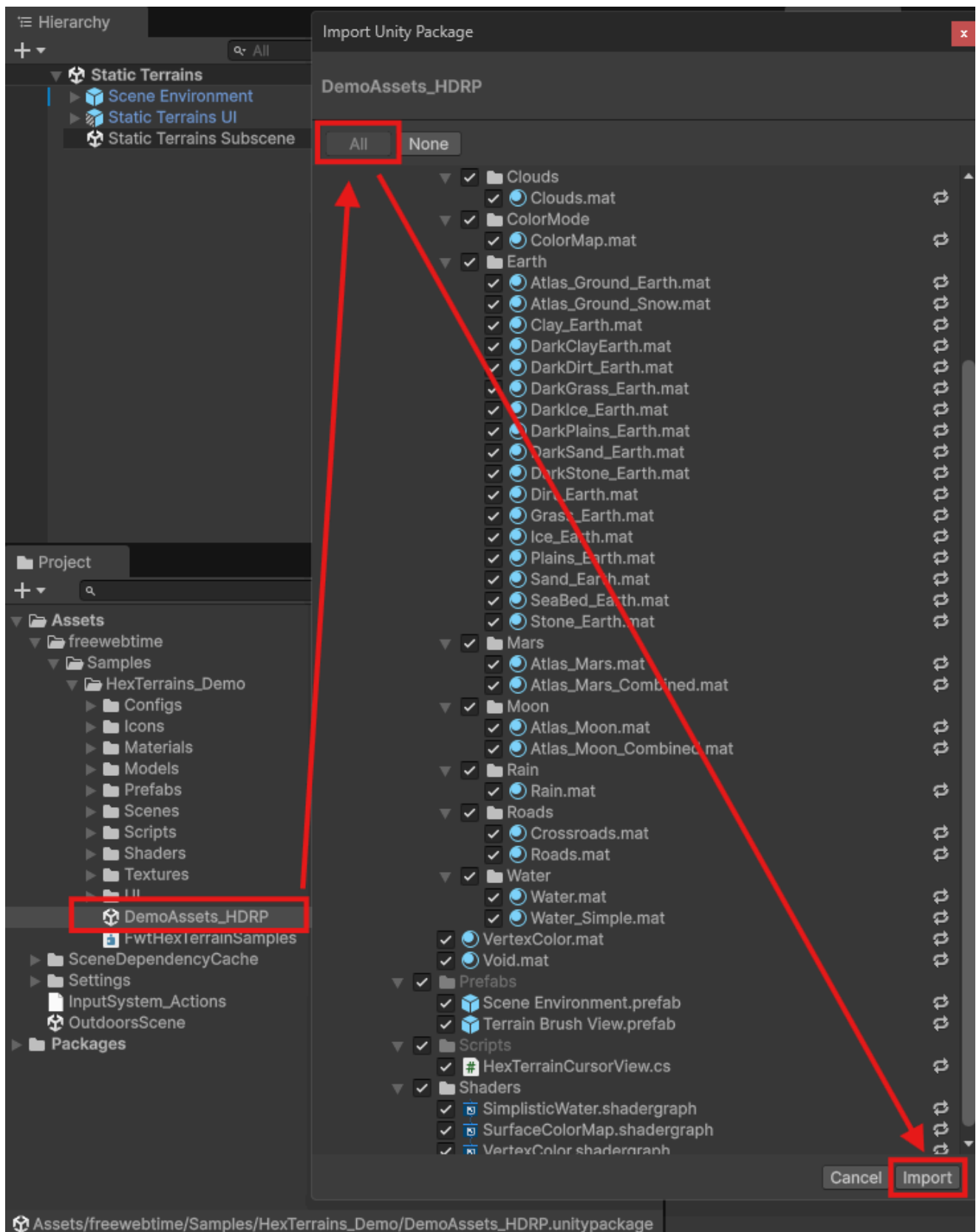


Getting Started

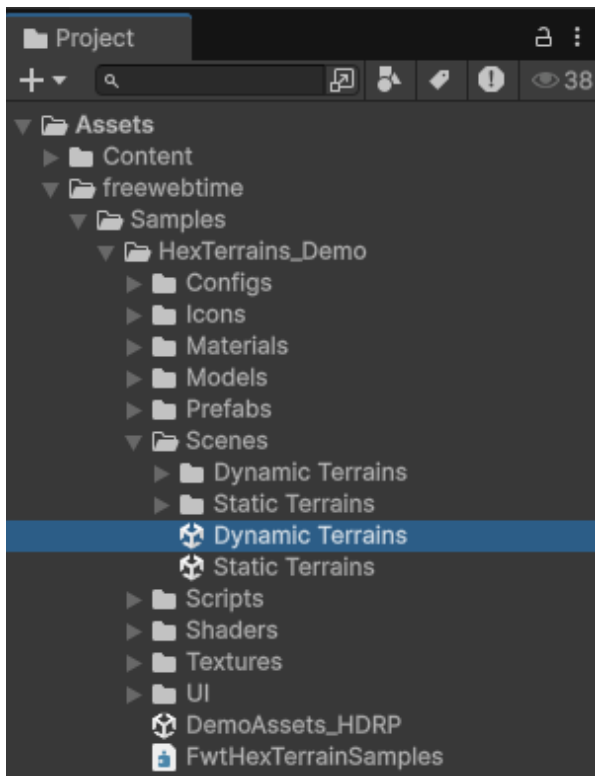


Demo Scenes

1. Install package from asset store.
2. If you use a Universal Render Pipeline, you are good to go. But if you use a High Definition Render Pipeline, extract HDRP assets from included DemoAssets_HDRP.unitypackage (Assets/freewebtime/Samples/HexTerrains_Demo/DemoAssets_HDRP.unitypackage). Double click on the DemoAssets_HDRP.unitypackage, in the popup ensure that all assets are selected and press "Import" button. This will overwrite URP assets with HDRP ones in your demo scenes.



3. Navigate to folder Assets/freewebtime/Samples/HexTerrains_Demo/Scenes
4. Open Static Terrains scene or Dynamic Terrains scene



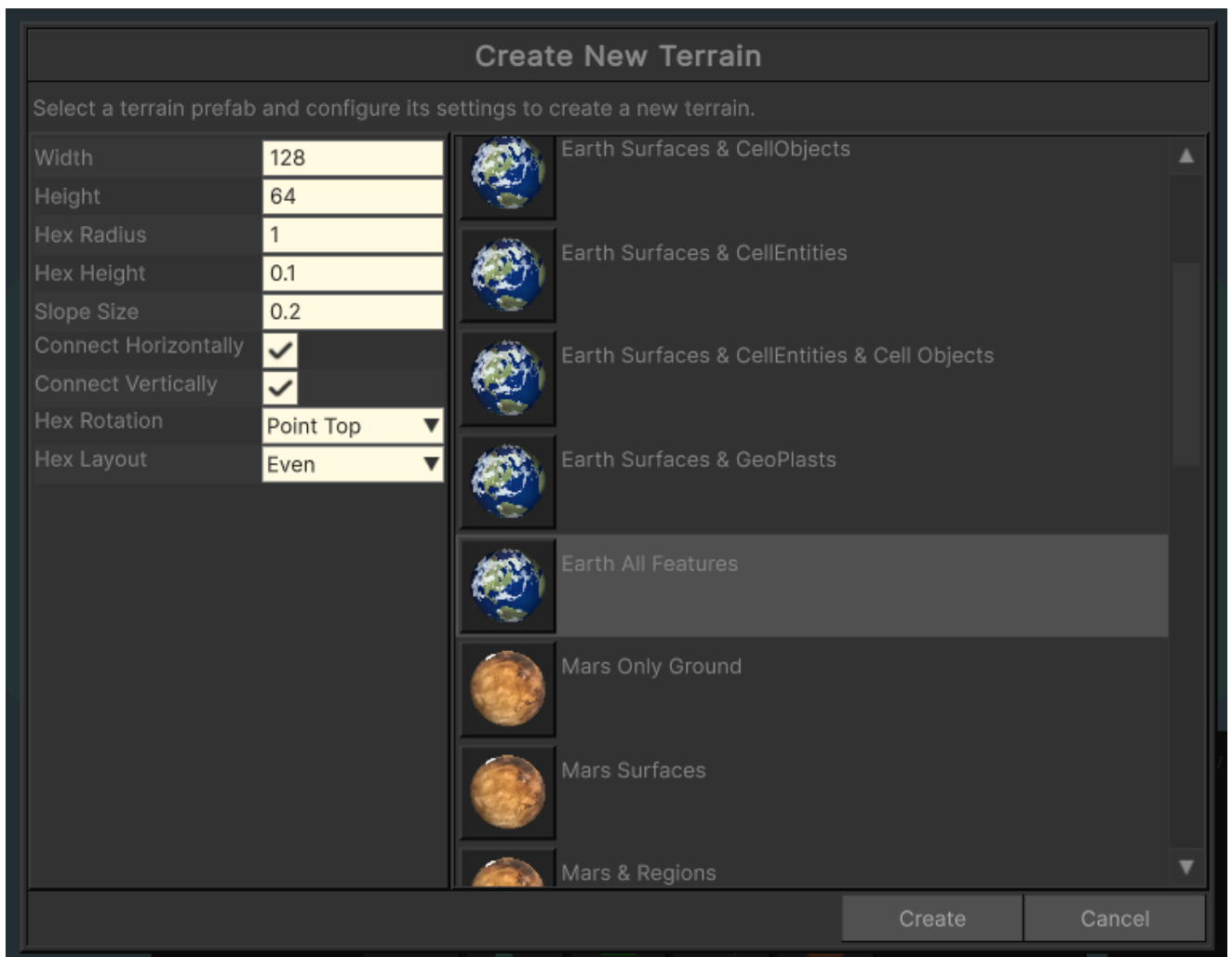
5. Press "Play" button



6. To create another terrain, select "System" User Tool category, then "Create New"



7. In opened window select a terrain prefab and put the settings you want.



8. Press "Create" button

9. Enjoy!



In-game terrain editor

1. In-game editor is a State Machine called (see class `UserToolStateMachine`). State Machine has a set of User Tool States like Deform Terrain, Paint Biomes, Paint Cell Items, Paint Countries, etc. Every `UserToolState` communicates with a Terrain using a proxy implementation of the `ITerrainAPI` (see `HexTerrainAPI` class).
2. All User Tools are split between a set of categories:

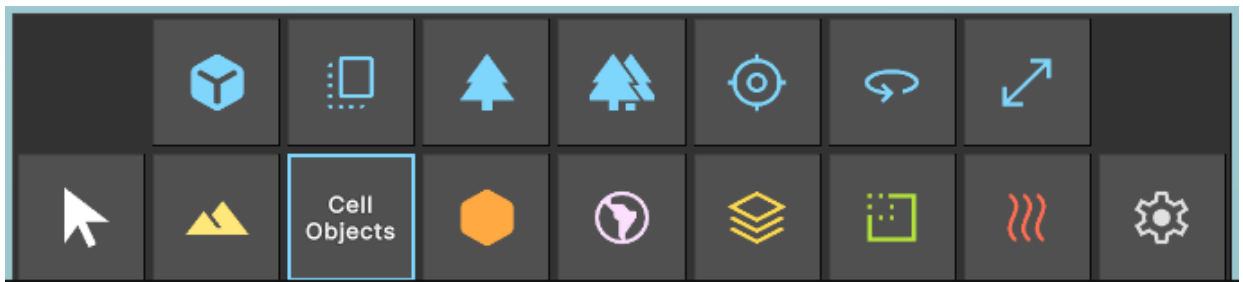
- Surfaces Tools

(Deform, Level, Noise, Smooth, Apply Heightmap, Paint Biome, Auto-paint Biome, Stamp Height, Stamp Biome, Set Layer Visibility)



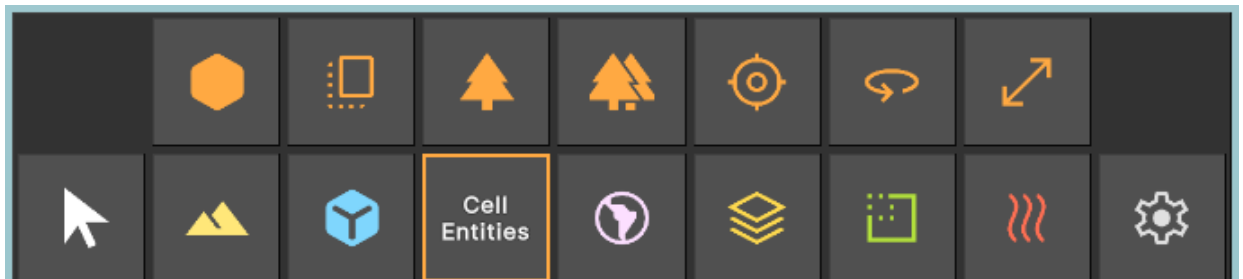
- Cell Objects

(Paint Cell Object, Stamp Cell Object, Cell Object Index, Cell Object State, Cell Object Position, Cell Object Rotation, Cell Object Scale)



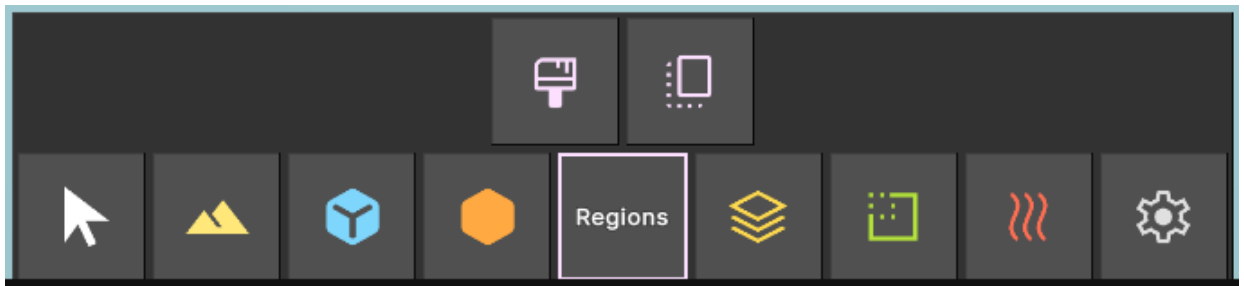
- Cell Entities

(Paint Cell Entity, Stamp Cell Entity, Cell Entity Index, Cell Entity State, Cell Entity Position, Cell Entity Rotation, Cell Entity Scale)



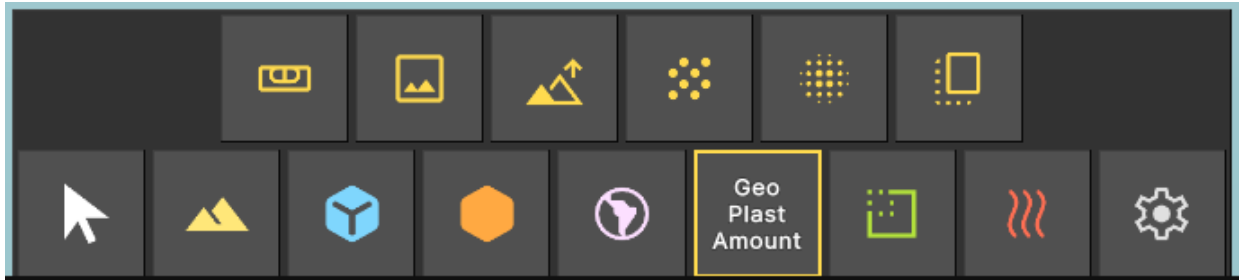
- Cell Regions

(Paint Regions, Stamp Regions)



- GeoPlast Amount Tools

(Level, Apply Heightmap, Deform, Noise, Smooth, Stamp)



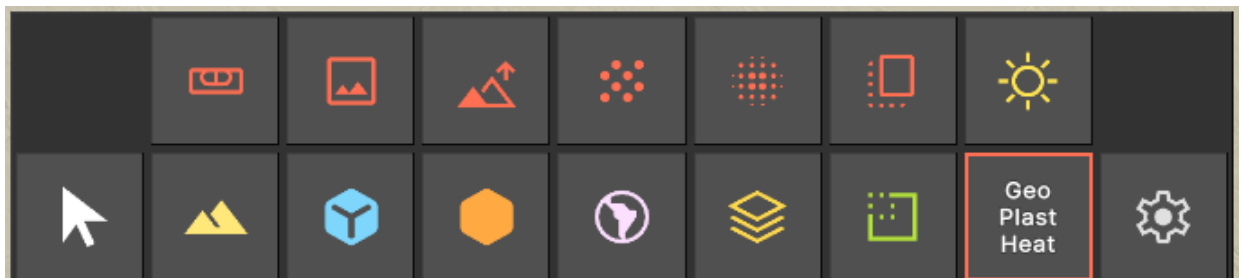
- GeoPlast Density Tools

(Level, Apply Heightmap, Deform, Noise, Smooth, Stamp)



- GeoPlast Heat Tools

(Level, Apply Heightmap, Deform, Noise, Smooth, Stamp, Sun)



- System Tools

(Toggle Visibility, Resize Terrain, Save Terrain, Load Terrain, Create New)



View Modes

How to change the View Mode

To change a view mode, click on "View Mode" dropdown and select an option you want.

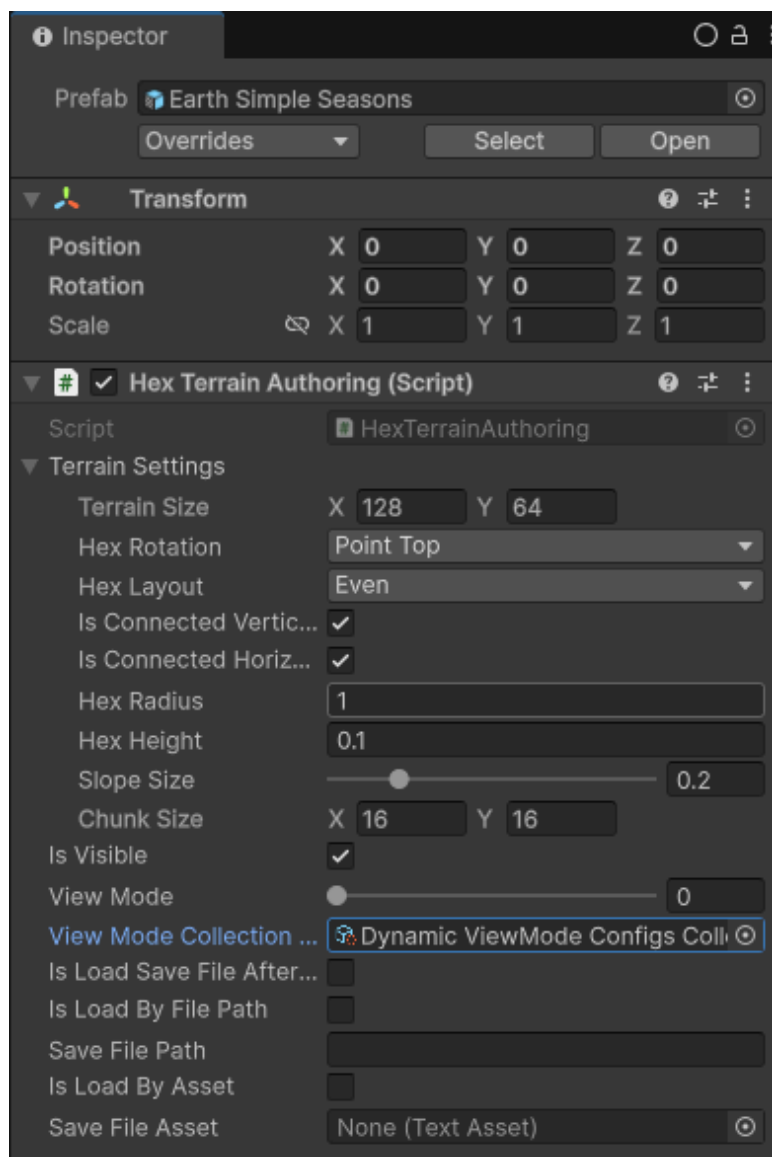


Hex Terrain supports rendering in a different view modes. View mode is a number, the value of the `HexTerrainViewMode` component on a Terrain Entity.

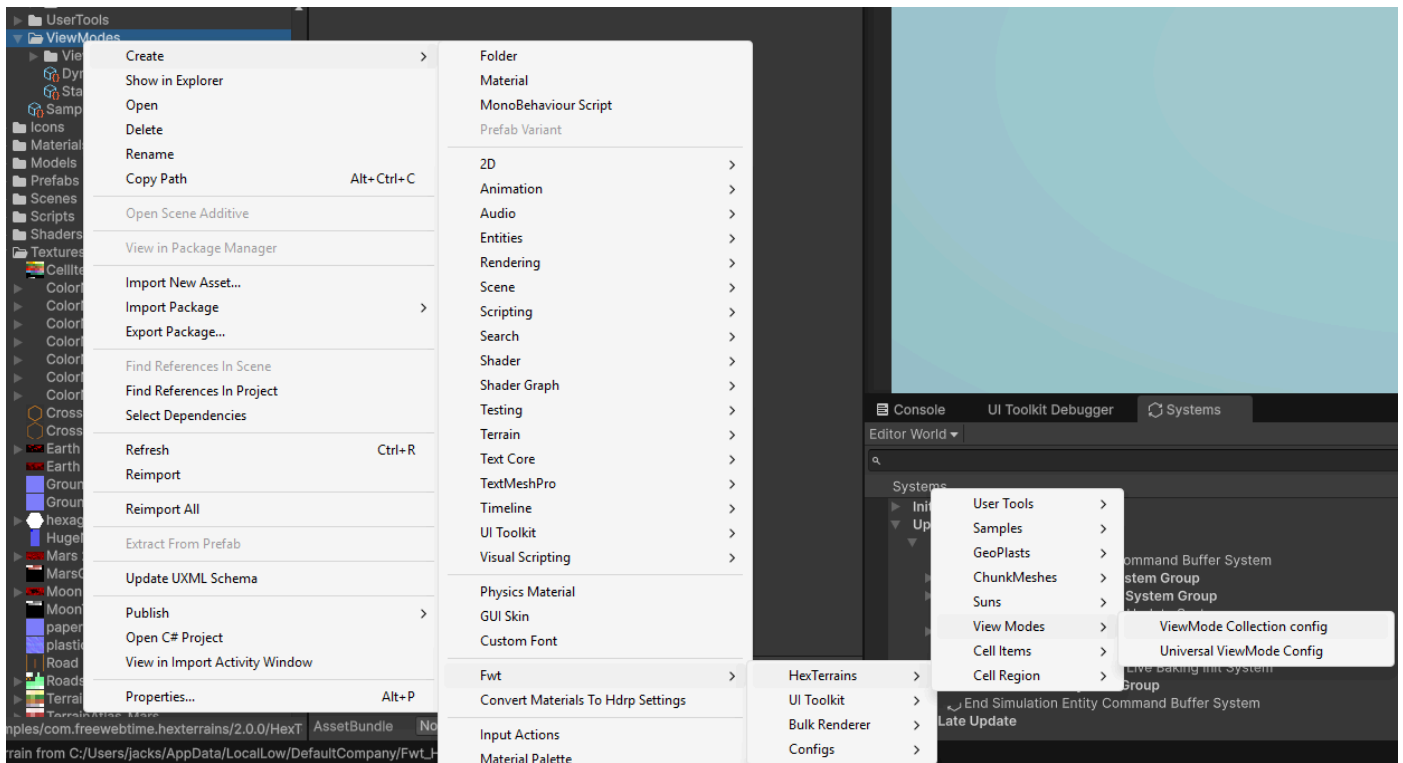
```
/// <summary>
/// Contains the current view mode of the terrain.
/// </summary>
public struct HexTerrainViewMode : IComponentData
{
    /// <summary>
    /// The current view mode of the terrain.
    /// </summary>
    public int Value;
}
```

Take a look at the Terrain Prefab. The Hex Terrain Authoring component has a `View Mode Collection Config` field.

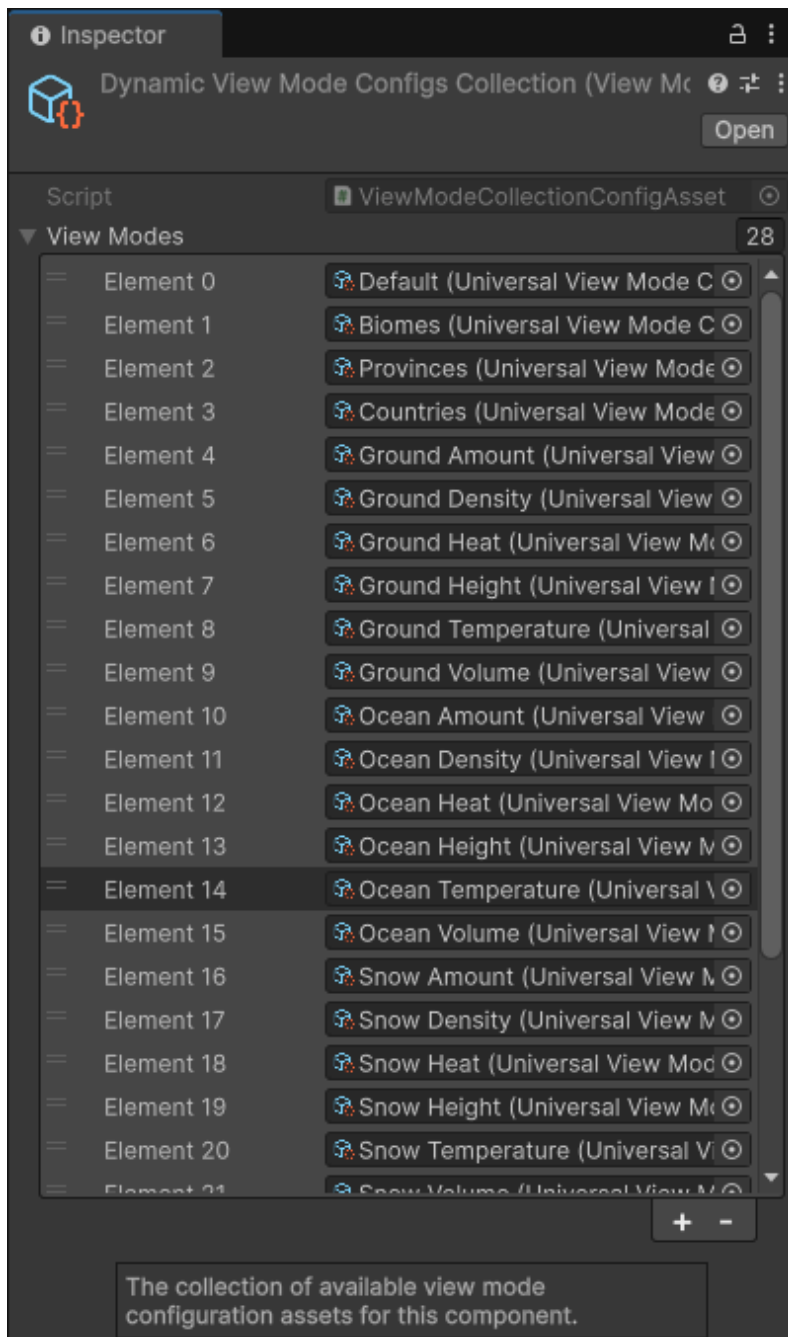
How to Setup View Modes



View Mode Collection Config is a scriptable object that can be created by selecting Create/Fwt/HexTerrains/View Modes/ViewMode Collection config



The asset holds a collection of View Mode configs. You may want to have different collections of View Modes for different terrains:



There are several built-in view modes already, but it's very easy to expand the list. Here are few examples:

- Default View Mode (Regular terrain view)



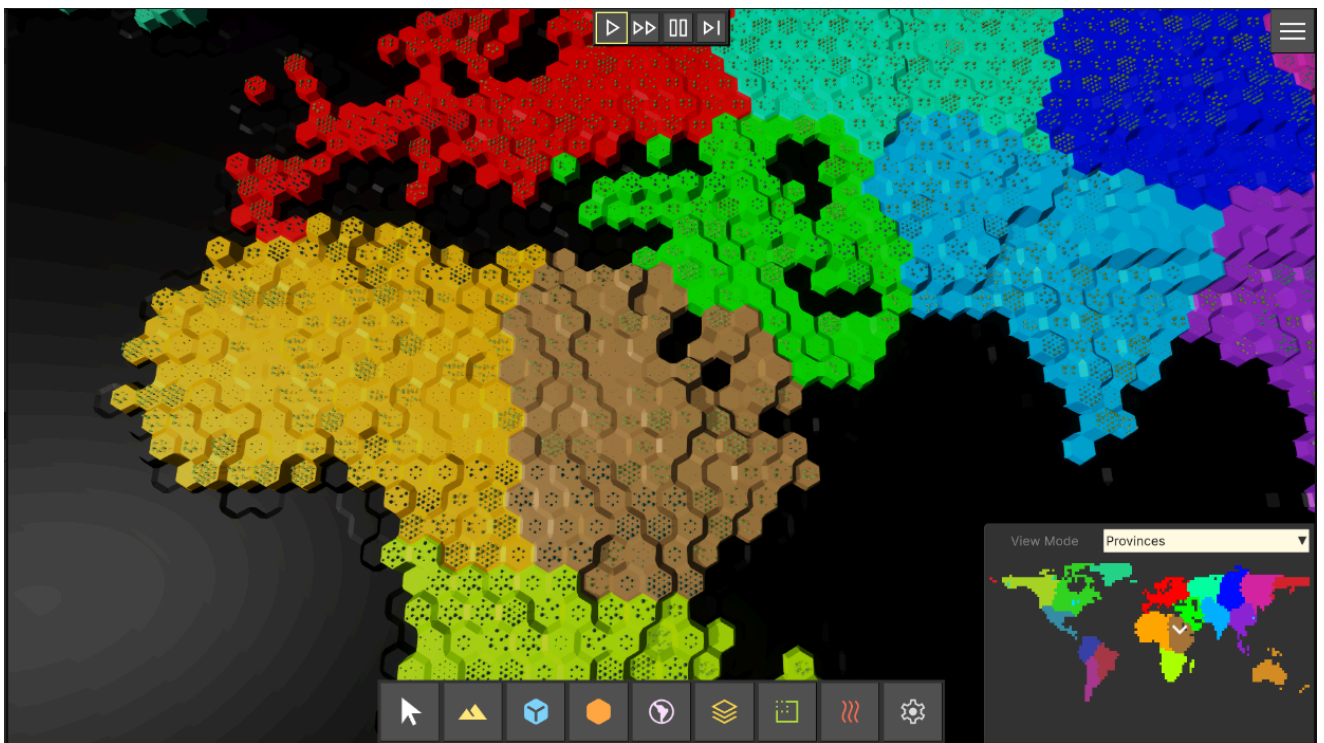
- Biomes View Mode



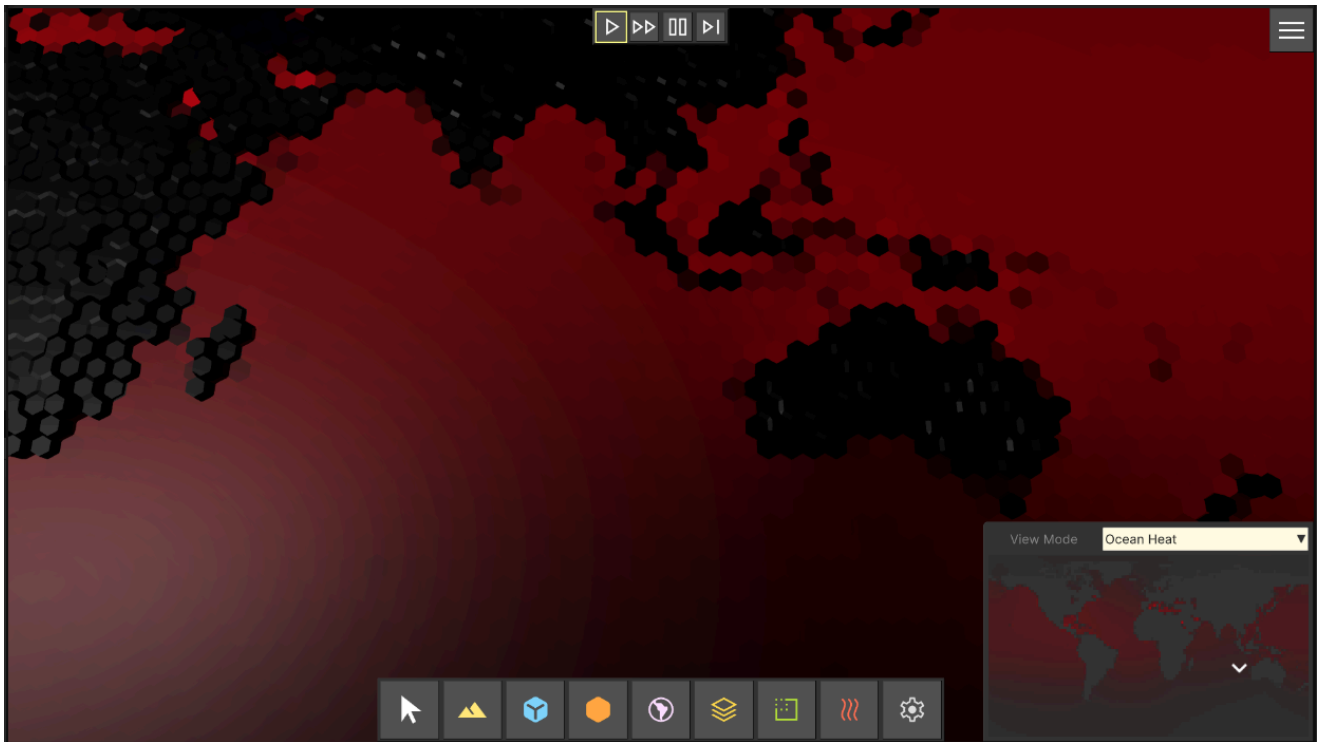
- Heighmap View Mode



- Provinces View Mode



- Ocean Heat View Mode

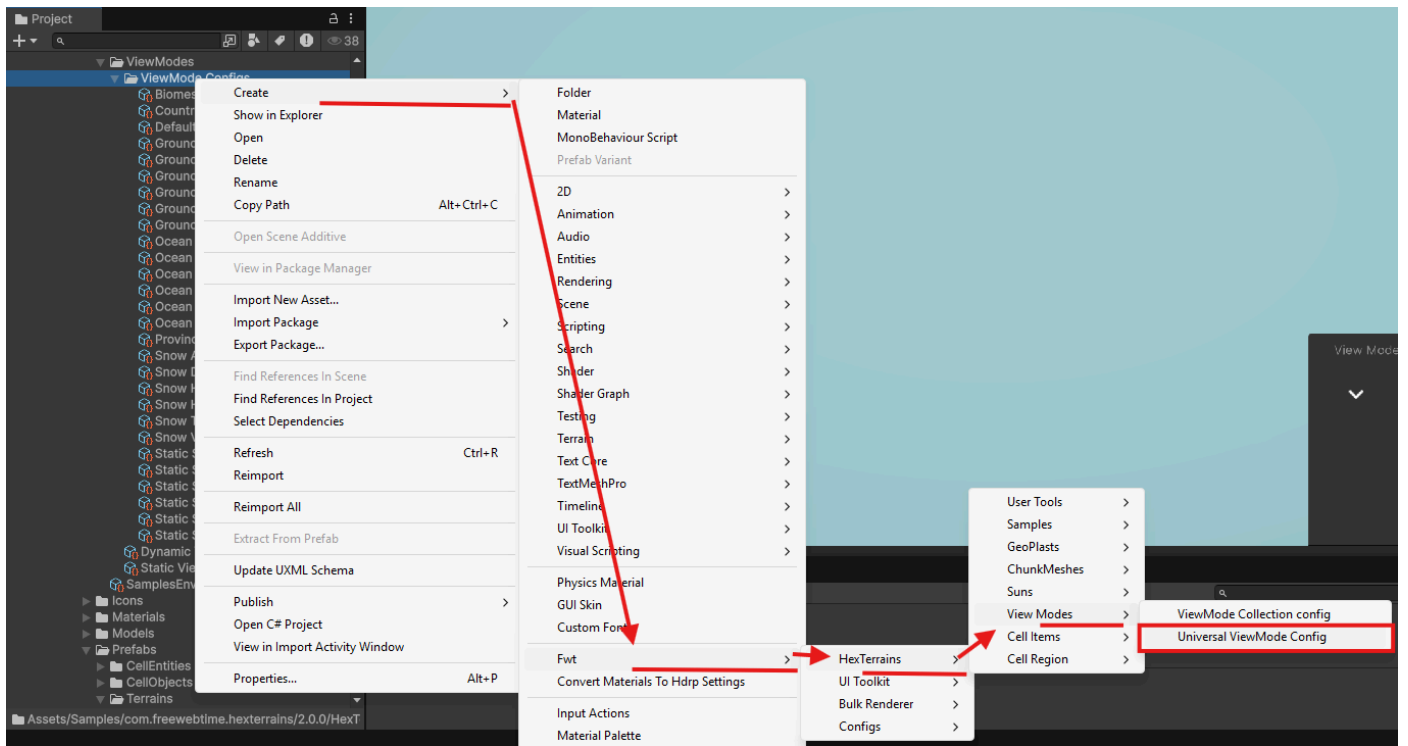


- Ocean Temperature View Mode

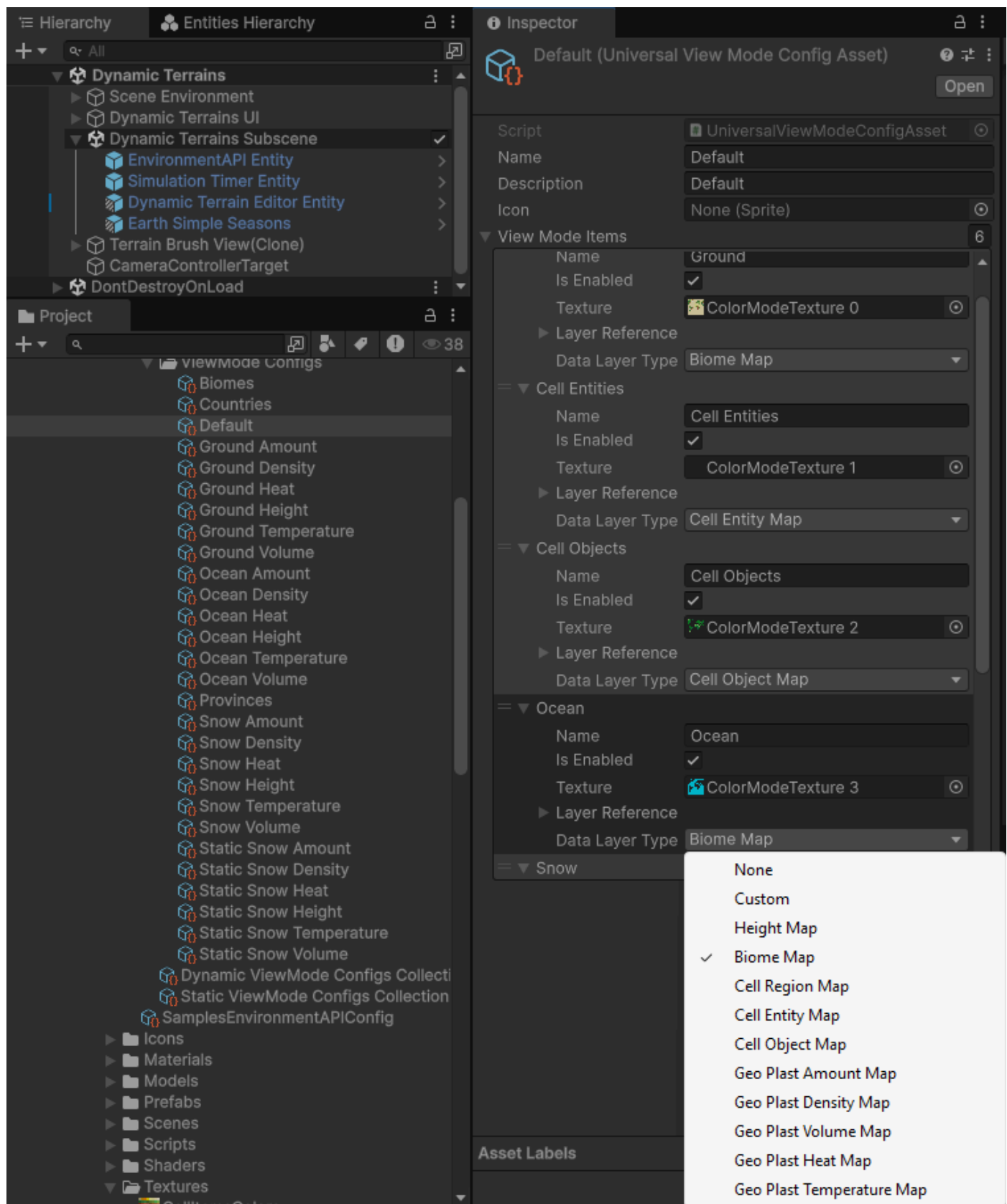


- And others (see "Assets/Samples/com.freewebtime.hexterrains/2.0.0/HexTerrains_Demo/Configs/ViewModes" folder)

To setup a ViewMode, create a new ViewMode asset scriptable object:



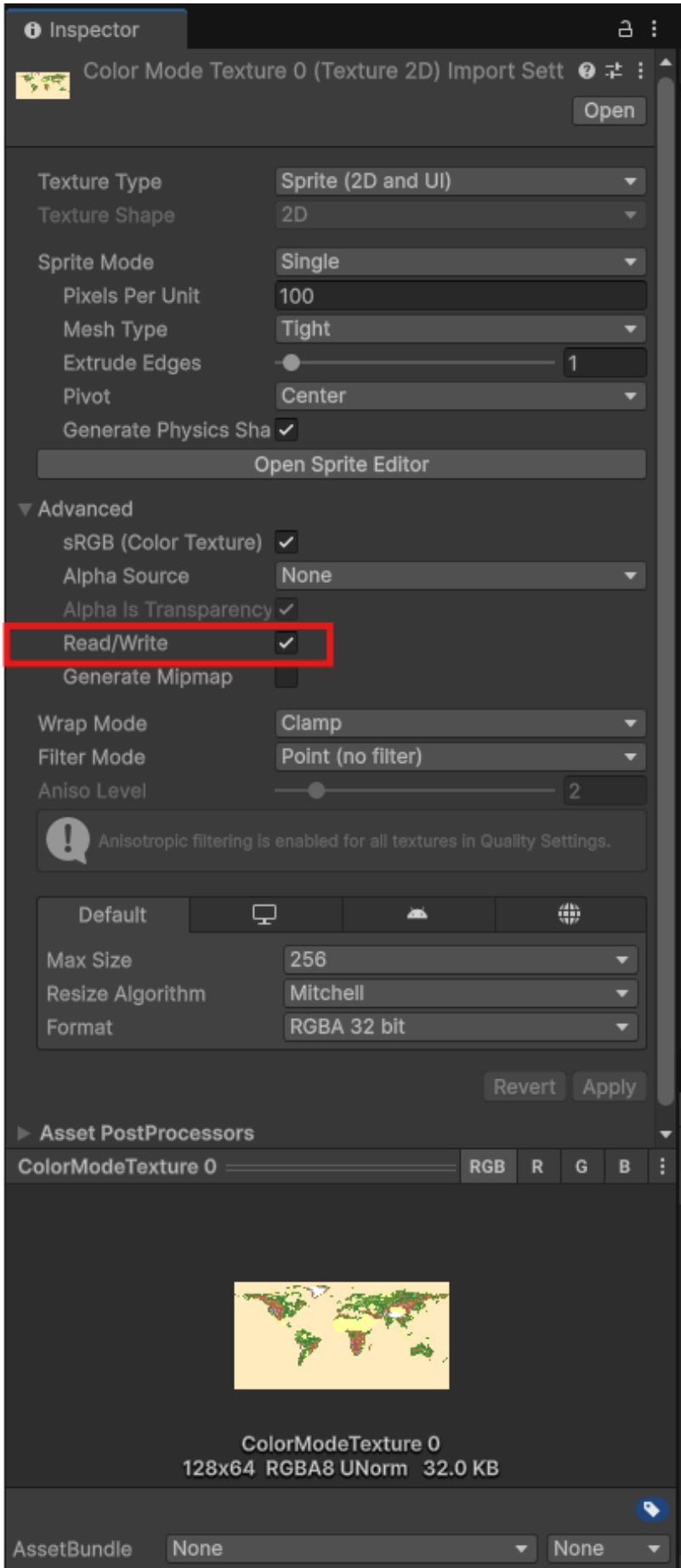
Configure the ViewMode asset:



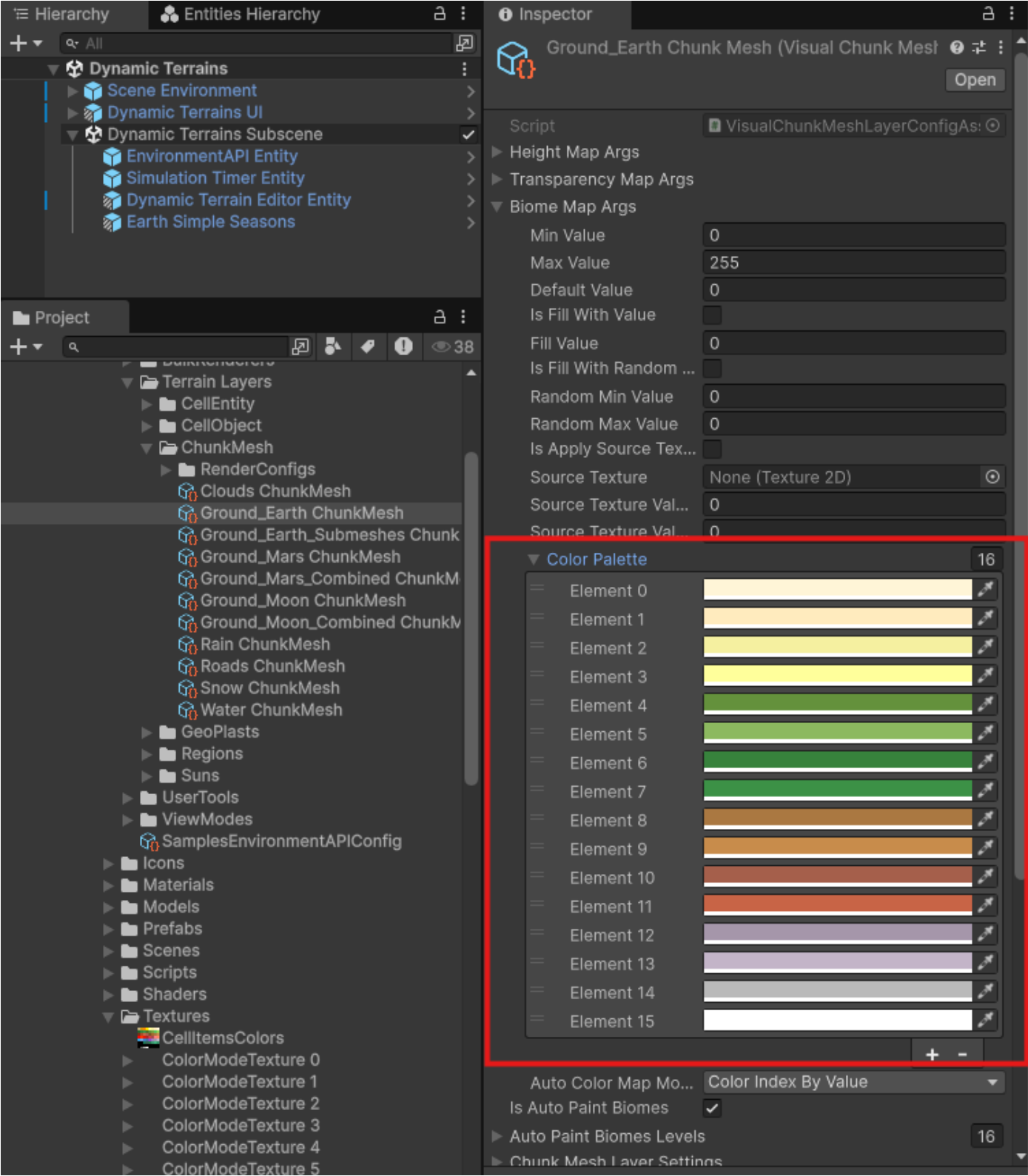
Add as much ColorMap layers as you need, and set which data should be displayed on each of them, and from which terrain layer to get the data.

For example, there is a "Default" View Mode that fills 6 textures with color data: Ground Biome, Cell Entities, Cell Objects, Ocean Biomes, Snow Biomes, Clouds Biomes. All 6 textures are filled with colors from respective data layers and then are sent to the Minimap UI where are displayed together one on top of another. See

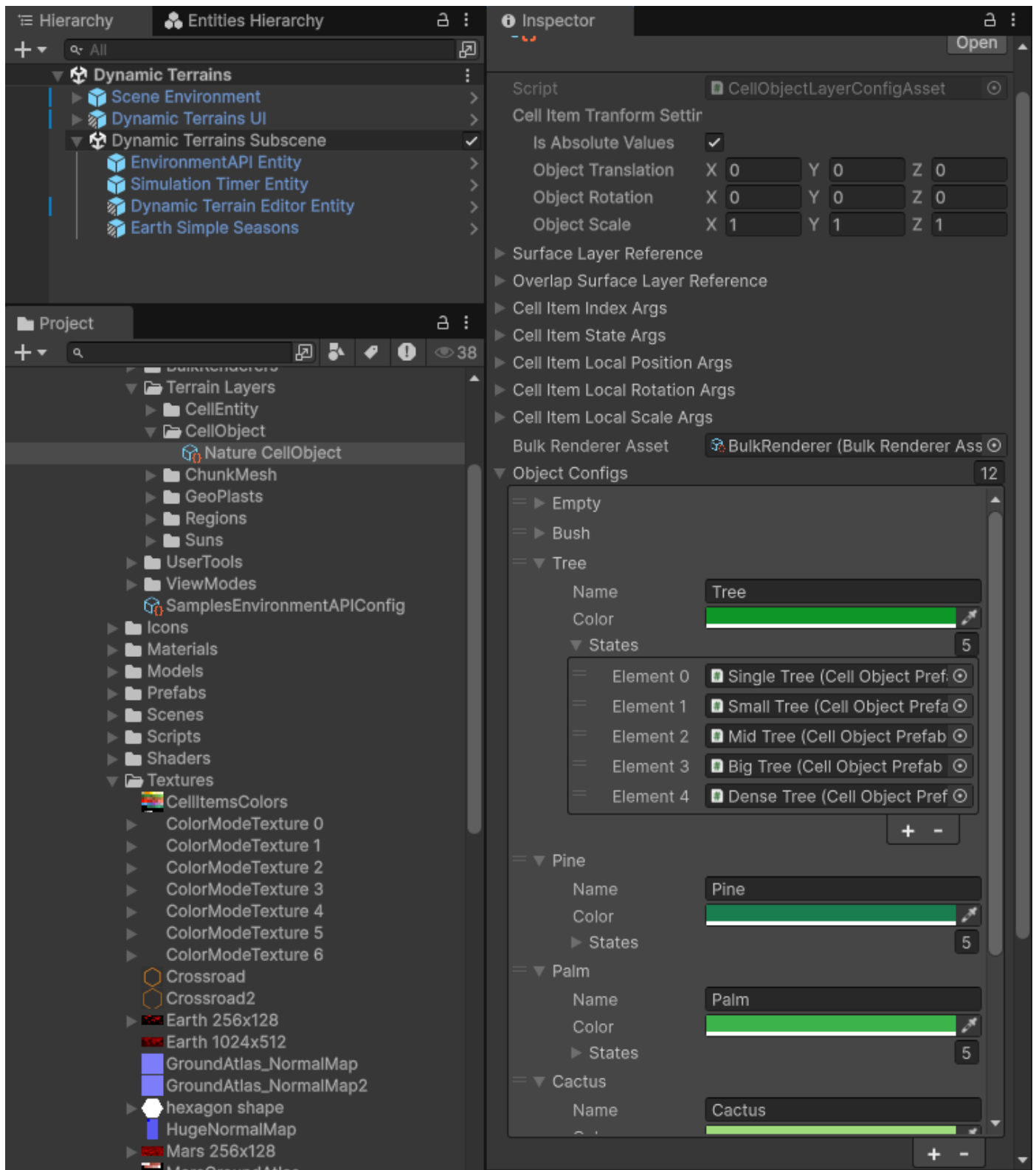
preconfigured ViewMode configs for more details. Note that textures that are filled with colors should have Read/Write option enabled in the texture import settings:



Most of data layers support a color map (they have a color map NativeArray and they fill a corresponding pixel with a color that represents the current cell value). For example, the ChunkMesh has a BiomeMap data layer and each biome has it's own color:

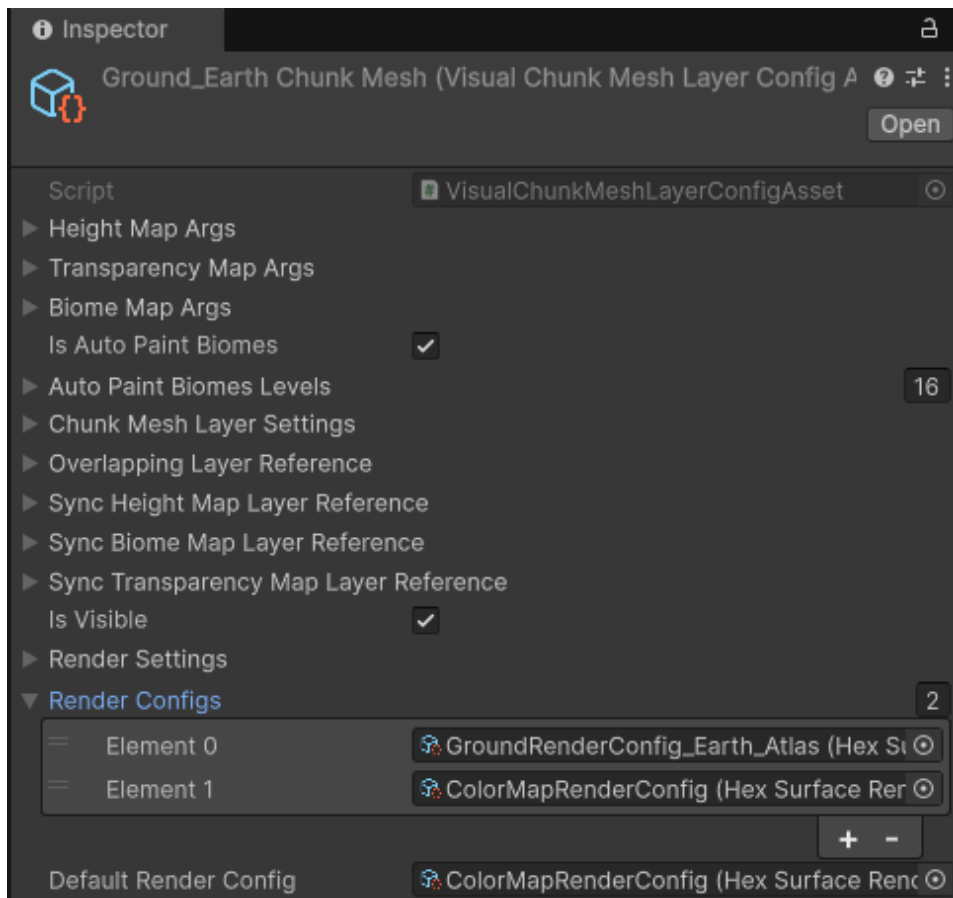


or, for example, the Color setup for each Cell Object:

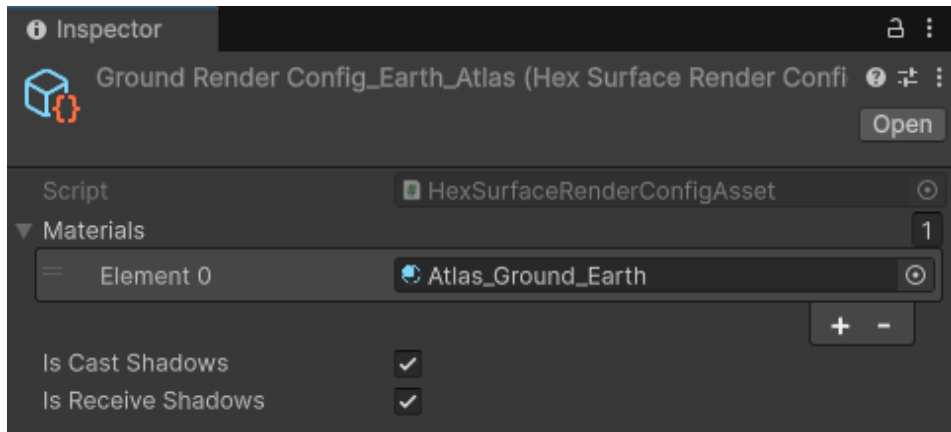
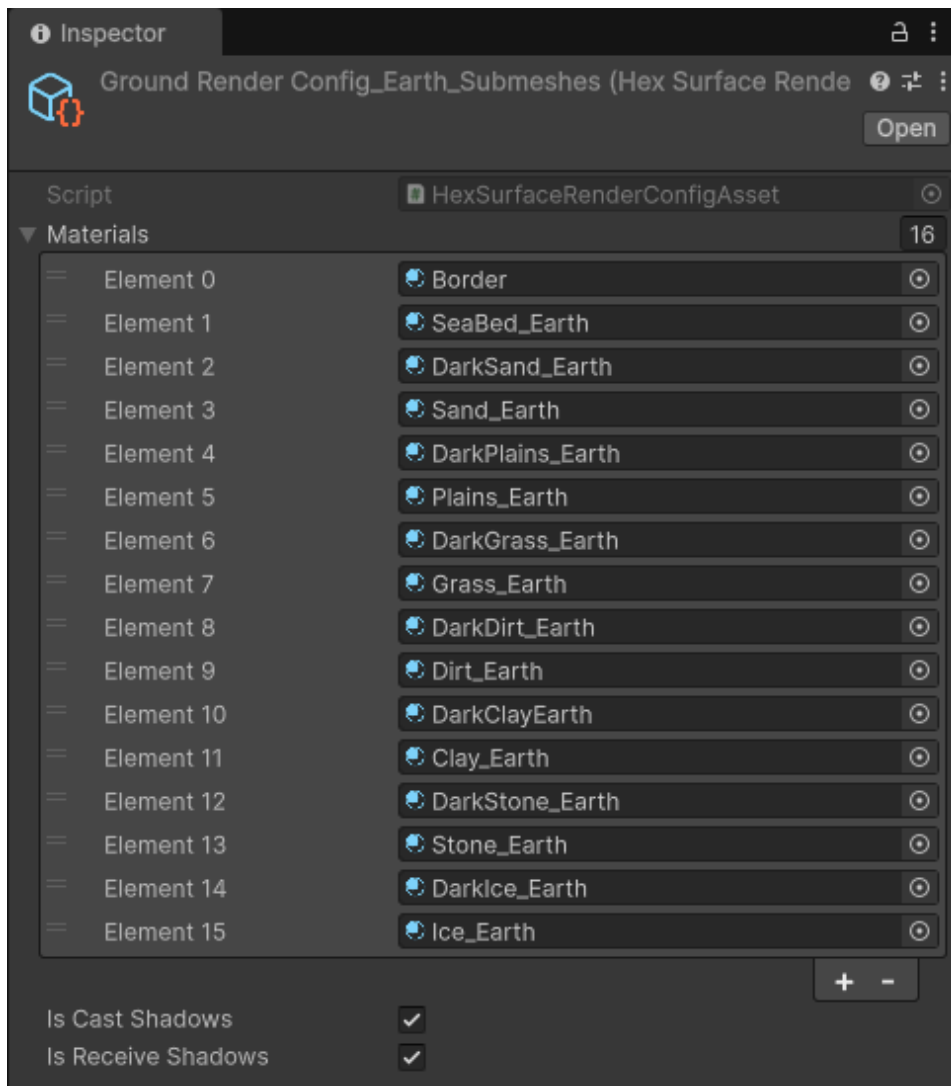


Terrain materials by View Mode

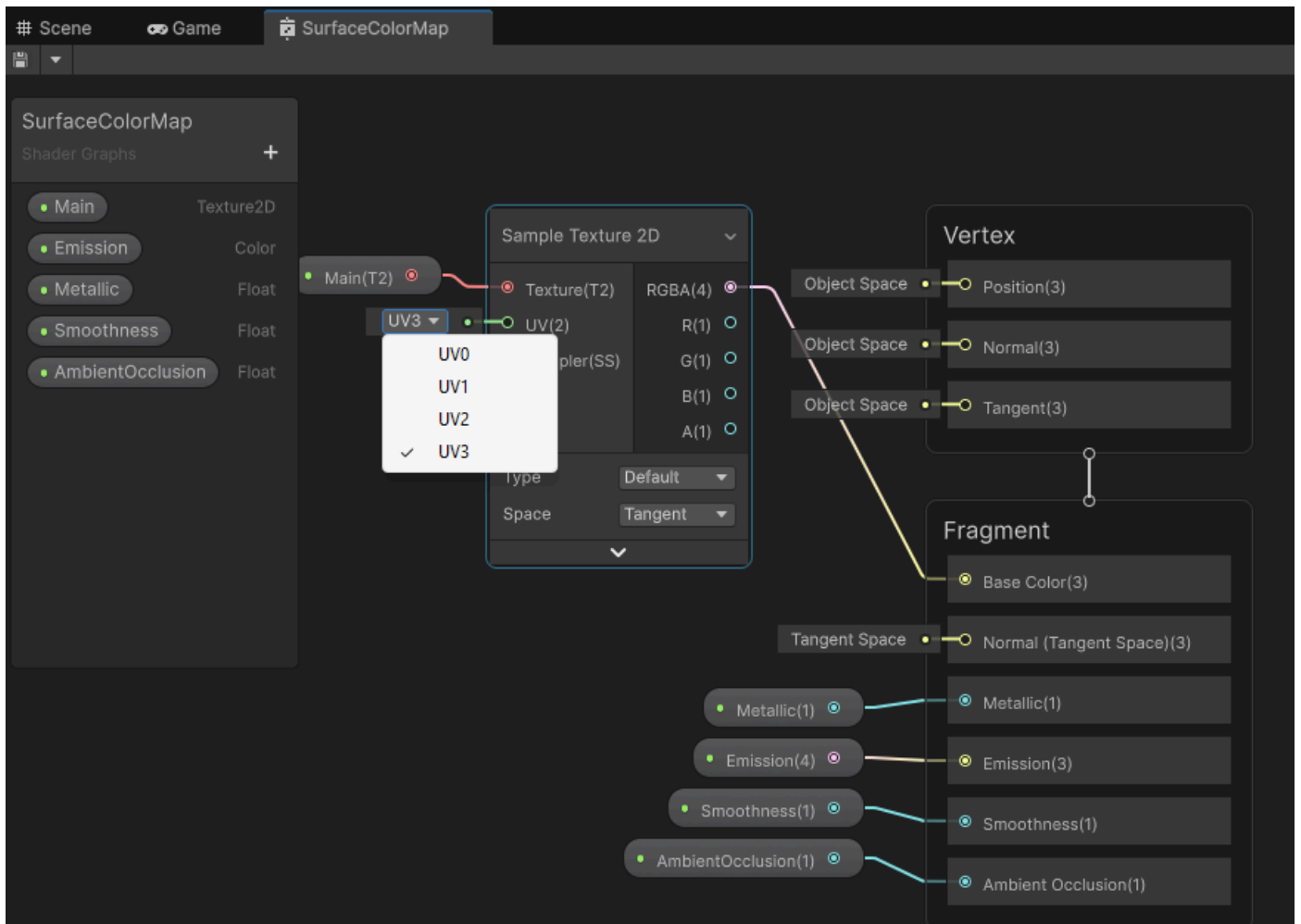
Take a look at configuration of one of your ChunkMesh Layer configs. For example, the Earth Ground Chunk Mesh Layer (Assets/freewebtime/Samples/HexTerrains_Demo/Configs/Terrain Layers/ChunkMesh/Ground_Earth ChunkMesh). You can see a Render Configs list and a Default Render Config . When ViewMode is 0, the ChunkMesh layer is rendered with RenderConfigs[0] , when ViewMode is 1, it uses RenderConfigs[1] , and so on. If there is no Render Config at index of a View Mode, the layer is rendered with Default Render Config . This way you can setup different looks in different View Modes.

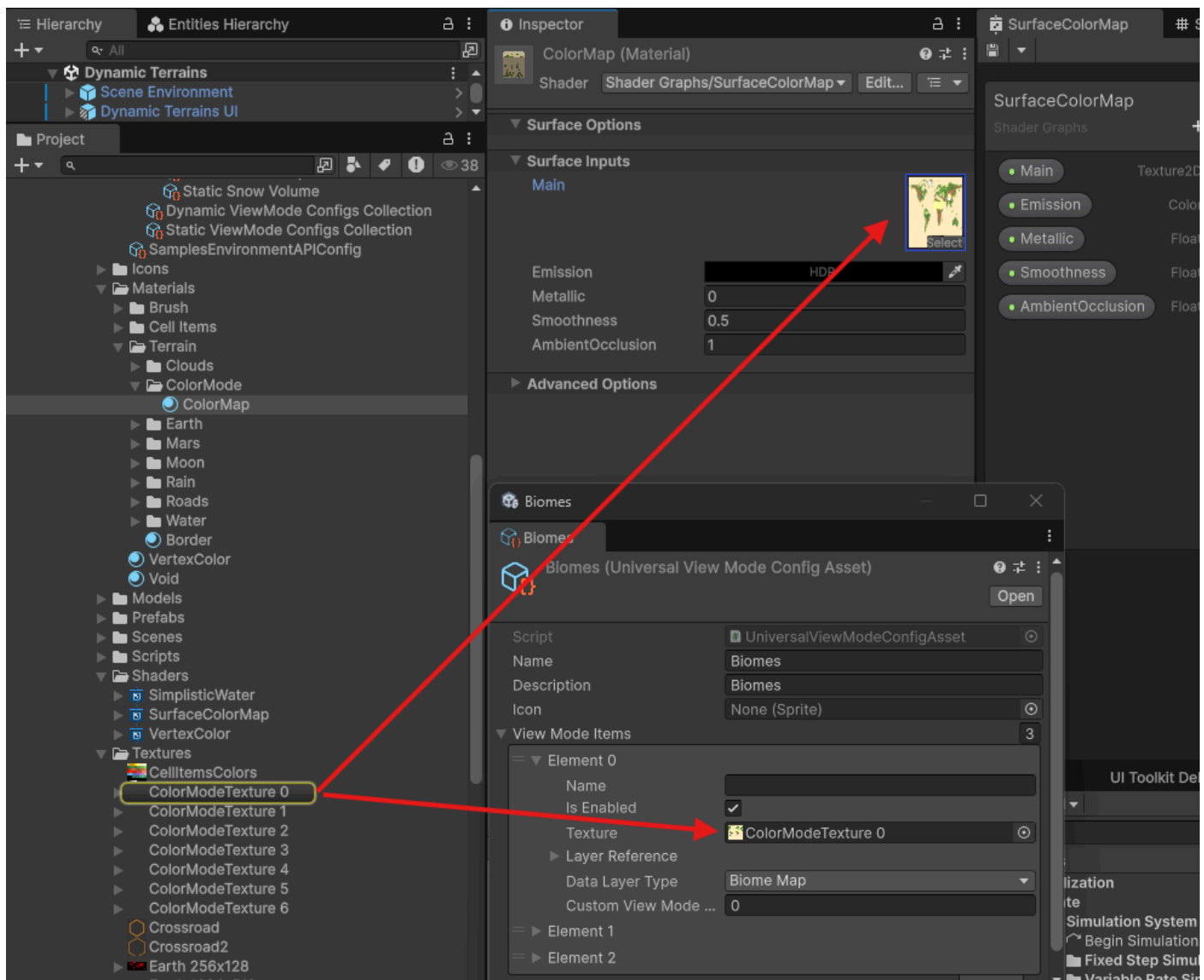


Render Config is a collection of Materials to be used for a generated Terrain Chunk Mesh (one material per submesh):



If you want to render a color map data on a terrain directly (the colors from Minimap on a terrain surface), in a terrain material for a specific ViewMode use the same texture that is used on Minimap UI, and make a material that uses UV3 (fourth UV set):

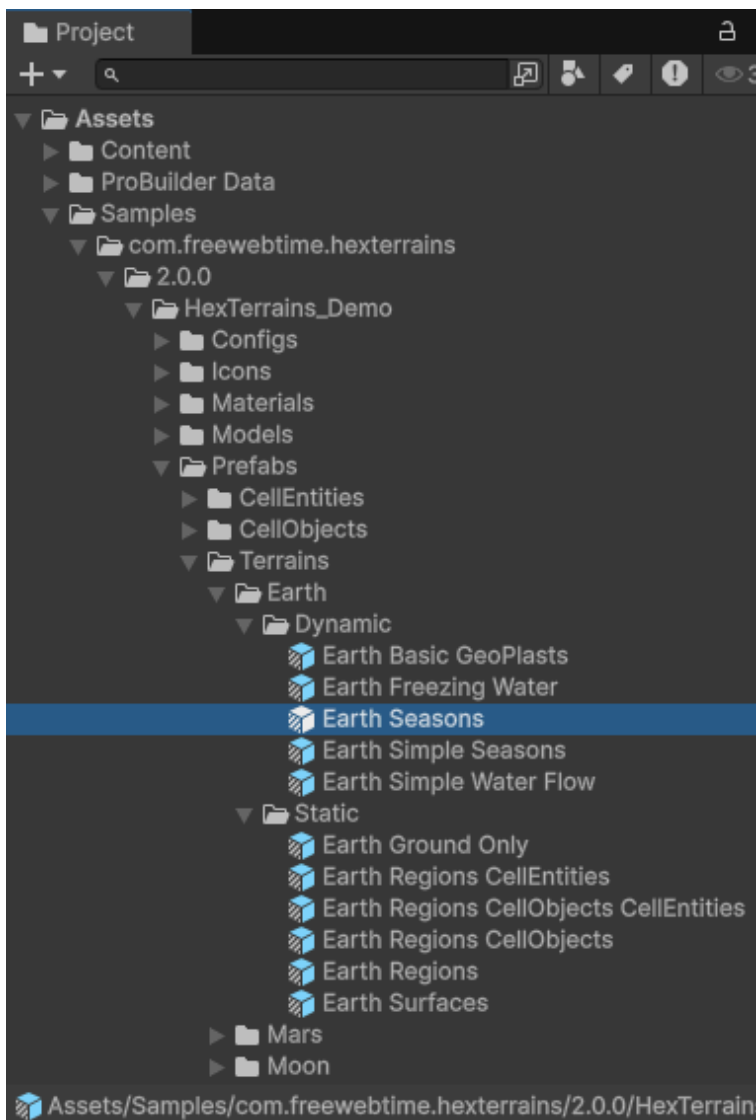




Create terrain on scene load

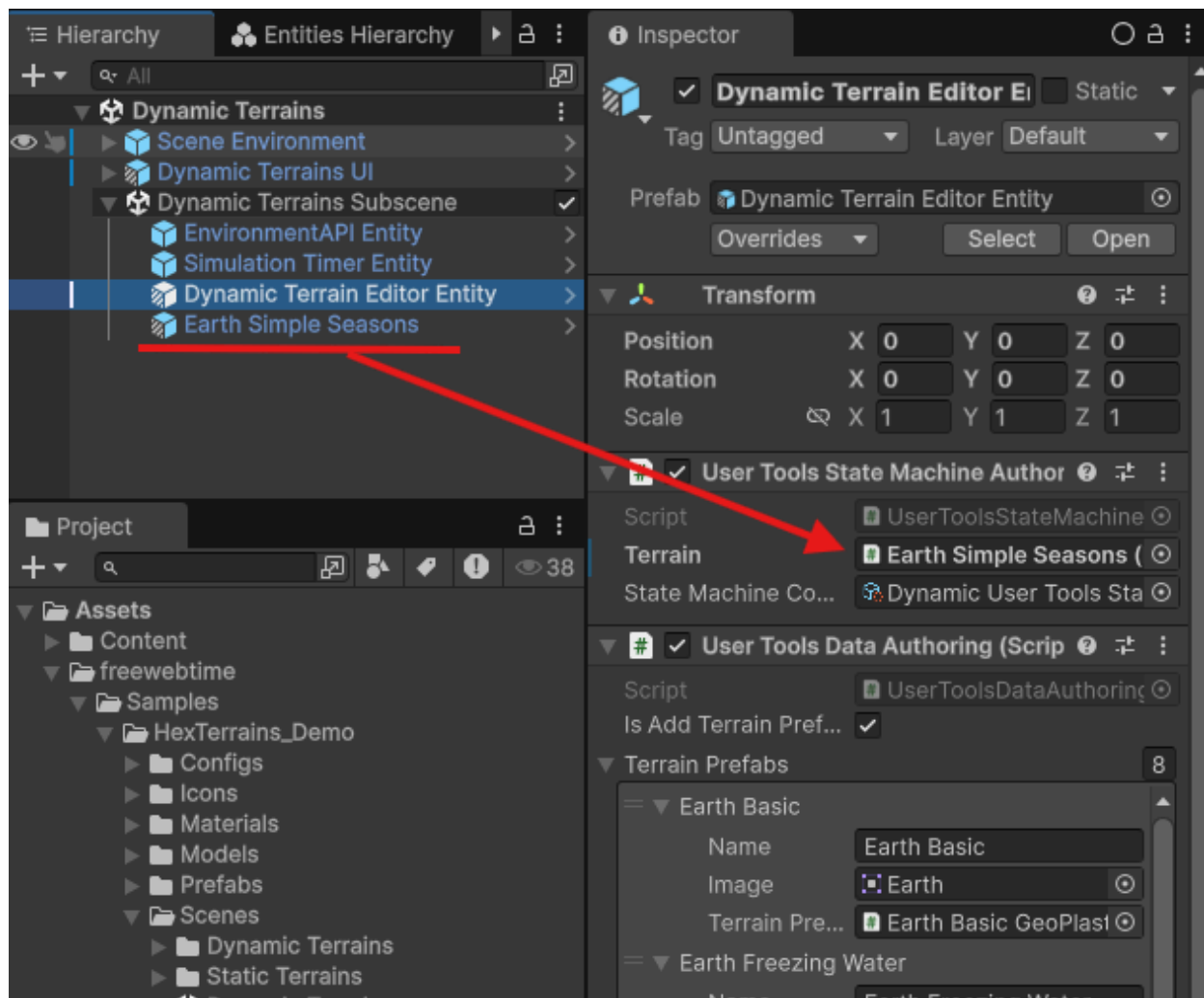
If you want to have a terrain loaded at scene load, just put on the subscene a terrain prefab. If you have a `HexTerrainEditor` prefab on the scene, set a reference to the terrain prefab in the `User Tools State Machine` `Authoring` script in the field `Terrain`.

You can find Terrain prefabs in the Samples folder by path "HexTerrains_Demo/Prefabs/Prefabs"



Put a prefab you want on the subscene. Now the terrain will be baked and appear on a scene in Play mode.

If you have a Terrain Editor on the subscene, set it a reference to the terrain authoring game object.



Note: if you don't set a reference to the terrain on the HexTerrainEditor, you will not be able to edit a terrain using the User Tools Panel at the bottom center of the screen.

Note: HexTerrainEditor prefab is optional. It is needed for having the User Tools Panel to be created. For your gameplay it might not be needed, so feel free to get rid of it.

How to interact with a Terrain

1. To see how it's done, take a look at interface `IThexTerrainAPI` and it's example implementation `HexTerrainAPI` class:

```

/// <summary>
/// Provides a comprehensive interface for interacting with hexagonal terrain systems, enabling access to terrain
/// entities, layers, settings, and related UI and environment functionality.
/// </summary>
/// <remarks>The IHexTerrainAPI interface exposes methods and properties for managing and querying various
/// aspects of a hex terrain, including cell data, terrain layers, brush controls, visibility, and persistence. It
/// supports advanced operations such as layer manipulation, raycasting, prefab configuration, and UI screen
/// management. Implementations should ensure thread safety and proper initialization of terrain entities and layers
/// before use. This interface is intended for use in applications that require dynamic and granular control over
/// hex terrain features, such as editors or simulation tools.</remarks>
public interface IHexTerrainAPI
{
    ///...

    /// <summary>
    /// Returns a terrain layer of type <typeparamref name="TTerrainLayer"/> from the terrain layer group <typeparamref name="TTerrainLayerGroup"/> from the Terrain Entity
    /// </summary>
    /// <typeparam name="TTerrainLayer">Type of the Terrain layer to get from a layer group</typeparam>
    /// <typeparam name="TTerrainLayerGroup">Type of the Terrain Layer Group to find on the entity</typeparam>
    /// <param name="layerReference">reference data to needed layer</param>
    /// <returns>terrain layer if found and null otherwise</returns>
    TTerrainLayer GetTerrainLayer<TTerrainLayerGroup, TTerrainLayer>(HexTerrainLayerReference layerReference)
    {
        where TTerrainLayer : HexTerrainLayer
        where TTerrainLayerGroup : HexTerrainLayerGroup
    {
        var layerGroup = GetTerrainLayer<TTerrainLayerGroup>();
        if (layerGroup != null)
        {
            return layerGroup.GetLayer<TTerrainLayer>(layerReference);
        }

        return null;
    }
}

    /// <summary>Returns the HeightMap value at the specified cell index from the specified ChunkMeshLayer.
    /// </summary>
    /// <typeparam name="TLayerGroup">type of HexTerrainLayerGroup entity component to get the ChunkMeshLayer from</typeparam>
    /// <typeparam name="TLayer">type of ChunkMeshLayer from the HexTerrainLayerGroup to get a cell value from</typeparam>

```

```

    /// <param name="cellIndex">cell index to get a value from</param>
    /// <param name="layerReference">reference to the layer to get a cell value from</param>
    /// <returns>value if found or null if not found</returns>
    float? GetCellHeight<TLayerGroup, TLayer>(int cellIndex, HexTerrainLayerReference layerReference)
        where TLayerGroup : HexTerrainLayerGroup, IComponentData
        where TLayer : ChunkMeshLayer;

    /// <summary>
    /// Sets the HeightMap value at the specified cell index at the specified ChunkMeshLayer.
    /// </summary>
    /// <typeparam name="TLayerGroup">type of HexTerrainLayerGroup entity component to get the ChunkMeshLayer from</typeparam>
    /// <typeparam name="TLayer">type of ChunkMeshLayer from the HexTerrainLayerGroup to set a cell value at</typeparam>
    /// <param name="cellIndex">cell index to set a value at</param>
    /// <param name="layerReference">reference to the layer to set a cell value at</param>
    /// <param name="value">value to set</param>
    /// <returns>true if value has been set, otherwise - false</returns>
    bool SetCellHeight<TLayerGroup, TLayer>(int cellIndex, HexTerrainLayerReference layerReference, float value)
        where TLayerGroup : HexTerrainLayerGroup, IComponentData
        where TLayer : ChunkMeshLayer;

    /// ...
}

```

In general all the interactions are done by accessing components on the Terrain Entity:

```

/// <summary>
/// returns a data layer from the TerrainEntity <see cref="TerrainEntity"/>
/// </summary>
/// <typeparam name="TDataLayer"></typeparam>
/// <returns></returns>
public virtual TDataLayer GetTerrainLayer<TDataLayer>() where TDataLayer : class
{
    if (!EntityManager.Exists(TerrainEntity) || !EntityManager.TryGetComponentObject<TDataLayer>(TerrainEntity, out var dataLayer))
    {
        return default;
    }
    return dataLayer;
}

/// <summary>Returns the HeightMap value at the specified cell index from the specified ChunkMeshLayer.
/// </summary>
/// <typeparam name="TLayerGroup">type of HexTerrainLayerGroup entity component to get the ChunkMeshLayer from</typeparam>
/// <typeparam name="TLayer">type of ChunkMeshLayer from the HexTerrainLayerGroup to get a cell value from</typeparam>
/// <param name="cellIndex">cell index to get a value from</param>
/// <param name="layerReference">reference to the layer to get a cell value from</param>
/// <returns>value if found or null if not found</returns>
public virtual float? GetCellHeight<TLayerGroup, TLayer>(int cellIndex, HexTerrainLayerReference layerReference)
    where TLayerGroup : HexTerrainLayerGroup, IComponentData
    where TLayer : ChunkMeshLayer
{
    var layersList = GetTerrainLayer<TLayerGroup>();
    if (layersList == null)
    {
        return default;
    }

    var terrainLayer = layersList.GetLayer<TLayer>(layerReference);
    if (terrainLayer == null)
    {
        return default;
    }

    var dataLayer = terrainLayer.HeightMap;

    if (!dataLayer.TryGetData(cellIndex, out var value))
    {
        return default;
    }

    return value;
}

```

```

/// <summary>
/// Sets the HeightMap value at the specified cell index at the specified ChunkMeshLayer.
/// </summary>
/// <typeparam name="TLayerGroup">type of HexTerrainLayerGroup entity component to get the C
hunkMeshLayer from</typeparam>
/// <typeparam name="TLayer">type of ChunkMeshLayer from the HexTerrainLayerGroup to set a c
ell value at</typeparam>
/// <param name="cellIndex">cell index to set a value at</param>
/// <param name="layerReference">reference to the layer to set a cell value at</param>
/// <param name="value">value to set</param>
/// <returns>true if value has been set, otherwise - false</returns>
public virtual bool SetCellHeight<TLayerGroup, TLayer>(int cellIndex, HexTerrainLayerReferen
ce layerReference, float value)
    where TLayerGroup : HexTerrainLayerGroup, IComponentData
    where TLayer : ChunkMeshLayer
{
    var layersList = GetTerrainLayer<TLayerGroup>();
    if (layersList == null)
    {
        return false;
    }
    var terrainLayer = layersList.GetLayer<TLayer>(layerReference);
    if (terrainLayer == null)
    {
        return false;
    }

    var dataLayer = terrainLayer.HeightMap;
    if (dataLayer == null)
    {
        return false;
    }

    return dataLayer.TrySetData(cellIndex, value);
}

```

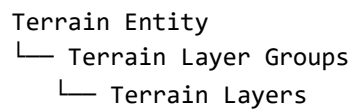
HexTerrains Framework – Core Architecture Concept

Overview

At the heart of the HexTerrains Framework is a **single Terrain Entity**.

This entity does not directly store terrain logic or visuals. Instead, it acts as a **container and coordinator** for structured terrain layers.

The terrain is built using a three-level hierarchy:



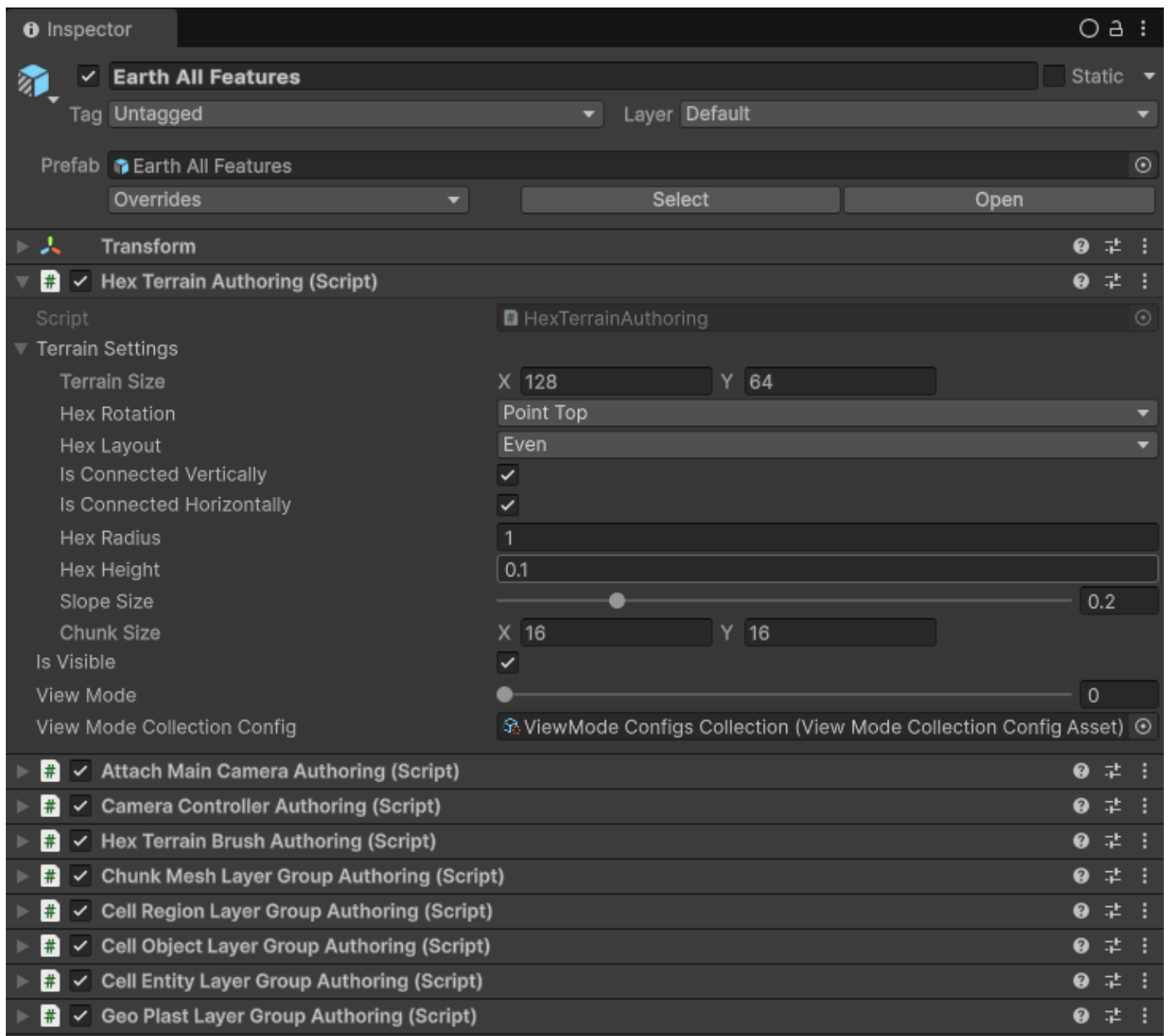
This layered approach keeps the system modular, scalable, and easy to extend.

1. Terrain Entity

The **Terrain Entity** is a single ECS entity that represents the entire hex terrain.

It:

- Defines terrain dimensions (width, height, chunk size)
- Holds global settings
- Owns all terrain layer groups
- Acts as the root of all terrain-related systems



2. Terrain Layer Groups

A **Terrain Layer Group** is a logical category of terrain functionality.

Each group contains one or more related terrain layers.

Examples of possible layer groups:

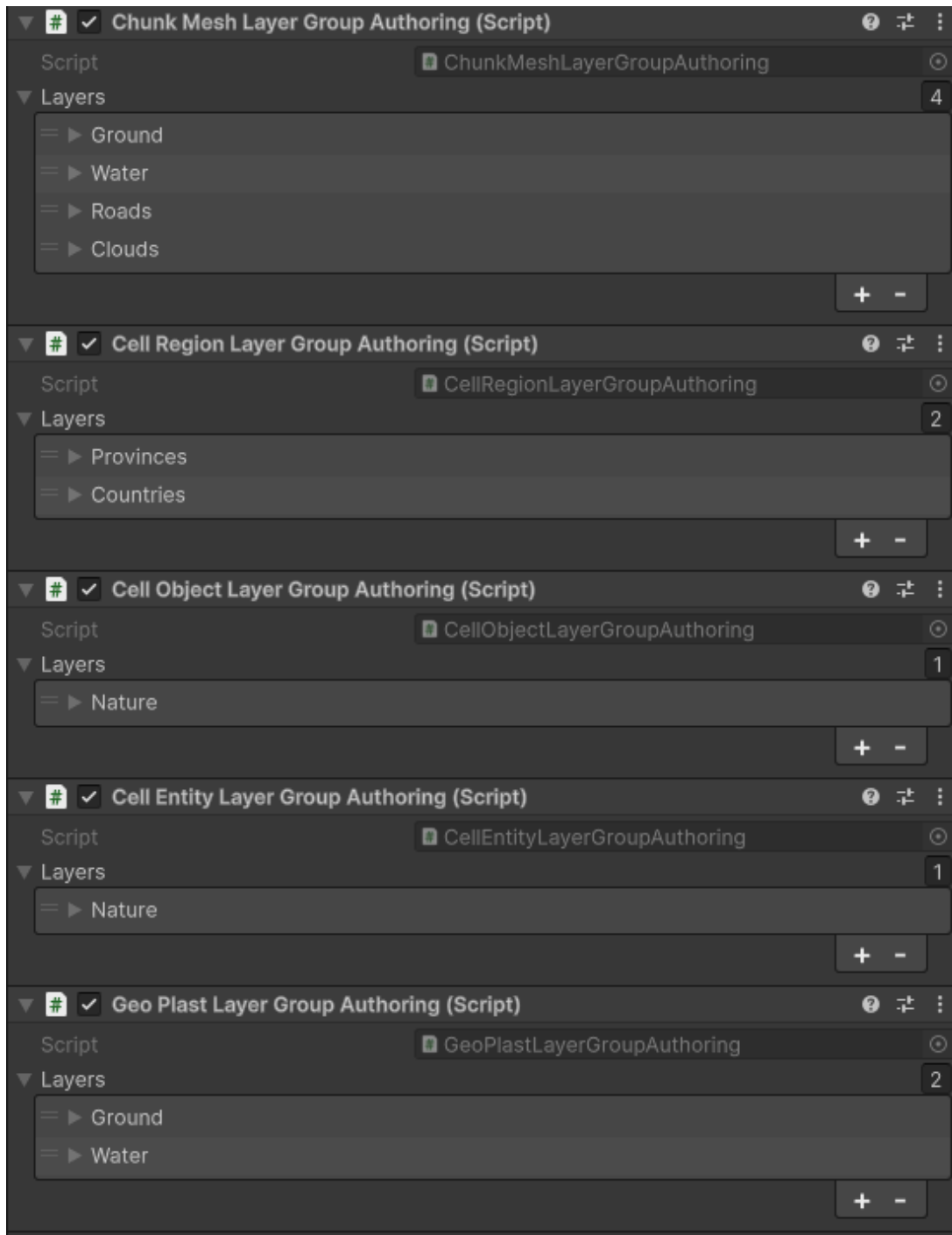
- ChunkMesh Layer Group (procedural generated mesh per chunk)
- CellObject Layer Group (static visual item per cell, instanced objects like trees)
- CellEntity Layer Group (ECS Entity per cell)
- CellRegion Layer Group (Region index per cell, like Country or Province)
- GeoPlast Layer Group (volumetric simulation like ground or water)

A layer group:

- Organizes related systems
- Controls update order within the group

- Manages shared behavior between its layers

Think of a Layer Group as a **department** inside the terrain.



3. Terrain Layers

A **Terrain Layer** is where actual terrain logic and data live.

Each layer represents a specific aspect of the terrain.

Examples:

- Ground surface layer
- Water surface layer

- Roads layer
- Nature CellObject layer
- Countries layer
- Water GeoPlast layer (water flow simulation)

A Terrain Layer typically contains:

- One or more Data Layers (per-cell data storage)
- Chunk-based dirty tracking
- Job scheduling logic
- Rendering or simulation logic

Layers are independent from each other but operate within their group's context.

Think of a Terrain Layer as a **specialized system** responsible for one aspect of the terrain. For example, `ChunkMeshLayer` has a `HeightMap` (float value per cell), a `BiomeMap` (int value per cell), and a `Transparency Map` (bool value per cell). It generates a mesh per chunk and renders them on screen, so you can have a terrain surface. It is possible to have any amounts of layers inside the same `TerrainLayerGroup`, so you can have one layer for Ground, one layer for Water, one layer for Roads, one for Clouds, and so on.

Why This Structure?

This hierarchy provides:

- Clear separation of responsibilities
- High modularity
- Easy extensibility
- Controlled update order
- Safe data management
- Scalable simulation and rendering

Instead of building one monolithic terrain system, the framework builds many focused layers that work together under one Terrain Entity.

Mental Model Summary

- **Terrain Entity** → The world container
- **Layer Groups** → Categories of functionality
- **Terrain Layers** → Concrete implementations (rendering, objects, simulation)
- **Data Layers (inside layers)** → Actual per-cell data storage

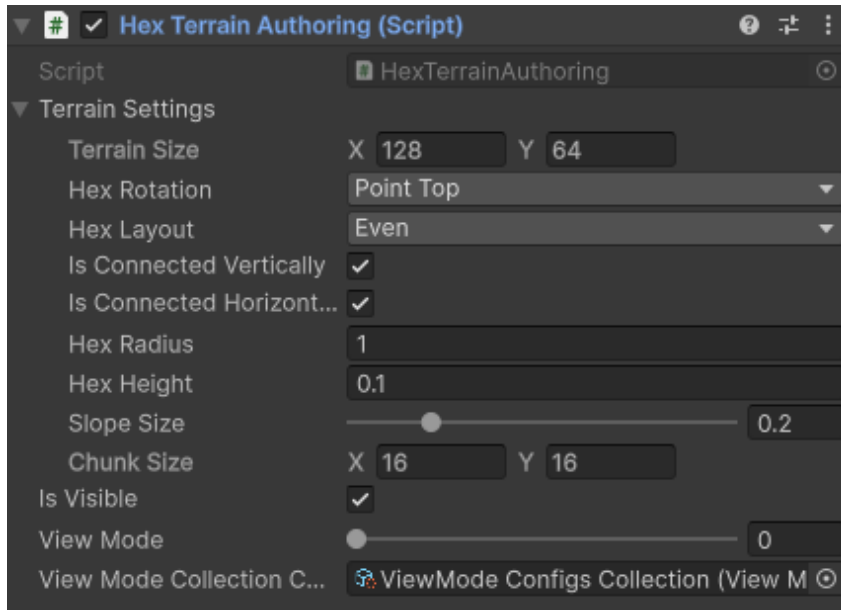
This structure allows the terrain to grow in complexity without becoming unmanageable.

How to create a Terrain Entity

Baking

Place a TerrainEntity authoring prefab game object on a subscene. Add all needed components to it:

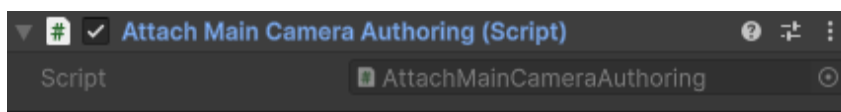
HexTerrain



This component contains terrain settings such as `TerrainSize` in cells (x, y), `HexRotation` (Point Top/Flat Top), `HexLayout` (Even/Odd), `HexRadius` (the lenght of the hexagon side), `HexHeight` (1 unit of height on `HeightMap` translates to this height of cell in meters, think of it as a vertical terrain scale), `SlopeSize` (share of the hex radius dedicated to slope between two adjacent cells), `IsConnectedVertically` and `IsConnectedHorizontally` flags (allow to connect opposite sides of the terrain, to create an illusion of a round planet like in Civilization), and `ChunkSize` (width and height of one terrain chunk in cells. 16x16 is an optimal value, as the Unity engine has a hard limit for the amount of vertices per mesh, and the `ChunkMeshLayer` generates one mesh per chunk. So depending on the geometry of your chunks the amount of vertexes per cell can easilly make your mesh big enough to go over that limit).

AttachMainCamera

Optional component



Attaches a `Camera.main` to the Terrain Entity on Initialization phase in runtime. In order to calculate visible chunks, the `ChunksGridLayer` needs a `Camera` instance attached to the Terrain Entity (to test chunk visibility inside the Camera Frustum).

If your logic requires different camera to be attached or no camera at all, don't add this component. If you need another camera to be attached, create your own component for that and check `AttachMainCameraToTerrainSystem` to learn how the camera is attached to the Terrain Entity:

```
[UpdateInGroup(typeof(CreateHexTerrainsGroup))]  
public partial class AttachMainCameraToTerrainSystem : SystemBase  
{  
    private EntityQuery _terrainsQuery;  
  
    protected override void OnCreate()  
    {  
        base.OnCreate();  
  
        _terrainsQuery = GetEntityQuery(  
            ComponentType.ReadOnly<AttachMainCameraRequest>(),  
            ComponentType.Exclude<Camera>()  
        );  
  
        RequireForUpdate(_terrainsQuery);  
    }  
  
    protected override void OnUpdate()  
    {  
        using var ecb = new EntityCommandBuffer(Unity.Collections.Allocator.Temp);  
        var camera = Camera.main;  
  
        ecb.AddComponentObject(_terrainsQuery, camera);  
        ecb.RemoveComponent<AttachMainCameraRequest>(_terrainsQuery, EntityQueryCaptureMode.  
AtPlayback);  
  
        ecb.Playback(EntityManager);  
    }  
}
```

CameraController

Optional component

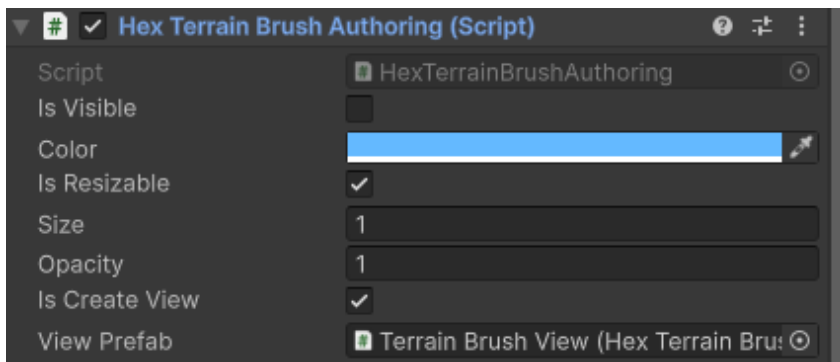


This component adds the default Camera Controller to the terrain that allows to control a position of the Camera attached to the Terrain Entity.

If you have your own implementation of the Camera Controller, or you simply don't need the default camera controller, don't add this component.

HexTerrainBrush

Optional component

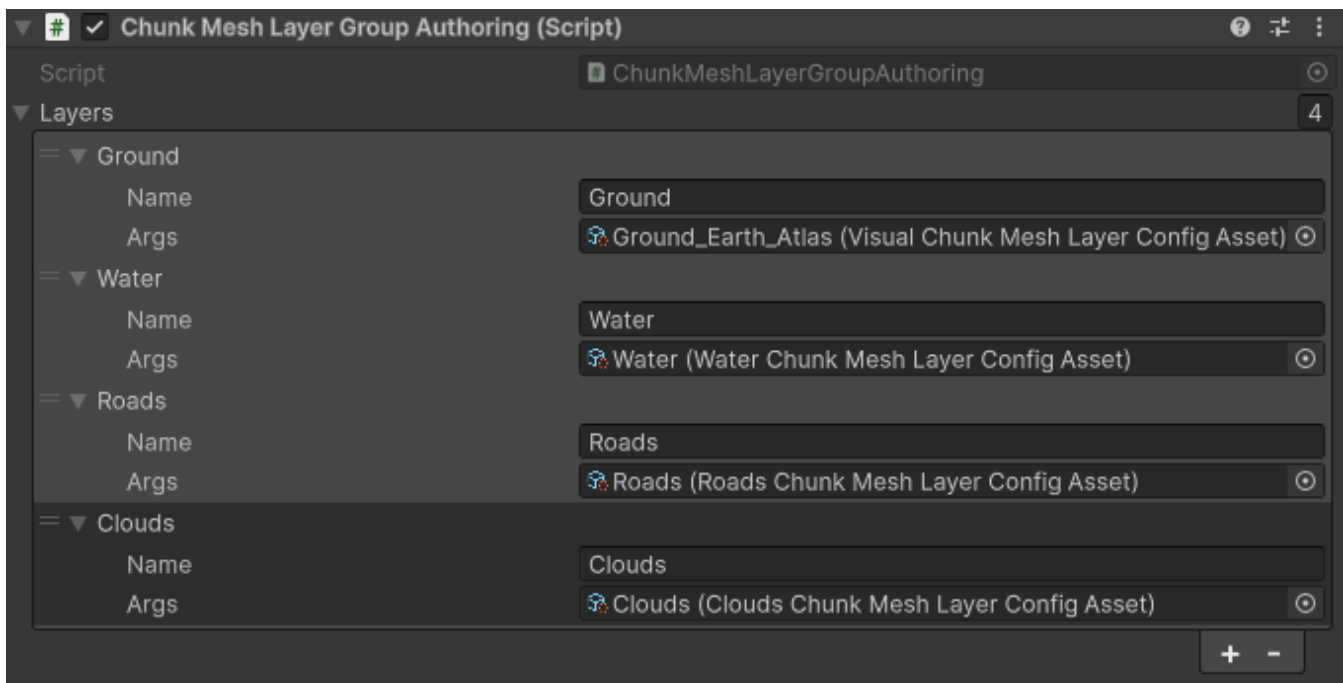


This component adds a 'Brush' that highlights the cells under cursor. Default implementation uses the `DecalProjector` to project a highlight on the terrain (see `View Prefab` on authoring component)

If you don't need a brush on the terrain, or you have your own implementation, don't add this component

ChunkMeshLayerGroup

Optional component



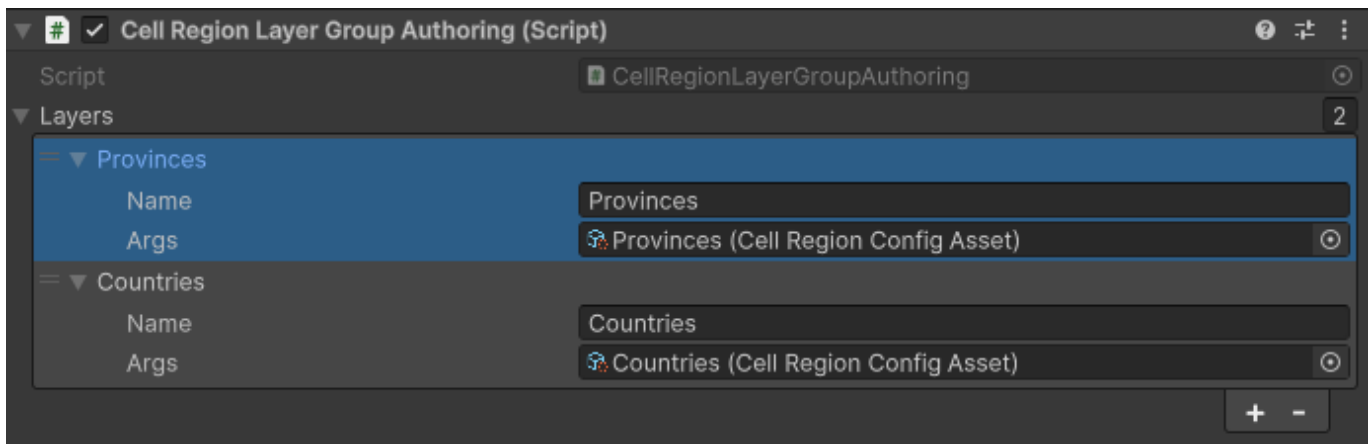
This component adds a `ChunkMeshLayerGroup` component to the `TerrainEntity`. This `LayerGroup` holds a list of `ChunkMeshLayer` layers such as `TerrainSurface`, `Clouds`, `Roads`, etc.

Each `ChunkMeshLayer` has a `HeightMap` (float per cell), `BiomeMap` (int per cell), and `TransparencyMap` (bool per cell). It also has a `CellMetricsMap` that holds precalculated data for each cell such as local and global center position, cell height, chunk index, chunk position, etc. This data is used by mesh generation as well as by other layers such as `CellObjectLayer` or `CellEntityLayer` to cell metrics dependent calculation. So `CellMetrics` are generated once and then used in different places.

This component is optional, but some other layers depend on it, such as `CellObjectLayer` and `CellEntityLayer` - for calculating the transforms for their items.

CellRegionLayerGroup

Optional component



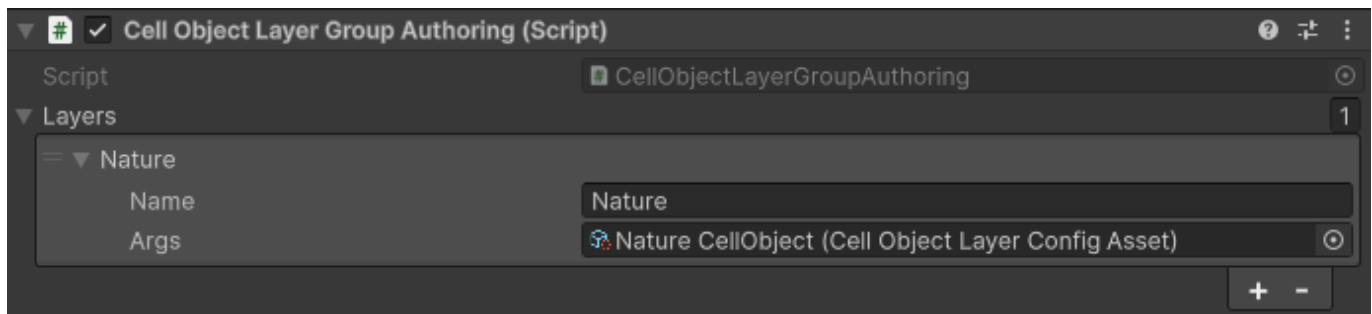
This component adds a `CellRegionLayerGroup` component to the `Terrain Entity`. This `LayerGroup` holds a list of `CellRegionLayer` layers such as `Provinces`, `Countries`, etc. `CellRegionLayer` has a `CellRegionMap` (int per cell), `RegionCells` (`NativeParallelMultiHashMap<int, uint>` where key is a region index and values is a collection of

cell indexes of the cells that are belong to that region), `RegionSizes` (uint per cell where index is a region index and value is the amount of cells of that region). `RegionCells` and `RegionSizes` are recalculated when `CellRegionMap` values change. `CellRegionMap` is a data layer with embedded color map, so whenever the data is changed, the colors in that color map are updated. That colors can be copied into the `Texture2D` instance to be displayed on UI or in terrain material to color the terrain cells into the respective colors (for example, to paint each cell into the color of the country that cell belongs to).

This component is totally optional and in default implementation no other layers depend on it.

CellObjectLayerGroup

Optional component



This component adds a `CellObjectLayerGroup` component to the Terrain Entity. This LayerGroup holds a list of `CellObjectLayer` layers such as Trees, Buildings, etc.

`CellObjectLayer` has `ItemIndexMap` (int per cell), `ItemStateMap` (int per cell), `ItemPositionMap` (float3 per cell), `ItemRotationMap` (quaternion per cell), `ItemScaleMap` (float3 per cell), and `ItemTransformMap` (Matrix4x4 per cell). When `ItemPositionMap` or `ItemRotationMap` or `ItemScaleMap` data is changed, the `ItemTransformMap` is recalculated, so it always contains the transform matrix for each cell for the Cell Items to render at.

This layer holds a palette for Cell Items. Each `CellItem` index and `CellItemState` correspond to an item in the palette. So if in a `ItemIndexMap[cell]` is 1 and `ItemStateMap[cell]` is 3, on this cell will be rendered an item from palette for index 1 and state 3. Rendering is done using `Graphics.DrawMeshInstanced`.

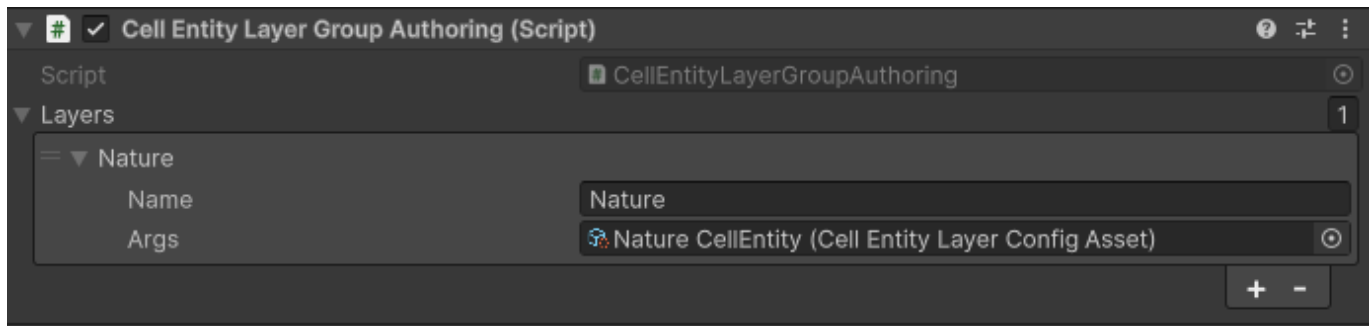
This layer supports LODs (see the `CellObject` prefab).

This layer exists to solve a problem with inability to have millions of Entities in Unity. If you have a huge terrain with millions of cells, and you spawn an Entity in each cell, the Unity may crash. To solve this problem a `CellObject` mechanic was created. It can hold as much items as you need as long as you have memory for them. Cell Objects are more lightweight than Entities and run faster, but provide only static object(s) per cell without a hierarchy, no animation, etc. Cell Objects can co-exist with Cell Entity on the same terrain without any problems.

This layer is optional. In default implementation no other layers depend on it.

CellEntityLayerGroup

Optional component



This component adds a `CellEntityLayerGroup` component to the Terrain Entity. This LayerGroup holds a list of `CellEntityLayer` layers such as Trees, Buildings, etc.

`CellEntityLayer` is very similar to the `CellObjectLayer`, but instead of rendering cell items using `Graphics.DrawMeshInstanced`, this layer spawns Entity per cell from palette according to the `ItemIndexMap` value and `ItemStateMap` value.

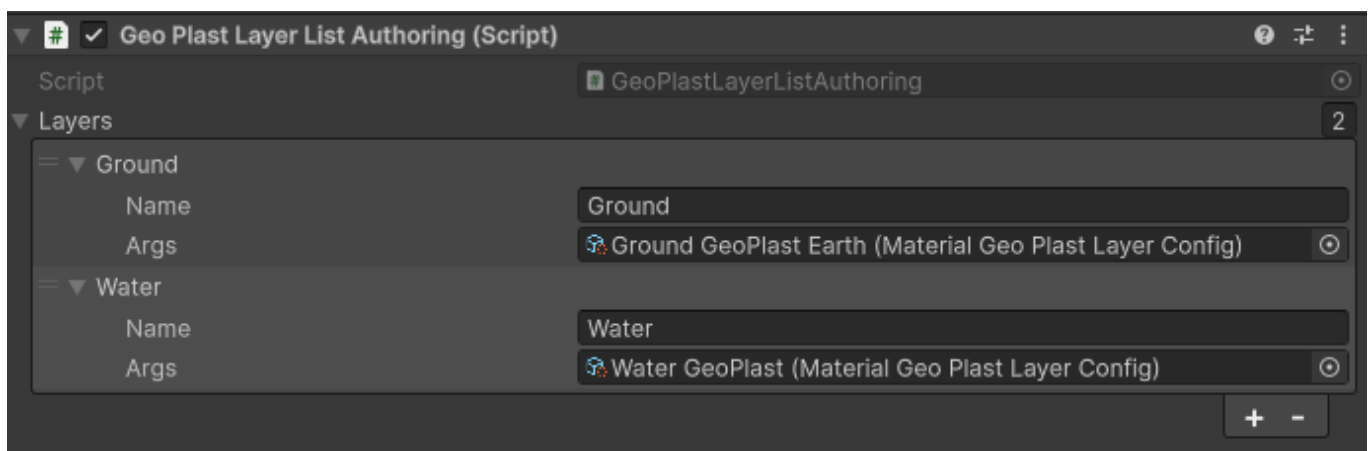
This layer holds a palette for Cell Items. Each `CellItemIndex` and `CellItemState` correspond to an Entity prefab in the palette. So if in a `ItemIndexMap[cell]` is 1 and `ItemStateMap[cell]` is 3, on this cell will be placed an Entity from palette for index 1 and state 3.

Note that Unity may crash if you create millions of Entities, so if you have a huge terrain and you create an entity for each cell, keep this restriction in mind. The `CellObjectLayer` exists to fix this problem, as it can hold as many items as you want as long as you have memory for them.

This layer is optional. In default implementation no other layers depend on it.

GeoPlastLayerGroup

Optional component



This component adds a `GeoPlastLayerGroup` to the Terrain Entity. This LayerGroup holds a list of `GeoPlastLayer` layers such as Ground, Water, Air, etc.

`GeoPlastLayer` has `AmountMap` (float per cell), `VolumeMap` (float per cell), `DensityMap` (float per cell), `BedrockHeightMap` (float per cell), `CeilingHeightMap` (float per cell). When `AmountMap` values or `DensityMap` values are changed, the `VolumeMap` is recalculated. Volume is calculated by multiplying the plast amount with its density in the same cell. Whenever the `BedrockHeightMap` is changed or `VolumeMap` is changed, the `CeilingHeightMap` is recalculated. Ceiling height is Bedrock height + Volume in each cell.

It is possible to set a bedrock reference to another `GeoPlastLayer`. In this case the Bedrock height of the layer is equals to the Ceiling height of the bedrock layer. This allows to place a layer above layer. So, for instance, if you have a Water `GeoPlast` layer and its bedrock is a Ground `GeoPlast` layer, the water is always above the ground, and when the ground height is changed, the water automatically adjusts.

If a `GeoPlastLayer` is a `DynamicGeoPlastLayer`, it has an ability to flow. Flow is an exchange of volume between adjacent cells in attempt to equalize Ceiling height. This naturally creates a realistic flow of the `GeoPlast` volume, so, for example, water flows downhill, filling the valleys on the ground.

There is also an ability to set a vertical flow targets (up and down) to exchange volume between `GeoPlast` layers. For instance, to simulate evaporation from water to clouds or to simulate condensation from clouds back to water. Default implementation of the `DynamicGeoPlastLayer` does not calculate a vertical flow, but there is a `MaterialGeoPlastLayer` that has an implementation of the vertical flow depending on the Temperature (so you can have a freezing/evaporating water, melting snow, etc).

Runtime

Initialization process

Because the Terrain Layers are managed `IDataComponent` components, it is not possible to bake them directly on Entity. So instead baking adds the `CreateLayerRequest` components.

For example, the `ChunkMeshLayerGroupBaker` adds a `DynamicBuffer<CreateChunkMeshLayerRequest>` :

```

public struct CreateChunkMeshLayerRequest : IBufferData, ITerrainLayerFactory
{
    public FixedString128Bytes Name;
    public UnityObjectRef<ChunkMeshLayerConfigAsset> Args;

    public HexTerrainLayer CreateTerrainLayer()
    {
        var config = Args.Value;
        if (config == null)
        {
            return default;
        }

        return config.CreateTerrainLayer();
    }
}

```

The `ChunkMeshLayerConfigAsset` here is a `ScriptableObject` that implements an `IChunkMeshLayerConfig` interface. This way the parameters of the `ChunkMeshLayer` is set on that `ScriptableObject` asset, and it is passed to the runtime world through baking the buffer of requests.

When the `CreateChunkMeshLayerGroupSystem` sees the entity with this `DynamicBuffer` of requests, it creates a `ChunkMeshLayerGroup` component, puts it on Terrain Entity and then creates and initializes as much `ChunkMeshLayers` as much requests are in this `DynamicBuffer`. After initialization the requests `DynamicBuffer` is removed from Terrain Entity.

The same approach is used for all the Terrain Layers.

Note that you don't have to use a `ScriptableObject` to initialize a `TerrainLayer`, you can use any class or struct you want as long as it implements the required interface. In case of `ChunkMeshLayer` it has to implement the `IChunkMeshLayerConfig`, in case of `CellEntityLayer` it must be `ICellEntityLayerConfig`, and so on.

Creating a Terrain Entity in runtime

If you don't bake your Terrain Entity from a scene, but want to create a Terrain in runtime, you have two options:

1. Instantiate a baked entity prefab with Create Layers Requests on it.
2. Instantiate an empty entity and manually add all the components to it. You can add `CreateLayerRequests` as baker does and then wait for one frame so the initialization systems create and initialize layers. Or alternatively you can create the `TerrainLayerGroup` components in your code, create and insert all the layers inside them, and add the `LayerGroups` to your entity.

See the code of Bakers of the authoring components to learn which components you have to add for the initialization process (Create Terrain Layer Requests processing):

Non-optional components:

```

public class HexTerrainBaker : Baker<HexTerrainAuthoring>
{
    public override void Bake(HexTerrainAuthoring authoring)
    {
        var terrainEntity = GetEntity(authoring, TransformUsageFlags.Dynamic);
        var terrainSettings = authoring.TerrainSettings;

        // terrain
        AddComponent(terrainEntity, new HexTerrain
        {
            Settings = terrainSettings
        });

        AddComponent(terrainEntity, new HexTerrainRaycastData());

        AddComponent(terrainEntity, new HexTerrainViewMode
        {
            Value = authoring.ViewMode
        });

        AddComponent(terrainEntity, new HexTerrainVisibility
        {
            Value = authoring.IsVisible
        });
        if (authoring.ViewModeCollectionConfig != null)
        {
            AddComponent(terrainEntity, new ViewModeCollectionConfigComponent
            {
                ConfigAsset = authoring.ViewModeCollectionConfig
            });
        }

        AddComponent(terrainEntity, new CreateChunksGridLayerRequest());

        AddComponent(terrainEntity, new NotInitializedTerrain
        {
            IsSetViewMode = true,
            ViewMode = authoring.ViewMode
        });
    }
}

```

Optional components.

Camera controller:

```

public class CameraControllerBaker : Baker<CameraControllerAuthoring>
{
    public override void Bake(CameraControllerAuthoring authoring)
    {
        var entity = GetEntity(TransformUsageFlags.Dynamic);
        AddComponent(entity, new CreateCameraControllerRequest
        {
            MoveUpKey = authoring.MoveUpKey,
            MoveDownKey = authoring.MoveDownKey,
            MoveLeftKey = authoring.MoveLeftKey,
            MoveRightKey = authoring.MoveRightKey,
            AccelerationKey = authoring.AccelerationKey,
            RotateLeftKey = authoring.RotateLeftKey,
            RotateRightKey = authoring.RotateRightKey,
            LockMovementKey = authoring.LockMovementKey,
            SaveCameraStateKey = authoring.SaveCameraStateKey,
            LoadCameraStateKey = authoring.LoadCameraStateKey,

            ZoomSpeed = authoring.ZoomSpeed,
            MovementSpeed = authoring.MovementSpeed,
            RotationSpeed = authoring.RotationSpeed,
            AccelerationMultiplier = authoring.AccelerationMultiplier,

            IsFindCameraControllerComponentOnScene = authoring.IsFindCameraControllerCompone
ntOnScene
        });

        var ignoreInputBuf = AddBuffer<IgnoreCameraZoomInputKeys>(entity);
        if (authoring.PreventZoomKeys != null)
        {
            for (var kIndex = 0; kIndex < authoring.PreventZoomKeys.Count; kIndex++)
            {
                ignoreInputBuf.Add(new IgnoreCameraZoomInputKeys
                {
                    Value = authoring.PreventZoomKeys[kIndex]
                });
            }
        }
    }
}

```

Attach main camera request:

```

public class AttachMainCameraBaker : Baker<AttachMainCameraAuthoring>
{
    public override void Bake(AttachMainCameraAuthoring authoring)
    {
        var entity = GetEntity(TransformUsageFlags.None);
        AddComponent(entity, new AttachMainCameraRequest());
    }
}

```

HexTerrainBrush:

```

public class HexTerrainBrushBaker : Baker<HexTerrainBrushAuthoring>
{
    public override void Bake(HexTerrainBrushAuthoring authoring)
    {
        var entity = GetEntity(TransformUsageFlags.Dynamic);

        AddComponent(entity, new HexTerrainBrush
        {
            Color = authoring.Color,
            IsResizable = authoring.IsResizable,
            IsVisible = authoring.IsVisible,
            Size = authoring.Size,
            Opacity = authoring.Opacity
        });

        if (authoring.IsCreateView && authoring.ViewPrefab != null)
        {
            var request = new CreateHexTerrainBrushViewRequest
            {
                Prefab = new UnityObjectRef<GameObject>
                {
                    Value = authoring.ViewPrefab.gameObject
                }
            };
            AddComponent(entity, request);
        }
    }
}

```

ChunkMeshLayerGroup:


```

public class ChunkMeshLayerGroupBaker : Baker<ChunkMeshLayerGroupAuthoring>
{
    public override void Bake(ChunkMeshLayerGroupAuthoring authoring)
    {
        var terrainEntity = GetEntity(TransformUsageFlags.None);

        var createRequests = AddBuffer<CreateChunkMeshLayerRequest>(terrainEntity);
        if (authoring.Layers != null)
        {
            for (var lIndex = 0; lIndex < authoring.Layers.Count; lIndex++)
            {
                var layerAuthoring = authoring.Layers[lIndex];
                if (layerAuthoring.Args == null)
                {
                    Debug.LogError($"Layer {layerAuthoring.Name} has no Args defined.");
                    continue;
                }

                var request = new CreateChunkMeshLayerRequest
                {
                    Name = layerAuthoring.Name,
                    Args = layerAuthoring.Args
                };
                createRequests.Add(request);
            }
        }
    }
}

```

CellRegionLayerGroup:

```

public class CellRegionLayerGroupBaker : Baker<CellRegionLayerGroupAuthoring>
{
    public override void Bake(CellRegionLayerGroupAuthoring authoring)
    {
        var terrainEntity = GetEntity(TransformUsageFlags.None);

        var createRequests = AddBuffer<CreateCellRegionLayerGroupRequest>(terrainEntity);
        if (authoring.Layers != null)
        {
            for (var lIndex = 0; lIndex < authoring.Layers.Count; lIndex++)
            {
                var layerAuthoring = authoring.Layers[lIndex];
                if (layerAuthoring.Args == null)
                {
                    Debug.LogError($"Layer {layerAuthoring.Name} has no Args defined.");
                    continue;
                }

                var request = new CreateCellRegionLayerGroupRequest
                {
                    Name = layerAuthoring.Name,
                    Args = layerAuthoring.Args
                };
                createRequests.Add(request);
            }
        }
    }
}

```

CellObjectLayerGroup:

```

public class CellObjectLayerGroupBaker : Baker<CellObjectLayerGroupAuthoring>
{
    public override void Bake(CellObjectLayerGroupAuthoring authoring)
    {
        var terrainEntity = GetEntity(TransformUsageFlags.None);

        var createRequests = AddBuffer<CreateCellObjectsLayerRequest>(terrainEntity);
        if (authoring.Layers != null)
        {
            for (var lIndex = 0; lIndex < authoring.Layers.Count; lIndex++)
            {
                var layerAuthoring = authoring.Layers[lIndex];
                if (layerAuthoring.Args == null)
                {
                    Debug.LogError($"Layer {layerAuthoring.Name} has no Args defined.");
                    continue;
                }

                var request = new CreateCellObjectsLayerRequest
                {
                    Name = layerAuthoring.Name,
                    Args = layerAuthoring.Args
                };
                createRequests.Add(request);
            }
        }
    }
}

```

CellEntityLayerGroup:

```

public class CellEntitiesLayersBaker : Baker<CellEntityLayerGroupAuthoring>
{
    public override void Bake(CellEntityLayerGroupAuthoring authoring)
    {
        var terrainEntity = GetEntity(TransformUsageFlags.Dynamic);
        var requestBuff = AddBuffer<CreateCellEntityLayerRequest>(terrainEntity);
        var cellEntityPrefabsBuff = AddBuffer<CellEntityConfig>(terrainEntity);

        if (authoring.Layers != null)
        {
            for (var lIndex = 0; lIndex < authoring.Layers.Count; lIndex++)
            {
                var layerAuthoring = authoring.Layers[lIndex];
                var createLayerArgs = layerAuthoring.Args;
                if (createLayerArgs != null)
                {
                    BakeCellEntities(createLayerArgs, lIndex, cellEntityPrefabsBuff);
                }

                var createLayerRequest = new CreateCellEntityLayerRequest
                {
                    Name = layerAuthoring.Name,
                    Args = new UnityObjectRef<CellEntityLayerConfigAsset>
                    {
                        Value = createLayerArgs
                    }
                };
                requestBuff.Add(createLayerRequest);
            }
        }

        public virtual void BakeCellEntities(CellEntityLayerConfigAsset createArgs, int layerIndex, DynamicBuffer<CellEntityConfig> cellEntityConfigs)
        {
            var configsRangeStart = cellEntityConfigs.Length;
            var configsRangeSize = 0;

            for (int entityConfigIndex = 0; entityConfigIndex < createArgs.CellEntities.Count; entityConfigIndex++)
            {
                var itemConfigAuthoring = createArgs.CellEntities[entityConfigIndex];
                var entityConfig = new CellEntityConfig
                {
                    Color = itemConfigAuthoring.Color,
                    Prefabs = new FixedList16<Entity>(),
                    StatePerPrefab = new FixedList16<byte>()
                };

                for (var pIndex = 0; pIndex < itemConfigAuthoring.PrefabConfigs.Count; pIndex++)
                {
                    var prefabConfigAuthoring = itemConfigAuthoring.PrefabConfigs[pIndex];

```

```

        RegisterPrefabForBaking(prefabConfigAuthoring.Prefab);
        var itemPrefab = GetEntity(prefabConfigAuthoring.Prefab, TransformUsageFlag
s.Dynamic);
        entityConfig.Prefabs.Add(itemPrefab);
        entityConfig.StatePerPrefab.Add((byte)prefabConfigAuthoring.State);
    }

    cellEntityConfigs.Add(entityConfig);

    configsRangeSize++;
}

createArgs.EntityConfigsRangeStart = configsRangeStart;
createArgs.EntityConfigsRangeSize = configsRangeSize;

#if UNITY_EDITOR
    UnityEditor.EditorUtility.SetDirty(createArgs);
#endif
}
}

```

GeoPlastLayerGroup:

```

public class GeoPlastLayersGroupBaker : Baker<GeoPlastLayerGroupAuthoring>
{
    public override void Bake(GeoPlastLayerGroupAuthoring authoring)
    {
        var terrainEntity = GetEntity(TransformUsageFlags.None);

        var createRequests = AddBuffer<CreateGeoPlastLayerRequest>(terrainEntity);
        if (authoring.Layers != null)
        {
            for (var lIndex = 0; lIndex < authoring.Layers.Count; lIndex++)
            {
                var layerAuthoring = authoring.Layers[lIndex];
                if (layerAuthoring.Args == null)
                {
                    Debug.LogError($"Layer {layerAuthoring.Name} has no Args defined.");
                    continue;
                }

                var request = new CreateGeoPlastLayerRequest
                {
                    Name = layerAuthoring.Name,
                    Args = layerAuthoring.Args
                };
                createRequests.Add(request);
            }
        }
    }
}

```

Interacting With a Terrain Entity

This page explains the main runtime interaction model in HexTerrains:

- how terrain state is stored on a **terrain entity**
 - what `ITerrainAPI` / `TerrainAPI` are for
 - what `IEnvironmentAPI` / `EnvironmentAPI` are for
 - how `EnvironmentAPIComponent` is created (startup wiring)
 - how to plug in a custom `IEnvironmentAPI` using `CreateEnvironmentAPIRequest` + `EnvironmentAPIConfigAssetBase`
 - practical interaction examples (reading/writing terrain data)
-

1) The core idea: "Terrain = Entity + Components"

HexTerrains uses Unity Entities (ECS) as the storage backend.

A **terrain** is represented by an `Entity` (referred to as `terrainEntity`) that contains:

- `HexTerrain` (`IData`) — holds `HexTerrainSettings` (size, chunk size, layout/rotation, etc.)
- multiple **managed components** (component objects) that implement various terrain layer/data concepts, commonly derived from `HexTerrainLayer` and/or `HexTerrainLayerGroup`

Most "terrain layers" are **managed component objects** attached to the same `terrainEntity`, e.g. a `ChunkMeshLayerGroup` that contains multiple `ChunkMeshLayer` instances.

Why APIs exist

Direct `EntityManager` access is not always convenient (or desirable) across tools/UI code. HexTerrains provides two API layers:

- `IEnvironmentAPI` / `EnvironmentAPI` — environment-wide operations (UI integration, save/load, create/destroy terrains, cursor raycast info, brush settings, etc.)
 - `ITerrainAPI` / `TerrainAPI` — terrain-focused, convenience accessors/mutators (cell height/biome/regions/objects/entities/etc.), typically used by user tools
-

2) `ITerrainAPI` (terrain-focused API)

`ITerrainAPI` is a "terrain-scoped" façade around a specific `terrainEntity`.

Responsibilities

`ITerrainAPI` exposes:

- references to other subsystems:
 - `IUISystemAPI` `UISystemAPI` { `get`; }
 - `IEnvironmentAPI` `EnvironmentAPI` { `get`; }
- access to the current terrain:

- Entity GetTerrainEntity()
- HexTerrainSettings? GetTerrainSettings()
- managed layer access:
 - TTerrainLayer GetTerrainLayer<TTerrainLayer>() where TTerrainLayer : class
 - bool IsLayerSupported<TDataLayer>()
 - helper to fetch a layer from a group:
 - GetTerrainLayer<TTerrainLayerGroup, TTerrainLayer>(HexTerrainLayerReference layerReference)

The “LayerGroup + LayerReference” pattern

Many APIs use:

- a *group component* on the entity (ex: ChunkMeshLayerGroup : HexTerrainLayerGroup<ChunkMeshLayer>, IComponentData)
- a HexTerrainLayerReference to select a nested layer by:
 - index (ByLayerIndex(...))
 - name (ByLayerName(...))
 - index + name (ByLayerIndexAndName(...))

This lets you address “the 2nd surface layer” or “the layer named Water” without hard-coding component types everywhere.

Typical operations

ITerrainAPI includes a large set of convenience methods grouped by feature, for example:

- **Cell height:** GetCellHeight(...), SetCellHeight(...)
- **Biome:** GetCellBiome(...), SetCellBiome(...)
- **Regions / objects / entities / geoplasts:** similar “get/set cell value” patterns
- **Visibility** of visual mesh layers: GetChunkMeshLayerVisibility(...), ShowChunkMeshLayer(...), HideChunkMeshLayer(...)

3) HexTerrainAPI (default ITerrainAPI implementation)

HexTerrainAPI is the provided baseline implementation.

What it caches

HexTerrainAPI stores:

- Entity TerrainEntity — the terrain it currently targets
- EntityManager EntityManager — used to query and mutate ECS storage
- Entity UserToolEntity — typically the entity that drives a tool/brush
- IUISystemAPI UISystemAPI
- IEnvironmentAPI EnvironmentAPI

It is designed so that if `TerrainEntity` changes, **all API calls automatically operate on the new entity** (the API queries the `EntityManager` each call).

Failure behavior (important)

Most methods are defensive:

- If the entity doesn't exist, or a layer isn't present, calls generally return `null` / `default` / `false` rather than throwing.
- Layer access uses `EntityManager.TryGetComponentObject<T>(...)` for managed components.

Example: how HexTerrainAPI reads/writes cell height

Internally `HexTerrainAPI` does this pattern:

1. Get the layer group component (managed or data component depending on the group type)
2. Use `HexTerrainLayerReference` to locate the nested layer
3. Use the layer's data layer (`HeightMap`, `BiomeMap`, etc.) and call `TryGetData` / `TrySetData`

This keeps tool code independent from the underlying data storage layout.

4) IEnvironmentAPI (environment-wide API)

`IEnvironmentAPI` is the "outer" API used to operate on **any** terrain entity, and also to integrate UI and environment-level assets.

Key properties

- `Entity EnvironmentAPIEntity { get; set; }`
The entity that hosts the environment API component.
- `EntityManager EntityManager { get; set; }`
- `IUISystemAPI UISystemAPI { get; set; }`

Terrain-facing methods (selected highlights)

Terrain basics

- `HexTerrainSettings? GetTerrainSettings(Entity terrainEntity)`
- `TDataLayer GetTerrainLayer<TDataLayer>(Entity terrainEntity)`
- `bool IsTerrainLayerSupported<TDataLayer>(Entity terrainEntity)`

Visibility and view mode

- `bool? GetIsTerrainVisible(Entity terrainEntity)`
- `bool SetIsTerrainVisible(Entity terrainEntity, bool isVisible)`
- `int GetViewMode(Entity terrainEntity)`
- `bool SetViewMode(Entity terrainEntity, int viewMode)`

Persistence

- `bool SaveTerrain(Entity terrainEntity, string filePath)`

- `bool LoadTerrain(Entity terrainEntity, string filePath)`

Resizing and lifecycle

- `bool ResizeTerrain(Entity terrainEntity, int2 terrainSize)`
- `bool DestroyTerrain(Entity terrainEntity)`

Cursor / raycast

- `HexTerrainRaycastData? GetRaycastData(Entity terrainEntity)`
- `int? GetCellIndexUnderCursor(Entity terrainEntity)`
- `int2? GetCellCoordUnderCursor(Entity terrainEntity)`

Prefab configs and palettes

- `IList<IHexTerrainPrefabConfig> GetHexTerrainPrefabConfigsList()`
- `IList<Texture2D> GetHeightmapPalette()`

UI

- methods to create/get/destroy UI screens via `IUISystemAPI` (minimap, user tools screen, etc.)

5) EnvironmentAPI (default IEnvironmentAPI implementation)

`EnvironmentAPI` implements the interface using `EntityManager` reads/writes.

Notable behavior:

- `SaveTerrain(...)` / `LoadTerrain(...)` delegate to `HexTerrainSerializer`.
- `ResizeTerrain(...)` updates `HexTerrain.Settings.TerrainSize`, then iterates managed components on the terrain entity and calls `Resize(...)` for those that are `HexTerrainLayer`.
This is the standard "resize propagates to managed layers" workflow.
- `GetHexTerrainPrefabConfigsList()` and `GetHeightmapPalette()` cache results after first query.

6) EnvironmentAPIComponent: how the environment API is stored on an entity

`EnvironmentAPIComponent` is a managed ECS component (`IComponentData`) that holds an `IEnvironmentAPI` instance:

- `public IEnvironmentAPI Value;`

It also implements `IDisposable` and will dispose `Value` if it implements `IDisposable`.

Marker component: EnvironmentAPIEntity

Alongside `EnvironmentAPIComponent`, the framework also adds a marker `EnvironmentAPIEntity` : `IComponentData` so systems can locate "the environment API entity" as a singleton.

7) How EnvironmentAPIComponent is created (startup flow)

Creation is request-driven via `CreateEnvironmentAPIRequest` and processed by `CreateEnvironmentAPISystem`.

7.1 The request component

`CreateEnvironmentAPIRequest` : `IComponentData` contains:

- `UnityEngine.ObjectRef<EnvironmentAPIConfigAssetBase> ConfigAsset;`

7.2 The system that fulfills the request

`CreateEnvironmentAPISystem` (runs in `InitializationSystemGroup`, before `HexTerrainsInitGroup`) does:

1. Finds entities with `CreateEnvironmentAPIRequest` and *without* `EnvironmentAPIComponent`
2. Reads `request.ConfigAsset.Value`
3. Calls `apiConfig.CreateAPI(EntityManager, entity)`
4. Adds:
 - `EnvironmentAPIComponent { Value = environmentAPI }`
 - `EnvironmentAPIEntity` marker
5. Removes `CreateEnvironmentAPIRequest` so it only runs once per entity

Implication: to customize environment behavior, you typically customize the *config asset* used by the request.

8) Providing a custom IEnvironmentAPI

You customize environment API creation via a `ScriptableObject` derived from `EnvironmentAPIConfigAssetBase`.

8.1 What EnvironmentAPIConfigAssetBase does by default

- `CreateAPI(...)` creates new `EnvironmentAPI()` and calls:
 - `Init(entityManager, GetUISystemAPI(entityManager), apiEntity)`
- `GetUISystemAPI(entityManager)` is abstract, so every project must decide how to provide the UI API instance.

8.2 Customization options

Option A: Override only `GetUISystemAPI(...)`

Use this when you want the default `EnvironmentAPI` behavior, but must provide another UI API implementation.

Option B: Override `CreateAPI(...)`

Use this when you want a different environment API implementation:

- subclass `EnvironmentAPI` (recommended when you just extend behavior), or
- implement `IEnvironmentAPI` from scratch

8.3 Example config asset overriding CreateAPI(...)

Below is a minimal pattern you can adapt (the UI acquisition is project-specific):

```
// In your project (example)
using Fwt.Core.UI.Screens;
using Fwt.HexTerrains;
using Fwt.HexTerrains.Data;
using Unity.Entities;
using UnityEngine;

[CreateAssetMenu(menuName = "HexTerrains/Environment API Config (Custom)")]
public sealed class CustomEnvironmentAPIConfigAsset : EnvironmentAPIConfigAssetBase
{
    public override IEnvironmentAPI CreateAPI(EntityManager entityManager, Entity apiEntity)
    {
        var api = new CustomEnvironmentAPI();
        api.Init(entityManager, GetUISystemAPI(entityManager), apiEntity);
        return api;
    }

    public override IUISystemAPI GetUISystemAPI(EntityManager entityManager)
    {
        // Resolve your UI system API here (project-specific).
        // Typically: query a singleton component, a world-managed service, etc.
        return default;
    }

    private sealed class CustomEnvironmentAPI : EnvironmentAPI
    {
        // Override / extend behavior as needed:
        // - SaveTerrain / LoadTerrain (custom callbacks)
        // - CreateNewTerrain pipeline
        // - custom UI screen management
    }
}
```

8.4 Wiring it up at runtime

To activate your config, create an entity (or choose an existing "environment/bootstrap" entity) and add:

- `CreateEnvironmentAPIRequest { ConfigAsset = <your asset ref> }`

`CreateEnvironmentAPISystem` will attach the resulting API to that entity as `EnvironmentAPIComponent`.

9) Practical interaction examples (using HexTerrainAPI)

Example 1: Read/Write a cell height

Conceptually (pseudo-flow):

1. Determine a target cell index (from cursor raycast, selection, etc.)
2. Use `HexTerrainAPI.SetCellHeight(...)` to write into a specific `ChunkMeshLayer`
3. Downstream systems react because the underlying data layer is marked dirty

```
// Example usage pattern (pseudo-code):
var cellIndex = environmentApi.GetCellIndexUnderCursor(terrainEntity);
if (cellIndex.HasValue)
{
    // Choose the target mesh layer inside a layer group by name/index:
    var layerRef = HexTerrainLayerReference.ByLayerName("Surface");
    hexTerrainApi.SetCellHeight<MyChunkMeshLayerGroup, ChunkMeshLayer>(
        cellIndex.Value,
        layerRef,
        value: 5.0f
    );
}
```

Example 2: Toggle visibility of a visual mesh layer

```
var layerRef = HexTerrainLayerReference.ByLayerName("Water");
var isVisible = hexTerrainApi.GetChunkMeshLayerVisibility<MyChunkMeshLayerGroup, VisualChunk
MeshLayer>(layerRef);
if (isVisible.HasValue)
{
    hexTerrainApi.SetChunkMeshVisibility<MyChunkMeshLayerGroup, VisualChunkMeshLayer>(layerR
ef, !isVisible.Value);
}
```

Example 3: Read terrain settings safely

```
var settings = hexTerrainApi.GetTerrainSettings();
if (settings.HasValue)
{
    // settings.Value.TerrainSize, settings.Value.ChunkSize, etc.
}
```

10) When to use IEnvironmentAPI vs IHexTerrainAPI

Use IEnvironmentAPI when:

- you have a `terrainEntity` and need general operations (save/load, resize, raycast-under-cursor, view mode, UI screens)

Use IHexTerrainAPI when:

- you are writing tool/brush-style code and want compact helpers for "set cell value in layer X"
- you want logic that is naturally scoped to "the current terrain"

In many tool flows:

- IEnvironmentAPI determines *what cell is targeted* (raycast/cursor)
 - IHexTerrainAPI mutates *the data inside a specific terrain layer*
-

Chunks Grid System

The Hex Terrains Framework divides the terrain into **chunks** to enable efficient rendering, visibility culling, and simulation scaling. The **Chunks Grid System** manages the lifecycle, visibility state, and dynamic spatial organization of these chunks.

Overview

Each terrain is split into a grid of chunks. This system ensures:

- Only **visible chunks** are rendered or in some cases even updated.
- Chunks can dynamically adjust their **transform offsets** for seamless terrain tiling.
- Simulation and rendering can be constrained to **active areas** based on camera visibility.

Core Concepts

ChunksGridLayer

A component that stores all spatial data related to chunk organization and visibility. It holds:

- Chunk settings (dimensions, count, etc.)
- Visibility flags per chunk (`ChunkVisibility`)
- Chunk metrics (`ChunkMetrics`)
- Dirty flags for dependency management and selective updating

Added on Terrain Entity by `CreateChunksGridLayerSystem`

ChunkBounds

Each chunk tracks 9 bounds:

- `Bounds_Center` — actual location
- `Bounds_{Direction}` — adjacent bounds used for edge wrapping

These enable neighborhood queries and visual interpolation across chunk edges.

ChunkVisibility

Stores per-chunk visibility information:

- `IsVisible` — true if inside camera frustum
- `VisualPosition` — where the chunk is currently rendered (may differ from actual world position if terrain wraps)
- `ChunkOffset` — logical offset used for virtual terrain scrolling
- `Transform` — final transform matrix applied to the chunk renderer

Lifecycle Systems

CreateChunksGridLayerSystem

- Group: CreateHexTerrainsGroup
- Automatically adds ChunksGridLayer component to any entity with CreateChunksGridLayerRequest
- Initializes chunk data using terrain settings

```
chunksGridData.Init(request.Settings);
```

CalcChunkVisibilitySystem

- Group: HexTerrainsUpdateGroup
- Recalculates visible chunks each frame based on camera frustum
- Stores new visibility states in ChunkVisibility per chunk
- Uses a CalcHexChunkVisibilityJob to run visibility culling in parallel

```
var job = new CalcHexChunkVisibilityJob {  
    // Assign metrics, frustum, visibility maps...  
};  
job.Schedule(terrainSettings.ChunksCount, 16, combinedDeps);
```

This system is the core of **terrain culling and selective rendering**.

CleanupChunksGridLayerSystem

- Group: HexTerrainsCleanupGroup
- Calls CleanupAsync() on ChunksGridLayer when terrain is visible
- Happens at the beginning of the frame before other systems. Cleans all the dirty flags collected during last frame

Authoring Support

The CreateChunksGridLayerRequest is added on baked Terrain Entity by HexTerrainBaker during baking the HexTerrainAuthoring.

Execution Order Summary

System	Group	Purpose
CreateChunksGridLayerSystem	CreateHexTerrainsGroup	Initializes chunks on terrain load
CalcChunkVisibilitySystem	HexTerrainsUpdateGroup	Recomputes which chunks are visible
CleanupChunksGridLayerSystem	HexTerrainsCleanupGroup	Cleans up chunk data when no longer needed

Chunk Mesh Layers

This document explains the **Chunk Mesh** feature in HexTerrains: how `ChunkMeshLayer` stores per-cell surface data, how `VisualChunkMeshLayer` turns that data into chunk meshes, how `ChunkMeshLayerGroup` orchestrates multiple mesh layers, what specialized mesh layers exist (Surface/Water/Clouds/Roads/Rain), which **jobs** generate mesh geometry and biome color maps, and how to implement a new chunk mesh layer (using Clouds as the reference model).

1 What “Chunk Mesh” means in HexTerrains

HexTerrains renders terrain as a grid of **chunks**, where each chunk contains a fixed-size rectangle of hex cells. A **chunk mesh layer** is responsible for:

1. Holding per-cell surface data (height, biome, transparency)
2. Converting that data into per-cell **metrics** (`HexCellMetrics`)
3. Scheduling mesh generation jobs per **dirty + visible** chunk
4. Producing `Mesh` objects and rendering them with one or more materials

The architecture separates data from visuals:

- `ChunkMeshLayer` = **data & metrics** (height/biome/transparency/cell metrics + biome color map)
 - `VisualChunkMeshLayer` = **mesh sources, meshes, render settings, render loop**
 - Specialized layers (Clouds/Water/Roads/Rain) override only the **mesh generator job** while reusing the same pipeline.
-

2 Key classes and responsibilities

2.1 `ChunkMeshLayer` (data + metrics)

`ChunkMeshLayer` (`HexTerrainLayer` , `ISerializableTerrainLayer`) owns the fundamental per-cell maps:

- `HeightMap` : `ColorMapCellValueDataLayer_Float`
- `BiomeMap` : `ColorMapCellValueDataLayer_Int`
- `TransparencyMap` : `CellValueDataLayer<bool>`
- `CellMetricsMap` : `CellMetricsDataLayer`
- `TerrainMetrics` : `HexTerrainMetrics`

It also supports synchronization from another layer:

- `SyncHeightMapLayerReference`
- `SyncBiomeMapLayerReference`
- `SyncTransparencyMapLayerReference`

Auto-biome painting (Height → Biome)

When initialized with `IChunkMeshLayerConfig` and `IsAutoPaintBiomes = true` , `ChunkMeshLayer.Init<TInitArgs>` calls:

- `FillBiomeByHeight(biomeMap, heightMap, AutoPaintBiomesLevels)`
- which uses `GetAutoBiomeHeightLevel(height, levels)` (descending threshold match)

This means biome indices can be derived entirely from the height map without a custom biome generation job.

2.2 VisualChunkMeshLayer (mesh sources + meshes + rendering)

`VisualChunkMeshLayer` : `ChunkMeshLayer` adds everything required to **generate** and **render** meshes:

- `RenderSettings` : `ChunkMeshRenderSettings`
- `ChunkMeshSources` : `ChunkMeshSourcesDataLayer` (One `MeshSource` per chunk)
- `ChunkMeshes` : `ChunkMeshesDataLayer` (one Unity `Mesh` per chunk)
- `BiomeUvConfigs` : `NativeList<ChunkMeshBiomeUVConfig>` (atlas rects)
- `RenderConfigs` : `List<HexSurfaceRenderConfigAsset>` (per view mode)
- `DefaultRenderConfig` : `HexSurfaceRenderConfigAsset`
- `IsVisible`
- `OffsetTransform` (typically height offset via `RenderSettings.HeightOffset`)

MeshSource and why it exists

Mesh generation runs in jobs, so it cannot safely write Unity `Mesh` directly. Instead jobs write into a Burst-friendly container:

- `MeshSource` (from `com.freewebtime.core`) stores vertices, normals, colors, UVs (4 channels), indices (up to 16 submeshes), plus bounds.
- After the job finishes, the main thread converts `MeshSource` → Unity `Mesh`.

`ChunkMeshSourcesDataLayer` additionally tracks:

- `GeneratedMeshIndexes` : `NativeList<int>` (which chunks finished generation this frame)
- Dirty chunk flags (`DirtyChunks`, `ChunkDirtyGrid` inherited from chunked data layer base)

Two mesh upload modes

`VisualChunkMeshLayer` supports two ways to upload mesh data:

1. **Classic**: `MeshSource.FillMesh(mesh, ...)` on main thread
(`CreateChunkMeshes_Classic`)
2. **MeshData path**: allocate `MeshDataArray`, fill it using `FillMeshDataJob`, then apply via:
`Mesh.ApplyAndDisposeWritableMeshData(...)`
(`CreateChunkMeshes_MeshData` + `CompleteFillingMeshes`)

Which path is used is controlled by:

- `IsGenerateMeshesWithMeshData`
 - and the `ChunkMeshSources.MeshSourceMode` is set accordingly (`SeparatedData` vs `CombinedData`)
-

2.3 ChunkMeshLayerGroup (orchestration across multiple layers)

ChunkMeshLayerGroup : HexTerrainLayerGroup<ChunkMeshLayer>, IComponentData is a container for multiple chunk mesh layers and exposes a common pipeline:

- SyncData(dependency) → calls layer.SyncData for each
- CalcCellMetrics(dependency) → calls layer.CalcCellMetrics for each
- CalcDirtyMeshSources(dependency) → for each VisualChunkMeshLayer, maps dirty metrics → dirty chunk mesh sources
- CalcMeshSources(chunksGridLayer, dependency) → schedules per-chunk mesh generation jobs
- CreateChunkMeshes() → uploads meshes
- Render(chunksGridLayer, viewMode, terrainTransform, camera) → draws meshes

Layer creation is factory-driven via CreateChunkMeshLayerRequest and the config asset's CreateTerrainLayer().

3 The Chunk Mesh update pipeline (end-to-end)

A typical frame/update pipeline is:

1. Sync maps (optional)

- ChunkMeshLayer.SyncData() calls:
 - SyncHeightMap()
 - SyncBiomeMap()
 - SyncTransparencyMap()
- Each uses SyncDataLayersMapJob<T> and merges dirty chunk grids.

2. Recalculate HexCellMetrics

- ChunkMeshLayer.CalcCellMetrics(dependency) schedules CalcHexCellMetricsJob
- Inputs:
 - HeightMap, BiomeMap, TransparencyMap
- Output:
 - CellMetricsMap + CellPositions
- Transparency can be forced by ChunkMeshLayerSettings.UseHeightTresholdForTransparency + HeightTresholdForTransparency.

3. Map dirty metrics → dirty chunk mesh sources

- VisualChunkMeshLayer.CalcDirtyMeshSources(dependency) merges dirty grids from:
 - CellMetricsMap and TransparencyMap
- Marks ChunkMeshSources dirty per chunk.

4. Generate mesh sources for dirty + visible chunks

- VisualChunkMeshLayer.CalcMeshSources(chunksGridLayer, isCalcAllMeshes, dependency) :
 - iterates over chunksGridLayer.VisibleChunks
 - schedules ScheduleGenerateMeshJob(...) per chunk
 - tracks generated chunks in ChunkMeshSources.GeneratedMeshIndexes

5. Upload meshes to Unity

- VisualChunkMeshLayer.CreateChunkMeshes() :
 - classic or MeshData path
 - clears GeneratedMeshIndexes

6. Render

- `VisualChunkMeshLayer.Render(...)` :
 - fetches `HexSurfaceRenderConfigAsset` by view mode
 - uses `Graphics.DrawMesh` per chunk and per material/submesh

Visibility culling comes from `ChunksGridLayer` (not a mesh layer). It computes `ChunkVisibility` and `VisibleChunks` using the camera frustum.

4 Specialized `VisualChunkMeshLayer` implementations

All specialized layers share the same pipeline, but override **which job** generates mesh geometry.

4.1 Surface (default) — `VisualChunkMeshLayer` + `GenerateSurfaceChunkMeshJob`

If you use `VisualChunkMeshLayer` directly, mesh generation is:

- `VisualChunkMeshLayer.ScheduleGenerateMeshJob(...)` → schedules `GenerateSurfaceChunkMeshJob`

Characteristics:

- Skips `HexCellMetrics.IsTransparent` cells
- Generates:
 - a central “plato” (top surface)
 - “bridges” between cells
- Supports:
 - colored borders (`ChunkMeshRenderSettings.IsColoredBorders`)
 - slope threshold border painting (`ColoredSlopeTreshold`)
 - biome atlas mode (`IsUseBiomeAtlas`)

4.2 Water — `WaterChunkMeshLayer` + `GenerateWaterChunkMeshJob`

`WaterChunkMeshLayer` : `VisualChunkMeshLayer` schedules:

- `GenerateWaterChunkMeshJob`

Notable behavior differences in the job:

- Handles transparency differently (water surface can still produce bridge geometry depending on neighbor transparency/height logic)
- Still uses the same UV channel layout and border logic concepts

Config asset:

- `WaterChunkMeshLayerConfigAsset` : `VisualChunkMeshLayerConfigAsset`

4.3 Clouds — CloudsChunkMeshLayer + GenerateCloudsChunkMeshJob

CloudsChunkMeshLayer : VisualChunkMeshLayer schedules:

- GenerateCloudsChunkMeshJob

Adds CloudRenderSettings :

- Thickness scaling (CloudThickness , MaxCellHeight)
- Optional “pillow” scaling threshold (CloudScaleTreshold)
- Optional bottom side rendering (IsDrawBottomSide)

Config asset:

- CloudsChunkMeshLayerConfigAsset : VisualChunkMeshLayerConfigAsset, ICloudsChunkMeshLayerConfig

4.4 Rain — RainChunkMeshLayer + GenerateRainChunkMeshJob

RainChunkMeshLayer : VisualChunkMeshLayer schedules:

- GenerateRainChunkMeshJob

Adds RainRenderSettings :

- Rain plane height (RainHeight)
- Thickness based on normalized cell height (MaxCellHeight)

Config asset:

- RainChunkMeshLayerConfigAsset : VisualChunkMeshLayerConfigAsset, IRainChunkMeshLayerConfig

4.5 Roads — RoadsChunkMeshLayer + GenerateRoadsChunkMeshJob

RoadsChunkMeshLayer : VisualChunkMeshLayer schedules:

- GenerateRoadsChunkMeshJob

Adds HexRoadsRenderSettings :

- Road width (RoadThickness)
- UV scaling for road tiling (RoadsTileScalePlato , RoadsTileScaleBridge)
- Optional height threshold to skip road connections across steep steps (IsUseHeightTreshold , HeightTreshold)

Important detail: the roads job uses multiple submeshes by design:

- submesh 0 = background / base
- submesh 1 = road geometry

Config asset:

- RoadsChunkMeshLayerConfigAsset : VisualChunkMeshLayerConfigAsset, IRoadsChunkMeshLayerConfig

5 Mesh generation jobs (what they do)

Each `Generate*ChunkMeshJob` follows the same high-level structure:

1. Validate that `MeshSource` is initialized.
2. `MeshSource.Clear()`
3. Loop over cells within `ChunkMetrics.ChunkSize_Cells`
4. Convert local chunk cell position → global `cellIndex`
5. Read `HexCellMetrics` and decide whether to generate geometry
6. Emit vertices/triangles into `MeshSource`
7. Compute UVs and assign triangles into submeshes

5.1 Common inputs

All mesh jobs are given (directly or indirectly):

- `HexTerrainSettings TerrainSettings`
- `HexTerrainMetrics TerrainMetrics`
- `ChunkMeshRenderSettings RenderSettings`
- `HexChunkMetrics ChunkMetrics` (the current chunk)
- `NativeList<HexCellMetrics> CellMetrics` (the whole terrain metrics array)
- `NativeList<ChunkMeshBiomeUVConfig> BiomeUVs`
- UV channel indices:
 - `UvChannelCell` (usually 0)
 - `UvChannelChunk` (usually 1)
 - `UvChannelTerrain` (usually 2)
 - `UvChannelCoord` (usually 3)

5.2 UV channel semantics (as implemented by the jobs)

Jobs compute multiple UV sets so materials can choose which mapping to use:

- **UV0 ("cell")**: maps the hex into its biome atlas rect (or 0..1 if atlas disabled)
- **UV1 ("chunk")**: maps the entire chunk area to 0..1
- **UV2 ("terrain")**: maps the entire terrain area to 0..1
- **UV3 ("cellCoord")**: encodes cell coordinate as UV, useful for data textures / lookups

5.3 Submesh strategy: atlas vs per-biome

In surface/water/clouds/rain jobs:

- If `RenderSettings.IsUseBiomeAtlas == true`:
 - geometry typically goes to **submesh 0** (single material, atlas-driven UVs)
- If `IsUseBiomeAtlas == false`:
 - submesh index is commonly `cellMetrics.Biome` (one submesh per biome/material slot)

In roads job:

- submesh allocation is specialized (base vs roads) regardless of biome.

5.4 Deep dive: how `GenerateCloudsChunkMeshJob` generates meshes (and what it teaches about all generators)

`GenerateCloudsChunkMeshJob` is one of the best references for understanding how mesh generation works in the framework because it combines:

- the standard “surface-like” hex meshing flow (`plato` + `bridges`)
- feature-specific geometry rules (cloud thickness + “pillow” scaling)
- optional double-sided geometry (top + bottom) using triangle winding

This section walks through the job step-by-step and points out what is shared with `GenerateSurfaceChunkMeshJob` , `GenerateWaterChunkMeshJob` , etc.

5.4.1 Input data: where `HexCellMetrics` comes from

Mesh jobs do **not** read `HeightMap` / `BiomeMap` directly. They read `HexCellMetrics` , which is produced earlier by `CalcHexCellMetricsJob` (via `ChunkMeshLayer.CalcCellMetrics(...)`).

`HexCellMetrics` contains (among other things):

- `CenterPoint_Local` (x/z in chunk-local space)
- `CellHeight_Points` and `CellHeight_Units`
- `Biome`
- `IsTransparent`
- `CellCoord_Global` / `ChunkCoord` / `ChunkIndex`

That’s why all mesh jobs accept:

- `HexChunkMetrics ChunkMetrics` (chunk-local basis)
- `NativeList<HexCellMetrics> CellMetrics` (global per-cell array)

5.4.2 The outer loop: generate one chunk’s mesh

All chunk mesh jobs start the same way:

- early out if `!MeshData.IsInitialized()`
- `MeshData.Clear()`
- iterate all cells within the chunk bounds
- compute global `cellIndex` from `ChunkMetrics.ChunkPosition_Cells` and `TerrainMetrics.TerrainSize_Cells.x`

For clouds specifically, the job skips cells when:

- `cellMetrics.IsTransparent` **or**
- `cellMetrics.CellHeight_Points <= 0f`

That second condition is cloud-specific: clouds are “born” only above a baseline height.

5.4.3 Per-cell meshing: `DrawCell`

`DrawCell` is the standard “one cell → some triangles” entry point.

For clouds it renders:

- Top side:

- DrawCellPlato(cell, isInverted: false)
- DrawCellBridges(cell, isInverted: false)
- Optional bottom side (if CloudsRenderSettings.IsDrawBottomSide):
 - DrawCellPlato(cell, isInverted: true)
 - DrawCellBridges(cell, isInverted: true)

This single pattern explains two important conventions used across the framework:

1. **Cell is the unit of generation** (each job “stamps” geometry per cell).
2. **Connectedness is handled during bridge/corner generation**, not by a global triangulation step.

5.4.4 Cloud thickness: how Y is chosen

Unlike the surface job (which uses `cellMetrics.CellHeight_Units` for Y), clouds use a computed thickness:

- CalculateCloudThickness(cellMetrics, isInverted)

Implementation idea:

- Start with `CloudsRenderSettings.CloudThickness`
- Scale by normalized height:
 - `clamp(cellMetrics.CellHeight_Points / CloudsRenderSettings.MaxCellHeight, 0..1)`
- If `isInverted == true`, thickness becomes negative so the bottom side is below zero.

This is why clouds look volumetric: the “top surface” is at `+thickness`, and the optional “bottom surface” is at `-thickness`.

5.4.5 Cloud scale (“pillow” effect): how the hex radius is modified

Clouds also change the **radius** of the generated hex surface per cell:

- CalculateCloudScale(cellMetrics):
 - `clamp(cellHeightPoints / CloudScaleTreshold, 0..1)` (or 1 if threshold is 0)

That scale affects:

- `platoSize` (top hex size)
- cell corner positions used for bridges
- whether two adjacent cloud cells are treated as “connected”

In `DrawCellBridges`, a neighbor is treated as connected when:

- neighbor is not transparent
- neighbor scale ≥ 1
- current cell scale ≥ 1

If a neighbor is **not** connected, the job intentionally collapses some bridge/corner heights to 0f. This creates the characteristic “puffy edge” instead of a hard bridge to an absent neighbor.

5.4.6 Plato generation: “fan triangulation” around the center

`DrawCellPlato` creates a simple triangulated hex disk:

1. Add a **center vertex** (position at `centerPos`, Y at `cloudThickness`)
2. Loop 6 corners:

- compute corner positions with `HexMath.HexCornerPosition(centerPos, platoSize, cornerIndex, ...)`
- add two corner vertices per side
- add one triangle connecting `center` → `cornerRight` → `cornerLeft`

The important parts shared with the surface/water/rain jobs:

- Plato is always a **center + 6 triangle fan**.
- UVs are computed per-vertex via helper functions:
 - `CalculateUvCell` / `CalculateUvChunk` / `CalculateUvTerrain` / `CalculateUvCellCoord`
- Submesh selection follows atlas vs non-atlas rule:
 - `submeshIndexCenter = RenderSettings.IsUseBiomeAtlas ? 0 : cellMetrics.Biome`

Cloud-specific part: **inverted triangle winding**

When `isInverted == true`, the job flips the triangle index order so normals point downward. This is the simplest, cheapest way to render a back-facing “bottom surface” without special shader tricks.

5.4.7 Bridge generation: connecting two cells (or fading out)

Bridges are the “skirts” connecting cell platos, and they are also what hides gaps between different heights.

In clouds, `DrawCellBridges` :

- computes corner positions on the current cell
- queries adjacent cell metrics using `CalcAdjacentCellData(...)`
- computes “target” points in the neighbor cell to bridge toward
- creates triangles for:
 - the bridge face between the two cells
 - the corner triangles between bridges (to fill the diagonal gaps)

Cloud-specific behavior:

- If `isNeighbourConnected == false`, some bridge points have their Y forced to `0f`, which prevents a full bridge and produces a soft edge.
- Plato size on neighbor can differ (neighbor scale affects its corner positions), so the bridge aligns with a scaled neighbor plato.

Shared behavior with `GenerateSurfaceChunkMeshJob` and `GenerateWaterChunkMeshJob` :

- Ground/border selection uses the same logic pattern:
 - `CalculateGroundType_Bridge(...)`
 - `CalculateGroundType_BridgeCorner(...)`
- Those functions use:
 - `RenderSettings.IsColoredBorders`
 - `RenderSettings.ColoredSlopeTreshold`
 - `RenderSettings.BorderSubmeshIndex`
 - biome equality checks
- Submesh index is either:
 - `0` (atlas)
 - or biome-derived index (non-atlas)

Also note: outside-of-terrain adjacency is handled in `GetAdjacentCellMetrics(...)`. When a neighbor cell is outside the terrain, it is treated as a “missing” cell with very low height, which prevents accidental high bridges across terrain borders.

5.4.8 UV atlas: how biomes map into `ChunkMeshBiomeUVConfig`

All jobs that support atlas mode use the same idea:

- `ChunkMeshBiomeUVConfig.Value` is a `float4` :
 - `xy` = `minUV`
 - `zw` = `maxUV`

`CalculateUvCell(...)` maps a vertex position into a normalized 0..1 cell space, then remaps into the biome's UV rect:

- $uv = \text{normalized} * (\text{max} - \text{min}) + \text{min}$

This mechanism is shared across `GenerateSurfaceChunkMeshJob`, `GenerateWaterChunkMeshJob`, `GenerateRainChunkMeshJob`, and `GenerateCloudsChunkMeshJob`.

5.5 How the other generators compare (quick mental model)

Use this mapping when reading other mesh jobs:

- `GenerateSurfaceChunkMeshJob`
 - **Y**: `cellMetrics.CellHeight_Units`
 - **Radius**: standard hex radius (no scale)
 - **Skip**: transparent cells
 - **Bridges**: connect to neighbor heights; optional colored borders.
 - `GenerateWaterChunkMeshJob`
 - **Y**: based on water cell height, but bridges are generated even when one side is transparent.
 - **Key difference**: special handling of transparent neighbors to avoid holes at the shoreline.
 - `GenerateRainChunkMeshJob`
 - **Y**: constant `RainRenderSettings.RainHeight` (a plane)
 - **Radius**: scaled by `CalculateRainThickness(cell)` to vary coverage
 - **Skip**: transparent cells
 - **Bridges**: used to connect partial rain coverage; includes logic to skip when neighbor also has "full" rain thickness.
 - `GenerateRoadsChunkMeshJob`
 - **Submeshes**: explicitly uses submesh `0` for base and `1` for roads (not biome-driven)
 - **UV0**: not a biome atlas rect; it encodes road-specific tiling coordinates
 - **Connectivity rules**: avoids drawing road segments to transparent neighbors and can enforce a height threshold.
-

6 Biome Color Map: how it is generated

Biome "color map" here refers to `BiomeMap.ColorMap` (a `Color32` per cell) used for visualization/materials that sample a texture-like map.

`ChunkMeshLayer.CalculateColorMap(dependency)` does:

- `HeightMap.CalculateColorMap(...)`
- `CalculateBiomeColorMap(...)`

6.1 Default biome color map (CalcDefaultChunkMeshColorMapJob)

Scheduled by `CalculateDefaultBiomeColorMap(...)` when:

- `CellMetricsMap.IsDirty == true`
- and `BiomeMap.ColorMap.ColorPalette` is created

Job behavior:

- Only processes cells in dirty chunks (`ChunkDirtyGrid`)
- If `HexCellMetrics.IsTransparent` → writes `DefaultColor`
- Else → writes `ColorPalette[HexCellMetrics.Biome]` (if within palette bounds)

6.2 Overlapping biome color map (CalcOverlappingChunkMeshColorMapJob)

Scheduled by `CalculateOverlapBiomeColorMap(overlappingLayer, ...)` when:

- current layer or overlapping layer `CellMetricsMap` is dirty
- overlapping is enabled via `ChunkMeshLayerSettings.HasOverlappingLayer` + reference

Job behavior:

- Only paints a cell if:
 - current cell is not transparent
 - AND `myCellMetrics.CellHeight_Points > otherCellMetrics.CellHeight_Points`
- Otherwise the cell becomes "not painted" (default color), effectively hiding this layer where another layer is higher.

This is used to stack surfaces (e.g., water under terrain, or secondary overlays).

7 Configuration assets (what to create in Unity)

7.1 Base config: ChunkMeshLayerConfigAsset

Creates `ChunkMeshLayer` (data-only) and configures:

- init args for:
 - `HeightMapArgs`
 - `BiomeMapArgs`
 - `TransparencyMapArgs`
- `IsAutoPaintBiomes` + `AutoPaintBiomesLevels`
- `ChunkMeshLayerSettings`
- sync references (`SyncHeightMapLayerReference` , etc.)

7.2 Visual config: VisualChunkMeshLayerConfigAsset

Creates `VisualChunkMeshLayer` and adds:

- `IsVisible`
- `RenderSettings` : `ChunkMeshRenderSettings`

- `RenderConfigs` (per view mode) + `DefaultRenderConfig`
- `BiomeUvs` : `List<Sprite>`
Converted to `BiomeUVConfigs` (sprite UV rects) used when `RenderSettings.IsUseBiomeAtlas` is enabled.

7.3 Specialized visual configs

- `CloudsChunkMeshLayerConfigAsset` → creates `CloudsChunkMeshLayer`
 - `RoadsChunkMeshLayerConfigAsset` → creates `RoadsChunkMeshLayer`
 - `RainChunkMeshLayerConfigAsset` → creates `RainChunkMeshLayer`
 - `WaterChunkMeshLayerConfigAsset` → creates `WaterChunkMeshLayer`
-

8 Creating a new `VisualChunkMeshLayer` (Clouds-based example)

This is the standard extension model in this codebase:

1. **Create render settings** (a struct) for your feature.
2. **Create a mesh generation job** (`IJob`) that writes to `MeshSource` .
3. **Create a new layer** deriving from `VisualChunkMeshLayer` and override `ScheduleGenerateMeshJob` .
4. **Create a config interface + ScriptableObject asset** that supplies settings and returns the layer from `CreateTerrainLayer()` .

8.1 Minimal layer implementation pattern

Use `CloudsChunkMeshLayer` as the template:

- Store settings (e.g., `MyEffectRenderSettings`)
- In `Init<TInitArgs>` , read them from a config interface
- In `ScheduleGenerateMeshJob` , create and schedule your `GenerateMyEffectChunkMeshJob`

Example shape (documentation snippet only):

```

public class MyEffectChunkMeshLayer : VisualChunkMeshLayer
{
    public MyEffectRenderSettings MySettings = MyEffectRenderSettings.Default;

    public override void Init<TInitArgs>(HexTerrainSettings settings, TInitArgs initArgs)
    {
        base.Init(settings, initArgs);

        if (initArgs is IMyEffectChunkMeshLayerConfig cfg)
        {
            MySettings = cfg.MyEffectRenderSettings;
        }
    }

    public override JobHandle ScheduleGenerateMeshJob(
        ChunkMetricsDataLayer chunkMetrics,
        ChunkMeshSourcesDataLayer chunkMeshSources,
        CellMetricsDataLayer cellMetrics,
        int chunkIndex,
        JobHandle dependency
    )
    {
        var terrainSettings = Settings;
        if (RenderSettings.IsOverrideSlopeSize)
        {
            terrainSettings.SlopeSize = RenderSettings.OverrideSlopeSize;
        }

        var job = new GenerateMyEffectChunkMeshJob
        {
            ChunkIndex = chunkIndex,
            ChunkMetrics = chunkMetrics.Data[chunkIndex],
            CellMetrics = cellMetrics.Data,
            MeshData = chunkMeshSources.Data[chunkIndex],
            TerrainMetrics = TerrainMetrics,
            TerrainSettings = terrainSettings,
            RenderSettings = RenderSettings,
            BiomeUVs = BiomeUvConfigs,
            UvChannelCell = 0,
            UvChannelChunk = 1,
            UvChannelTerrain = 2,
            UvChannelCoord = 3,
            MySettings = MySettings,
        };

        return job.Schedule(dependency);
    }
}

```

8.2 Job implementation guidance

A new mesh job should:

- Call `MeshData.Clear()`
- Iterate chunk cells using `ChunkMetrics.ChunkSize_Cells` and `ChunkMetrics.ChunkPosition_Cells`
- Skip cells based on:
 - transparency
 - height thresholds
 - your feature's settings (like Clouds scale threshold)
- Use `MeshData.AddVertex(...)` and `MeshData.AddTriangle(submesh, i0, i1, i2)`
- Compute UV sets using the same semantics as existing jobs to keep materials consistent

The Clouds job is a good reference because it shows:

- feature-specific thickness/scale calculations
- optional inverted rendering (bottom side)
- how to keep atlas-compatible UV generation

8.3 Hooking it into the terrain

To actually use the new layer:

- Create a config asset (derive from `VisualChunkMeshLayerConfigAsset`)
- Override `CreateTerrainLayer()` to return `new MyEffectChunkMeshLayer()`
- Add that config to whatever system builds a `ChunkMeshLayerGroup` (via `CreateChunkMeshLayerRequest` pipeline)

9 Practical notes and common pitfalls

- **Dirty propagation is mandatory:** if your simulation modifies `HeightMap` / `BiomeMap` / `TransparencyMap`, ensure the relevant data layers are marked dirty so `CalcCellMetrics` and mesh regeneration runs.
- **Mesh generation runs only for dirty + visible chunks** by default. If you "changed something" and see no update, verify:
 - chunk is visible (`ChunksGridLayer.VisibleChunks`)
 - chunk was marked dirty in `ChunkMeshSources.DirtyChunks`
- **Atlas mode** (`RenderSettings.IsUseBiomeAtlas`) changes submesh usage. Make sure your materials and `HexSurfaceRenderConfigAsset` match the chosen strategy.
- **Roads are special:** they intentionally use dedicated submeshes for base/roads; don't assume `submesh == biome`.

Quick reference: Provided chunk mesh layers and their generator jobs

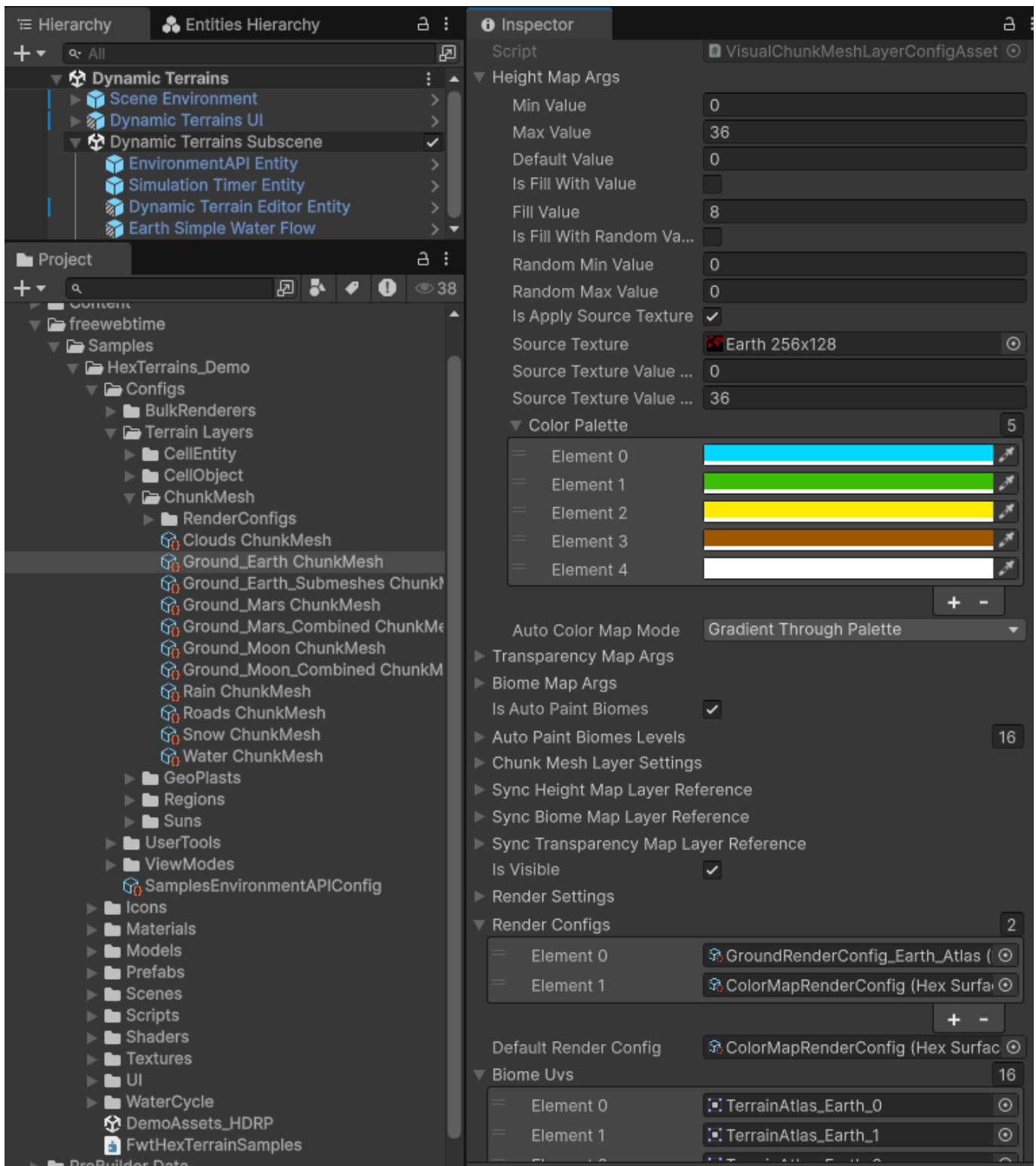
Layer class	Job	Extra settings
<code>VisualChunkMeshLayer</code> (Surface)	<code>GenerateSurfaceChunkMeshJob</code>	<code>ChunkMeshRenderSettings</code>

Layer class	Job	Extra settings
WaterChunkMeshLayer	GenerateWaterChunkMeshJob	ChunkMeshRenderSettings
CloudsChunkMeshLayer	GenerateCloudsChunkMeshJob	CloudsRenderSettings
RainChunkMeshLayer	GenerateRainChunkMeshJob	RainRenderSettings
RoadsChunkMeshLayer	GenerateRoadsChunkMeshJob	HexRoadsRenderSettings

Biome color map jobs:

- Default: CalcDefaultChunkMeshColorMapJob
- Overlap: CalcOverlappingChunkMeshColorMapJob
- Metrics: CalcHexCellMetricsJob
- MeshData upload: FillMeshDataJob

ChunkMeshLayerConfigAsset



ChunkMeshLayerConfigAsset is a Unity ScriptableObject used as *both*:

1. A **terrain-layer factory** (it implements `ITerrainLayerFactory` via `HexTerrainLayerConfigAsset<T>`), and
2. A **layer initialization/config payload** (it implements `IChunkMeshLayerConfig`).

It configures how a `ChunkMeshLayer` (and derived layers) initialize their internal data layers:

- height per cell (HeightMap)
- biome per cell (BiomeMap)
- transparency per cell (TransparencyMap)
- optional auto-biome painting from height
- optional data syncing from other layers
- optional overlap/transparency rules

Where/how this config is used during terrain initialization

Terrain layers are commonly hosted inside a `HexTerrainLayerGroup<TTerrainLayer>` . During initialization, the group:

- iterates the provided init-args list (often a list of config assets),
- creates the runtime layer instance using `ITerrainLayerFactory` (if implemented),
- then calls `layer.Init(settings, initArgs)` to apply the config.

Key implementation detail:

- `HexTerrainLayerGroup<TTerrainLayer>.CreateTerrainLayer(initArgs) :`
 - if `initArgs` is `ITerrainLayerFactory` , it calls `factory.CreateTerrainLayer<TTerrainLayer>()`
 - otherwise it uses `Activator.CreateInstance<TTerrainLayer>()`
- `ChunkMeshLayer.Init(settings, initArgs) :`
 - checks `initArgs` is `IChunkMeshLayerConfig`
 - copies settings/references
 - initializes height/biome/transparency maps from the provided init args
 - optionally auto-paints biomes based on height thresholds

flowchart TD

```
A["Scene/Bootstrap code provides a list of layer config assets"] --> B["HexTerrainLayerGroup<T>.Init(settings, initArgsList)"]
B --> C["For each initArgs: CreateTerrainLayer(initArgs)"]
C --> D["If initArgs implements ITerrainLayerFactory: call CreateTerrainLayer() on the asset"]
D --> E["layer.Init(settings, initArgs)"]
E --> F["ChunkMeshLayer.Init<T> reads IChunkMeshLayerConfig and initializes maps"]
E --> G["VisualChunkMeshLayer.Init<T> (if applicable) copies render/UV settings"]
E --> H["Roads/Rain/Clouds layers copy their specialized settings (if applicable)"]
```

Field reference: ChunkMeshLayerConfigAsset

Source:

```
com.freewebtime.hexterrains/Runtime/ChunkMeshes/Data/ChunkMeshLayerConfigAsset.cs
```

Height Map Args (`_heightMapArgs` / `HeightMapArgs`)

Type: `InitColorMapCellValueDataLayerArgs<float>`

Controls *initialization* of the layer's per-cell height data (`ChunkMeshLayer.HeightMap`).

How it's used:

- `ChunkMeshLayer.Init<T>` calls `InitColoredDataLayer(HeightMap, config.HeightMapArgs)`
- This can fill with a constant, random range, or apply a source texture.
- Also configures color palette + auto-color mode for the height color map (if used).

Typical meaning:

- This is the base "terrain elevation" for this layer (or any per-cell scalar the layer interprets as height).

Transparency Map Args (`_transparencyMapArgs` / `TransparencyMapArgs`)

Type: `InitColorMapCellValueDataLayerArgs<bool>`

Controls initialization of the per-cell transparency flags (`ChunkMeshLayer.TransparencyMap`).

How it's used:

- `ChunkMeshLayer.Init<T>` calls `InitDataLayer(TransparencyMap, config.TransparencyMapArgs)`
- Can fill all transparent/opaque, randomize (bool), or derive from a texture (depending on implementation support).

Typical meaning:

- Marks cells that should be treated as transparent/hidden in rendering or downstream calculations.
- This is also used when calculating "dirty mesh sources" (mesh regeneration triggers).

Biome Map Args (`_biomeMapArgs` / `BiomeMapArgs`)

Type: `InitColorMapCellValueDataLayerArgs<int>`

Controls initialization of per-cell biome indices (`ChunkMeshLayer.BiomeMap`).

How it's used:

- `ChunkMeshLayer.Init<T>` calls `InitColoredDataLayer(BiomeMap, config.BiomeMapArgs)`
- Biome values typically map to:
 - **submesh/material index** (standard rendering), or
 - **atlas UV selection** (when `RenderSettings.IsUseBiomeAtlas` is enabled in visual layers)

Is Auto Paint Biomes (`_isAutoPaintBiomes` / `IsAutoPaintBiomes`)

Type: `bool`

If enabled, the biome map is overwritten (painted) from the height map using `AutoPaintBiomesLevels`.

How it's used:

- In `ChunkMeshLayer.Init<T> :`
 - if `config.IsAutoPaintBiomes`, calls:
 - `FillBiomeByHeight(BiomeMap.Data, HeightMap.Data, config.AutoPaintBiomesLevels)`
 - then marks the whole biome map dirty.

Implications:

- Any biome values produced by `BiomeMapArgs` can be replaced by this step.
-

Auto Paint Biomes Levels (`_autoPaintBiomesLevels / AutoPaintBiomesLevels`)

Type: `List<float>`

A list of height thresholds used to assign biome indices.

Algorithm (as implemented):

- For each cell height `h`, find the **highest index** `i` such that `levels[i] <= h`
- Assign `biome = i`
- If the list is null/empty, biome defaults to `0`

Practical guidance:

- Index in the list is the biome index that will be assigned.
 - Example (levels `[0, 1, 2]`):
 - `h < 1` → biome `0`
 - `1 <= h < 2` → biome `1`
 - `h >= 2` → biome `2`
-

Chunk Mesh Layer Settings (`_chunkMeshLayerSettings / ChunkMeshLayerSettings`)

Type: `ChunkMeshLayerSettings`

Controls layer-specific rules used primarily during cell-metrics and color-map calculation:

UseHeightThresholdForTransparency

If `true`, cell metrics calculation uses a height threshold to treat cells as transparent (see `CalcHexCellMetricsJob` usage).

HeightThresholdForTransparency

Height cutoff used when `UseHeightThresholdForTransparency` is enabled.

HasOverlappingLayer

If `true`, biome color map calculation can be influenced by an overlapping layer.

OverlappingLayerReference

A `HexTerrainLayerReference` to another `ChunkMeshLayer`. When overlapping is enabled, biome color calculation can mark cells transparent if they are lower than the overlapping layer at the same cell index.

Where it shows up:

- `ChunkMeshLayer.CalculateBiomeColorMap()` chooses overlap-aware logic when enabled.
-

Sync Height Map Layer Reference (`_syncHeightMapLayerReference` / `SyncHeightMapLayerReference`)

Type: `HexTerrainLayerReference`

If set, this layer can copy (sync) height values from another `ChunkMeshLayer` during runtime syncing.

Where it's used:

- `ChunkMeshLayer.SyncHeightMap()`

Behavior summary:

- Finds referenced layer in `ParentLayer` via `HexTerrainLayerReference`
 - If either source or target map is dirty, schedules a sync job and marks target dirty.
-

Sync Biome Map Layer Reference (`_syncBiomeMapLayerReference` / `SyncBiomeMapLayerReference`)

Type: `HexTerrainLayerReference`

Same concept as height syncing, but for biome values.

Where it's used:

- `ChunkMeshLayer.SyncBiomeMap()`
-

Sync Transparency Map Layer Reference (`_syncTransparencyMapLayerReference` / `SyncTransparencyMapLayerReference`)

Type: `HexTerrainLayerReference`

Same concept as height syncing, but for transparency flags.

Where it's used:

- `ChunkMeshLayer.SyncTransparencyMap()`
-

CreateTerrainLayer()

Factory method override (important for initialization flow).

Default mapping:

- `ChunkMeshLayerConfigAsset.CreateTerrainLayer()` → `new ChunkMeshLayer()`

This is what enables `HexTerrainLayerGroup<T>.CreateTerrainLayer(initArgs)` to instantiate the correct runtime layer type when the `init-args` object is a config asset.

Shared nested type:

InitColorMapCellValueDataLayerArgs<TValue>

These args appear in the inspector as foldouts for `HeightMapArgs`, `BiomeMapArgs`, and `TransparencyMapArgs`.

Value range / defaults

- `MinValue` : used for some calculations (not a hard clamp)
- `MaxValue` : used for some calculations (not a hard clamp)
- `DefaultValue` : used when layers resize and new cells are added

Initialization mode toggles (usually you enable one)

- `IsFillWithValue` + `FillValue`
- `IsFillWithRandomValues` + `RandomMinValue` + `RandomMaxValue`
- `IsApplySourceTexture` + `SourceTexture` + `SourceTextureValueOffset` + `SourceTextureValueScale`

Color map configuration (for colored layers)

- `ColorPalette` : palette used to compute a color map
 - `AutoColorMapMode` :
 - `GradientThroughPalette` : value normalized between `MinValue..MaxValue` drives palette gradient
 - `ColorIndexByValue` : integer value used as palette index
 - `Custom` : derived/custom logic
-

Shared nested type: HexTerrainLayerReference

A generic way to reference another layer in the same `HexTerrainLayerGroup` :

- `IsSearchByIndex` + `LayerIndex`
- `IsSearchByName` + `LayerName`

Used by:

- sync references (`SyncHeightMapLayerReference`, etc.)
 - overlap reference (`ChunkMeshLayerSettings.OverlappingLayerReference`)
-

Inherited config assets (derived from `ChunkMeshLayerConfigAsset`)

`VisualChunkMeshLayerConfigAsset`

Base class for *renderable* chunk mesh layers.

Factory mapping:

- `VisualChunkMeshLayerConfigAsset.CreateTerrainLayer()` → `new VisualChunkMeshLayer()`

Additional fields:

`Is Visible` (`_isVisible` / `IsVisible`)

If `false`, the layer will skip mesh generation/rendering (`VisualChunkMeshLayer.CalcMeshSources` returns early).

`Render Settings` (`_renderSettings` / `RenderSettings`)

Type: `ChunkMeshRenderSettings`

Key sub-fields:

- `HeightOffset` : vertical render offset (commonly used for water)
- `IsColoredBorders`, `BorderSubmeshIndex`, `ColoredSlopeTreshold`, `BorderSize` : border rendering rules
- `IsUseBiomeAtlas` : if true, biome selection uses atlas UVs instead of biome-index materials
- `UVScale` : global UV scaling
- `IsOverrideSlopeSize` / `OverrideSlopeSize` : optional slope size override during mesh generation

Where it's used:

- Copied into `VisualChunkMeshLayer.RenderSettings` during `Init<T>`.
- Affects mesh generation jobs (`GenerateSurfaceChunkMeshJob`, etc.).

`Render Configs` (`_renderConfigs` / `RenderConfigs`)

Type: `List<HexSurfaceRenderConfigAsset>`

Meaning:

- Index is the terrain "view mode" (`viewMode 0` → config 0, etc.)
- Each config provides:
 - `Materials[]` (material index typically = biome/submesh index)
 - shadow flags

`Default Render Config` (`_defaultRenderConfig` / `DefaultRenderConfig`)

Fallback if the requested view mode has no entry in `RenderConfigs`.

Biome UVs (`_biomeUvs` / `BiomeUvs`)

Type: `List<Sprite>`

Used to generate `ChunkMeshBiomeUVConfig` entries:

- Each sprite's UV rect is extracted and stored.
 - Only used when `RenderSettings.IsUseBiomeAtlas` is enabled (atlas workflow).
-

WaterChunkMeshLayerConfigAsset

Factory mapping:

- `WaterChunkMeshLayerConfigAsset.CreateTerrainLayer()` → `new WaterChunkMeshLayer()`

Adds **no new serialized fields** beyond `VisualChunkMeshLayerConfigAsset`.

Practical notes:

- Usually configured with a small `RenderSettings.HeightOffset` to prevent z-fighting with the ground surface.
 - Uses a specialized mesh generator job (`GenerateWaterChunkMeshJob`) in `WaterChunkMeshLayer`.
-

RoadsChunkMeshLayerConfigAsset

Factory mapping:

- `RoadsChunkMeshLayerConfigAsset.CreateTerrainLayer()` → `new RoadsChunkMeshLayer()`

Adds:

Roads Render Settings (`_roadsRenderSettings` / `RoadsRenderSettings`)

Type: `HexRoadsRenderSettings`

Fields:

- `RoadThickness` : relative to hex radius (0..1)
- `RoadsTileScalePlato` : UV tiling for flat road segments
- `RoadsTileScaleBridge` : UV tiling for "bridge" segments
- `CrossRoadsUvScale` : UV scaling for cell-center crossroads
- `IsUseHeightThreshold` : only render road connections if neighbor height delta is small enough
- `HeightThreshold` : the allowed height delta

Where it's used:

- Copied into `RoadsChunkMeshLayer.RoadsRenderSettings` during init.
 - Passed into `GenerateRoadsChunkMeshJob`.
-

CloudsChunkMeshLayerConfigAsset

Factory mapping:

- `CloudsChunkMeshLayerConfigAsset.CreateTerrainLayer()` → `new CloudsChunkMeshLayer()`

Adds:

Clouds Render Settings (`_cloudsRenderSettings` / `CloudsRenderSettings`)

Type: `CloudsRenderSettings`

Fields:

- `CloudThickness` : max volumetric thickness at/above `MaxCellHeight`
- `MaxCellHeight` : height at which thickness is considered max
- `CloudScaleTreshold` : below this height, cloud scale fades toward 0
- `IsDrawBottomSide` : whether underside faces are generated/rendered

Where it's used:

- Copied into `CloudsChunkMeshLayer.CloudsRenderSettings` during init.
 - Passed into `GenerateCloudsChunkMeshJob` .
-

RainChunkMeshLayerConfigAsset

Factory mapping:

- `RainChunkMeshLayerConfigAsset.CreateTerrainLayer()` → `new RainChunkMeshLayer()`

Adds:

Rain Render Settings (`_rainRenderSettings` / `RainRenderSettings`)

Type: `RainRenderSettings`

Fields:

- `RainHeight` : vertical start height above terrain from which rain is generated
- `MaxCellHeight` : terrain height at which rain effect reaches its max (visual scaling is typically interpolated)

Where it's used:

- Copied into `RainChunkMeshLayer.RainRenderSettings` during init.
 - Passed into `GenerateRainChunkMeshJob` .
-

Summary: runtime layer created by each config asset

Config asset	Runtime layer instance returned by <code>CreateTerrainLayer()</code>
ChunkMeshLayerConfigAsset	ChunkMeshLayer
VisualChunkMeshLayerConfigAsset	VisualChunkMeshLayer
WaterChunkMeshLayerConfigAsset	WaterChunkMeshLayer
RoadsChunkMeshLayerConfigAsset	RoadsChunkMeshLayer
CloudsChunkMeshLayerConfigAsset	CloudsChunkMeshLayer
RainChunkMeshLayerConfigAsset	RainChunkMeshLayer

CellItemLayer, CellObjectLayer, CellEntityLayer — concept, lifecycle, frame cycle, rendering & entities

This document explains the “cell item” layer family:

- `CellItemLayer` (base data + transforms per cell)
- `CellObjectLayer` (renders per-cell objects via `IBulkRenderer` / `BulkRendererAsset`)
- `CellEntityLayer` (spawns/despawns ECS entities per cell and keeps them in sync)

It focuses on:

- how the layers store data
- how dirty tracking affects recalculation
- what happens every frame (update → calculate → render → cleanup)
- initialization and disposal responsibilities
- how to use each layer correctly

1) Core idea: “an item per cell”

A **cell item layer** represents *at most one logical thing per cell* (a tile prop, a building, a resource entity, etc.). The thing is described by:

- **Item index:** *what* is in the cell (`ItemIndexMap`)
- **Item state:** a variation or stage (`ItemStateMap`)
- **Local transform parts:**
 - `ItemPositionMap` (`float3`)
 - `ItemRotationMap` (`quaternion`)
 - `ItemScaleMap` (`float3`)
- **Precomputed local matrix:**
 - `ItemTransformMap` (`Matrix4x4`) = combined local TRS (plus optional transform settings)

These fields live in `CellItemLayer` (`Runtime/CellItems/Data/CellItemLayer.cs`).

2) `CellItemLayer`: data, dirty tracking, update, serialization, disposal

2.1 Data layers inside `CellItemLayer`

`CellItemLayer` allocates a “per cell” data layer for each attribute:

Field	Type	Meaning
ItemIndexMap	ColorMapCellValueDataLayer_Int	cellIndex -> itemIndex (also has a color map for visualization)
ItemStateMap	CellValueDataLayer<int>	cellIndex -> state
ItemPositionMap	CellValueDataLayer<float3>	cellIndex -> local position
ItemRotationMap	CellValueDataLayer<quaternion>	cellIndex -> local rotation
ItemScaleMap	CellValueDataLayer<float3>	cellIndex -> local scale
ItemTransformMap	CellValueDataLayer<Matrix4x4>	cellIndex -> local transform matrix

Each is **chunked** and has:

- IsDirty flag
- per-chunk dirty grid (ChunkDirtyGrid)
- job dependency tracking (PrepareToRead , PrepareToWrite , AddReadDependency , AddWriteDependency)

This is why updates can run “only when something changed”.

2.2 Initialization

`CellItemLayer.Init(HexTerrainSettings settings)` ensures all maps exist and are sized to `settings.CellsCount`.

`CellItemLayer.Init<TInitArgs>(..., initArgs)` applies configuration when `initArgs` implements `ICellItemLayerConfig`:

- ItemTransformSettings
- SurfaceLayerReference
- OverlapSurfaceLayerReference
- initial data fill for index/state/pos/rot/scale (via `InitDataLayer(...)` helpers and `InitColoredDataLayer(...)` for index)

2.3 Per-frame update: `UpdateCellItems()` → `UpdateLocalTransforms()`

`CellItemLayer.UpdateCellItems(dependency)` primarily calls:

- `UpdateLocalTransforms(dependency)`

`UpdateLocalTransforms` :

- returns early if `ItemPositionMap`, `ItemRotationMap`, and `ItemScaleMap` are not dirty
- schedules `CalculateCellItemTransformsJob`
- writes `ItemTransformMap` and marks it dirty

So the base layer’s “output” that other layers consume is typically:

- ItemIndexMap
- ItemStateMap
- ItemTransformMap

2.4 Serialization

`CellItemLayer` implements `ISerializableTerrainLayer`:

- `SerializeLayer(BinaryWriter)` serializes: index/state/pos/rot/scale
- `DeserializeLayer(BinaryReader, settings)` restores the same and then calls `SetAllDirty(true)`

Notes:

- It calls `CompleteAllJobs()` before serializing/deserializing to ensure data safety.

2.5 Cleanup vs Dispose

There are 3 different “end of frame / end of life” concepts:

- `Cleanup()` / `CleanupAsync(...)`
Clears dirty flags/chunk dirty grids (so next frame won't recompute unless something changes again).
- `Dispose()`
Permanently frees native memory (`NativeList`, `NativeParallel...` collections) owned by the layer.
- `CompleteAllJobs()`
Synchronization point used before serialization or when safe CPU reads are required.

3) Frame cycle overview (how derived layers fit in)

flowchart TD

```
A["Gameplay writes: ItemIndex/State/Pos/Rot/Scale"] --> B["Dirty flags are set on changed chunks"]
B --> C["Update phase: CellItemLayer.UpdateCellItems()"]
C --> D["Job: compute ItemTransformMap (local matrices)"]
D --> E["Derived layer calculates view data"]
E --> F["Render or ECS updates happen"]
F --> G["Cleanup phase: clear dirty flags (Cleanup()/CleanupAsync(JobHandle))"]
```

Derived layers differ mainly at step **E/F**:

- `CellObjectLayer`: builds render batches (`BulkRenderItemsDataLayer`) and calls `IBulkRenderer` to draw.
- `CellEntityLayer`: decides which ECS entities should exist per cell, instantiates/destroys them, and systems update their transform/visibility.

4) CellObjectLayer: how static “cell objects” are baked, calculated, and rendered

Files:

- `Runtime/CellObjects/Data/CellObjectLayer.cs`
- `Runtime/CellObjects/Data/CellObjectLayerConfigAsset.cs`
- `Runtime/CellObjects/CellObjectConfigAuthoring.cs`
- `Runtime/CellObjects/CellObjectPrefabAuthoring.cs`

- Runtime/CellObjects/CellObjectPrefabLODAuthoring.cs
- Runtime/CellObjects/Jobs/CalcCellObjectsLODLayerJob.cs

4.1 What CellObjectLayer adds on top of CellItemLayer

CellObjectLayer inherits all base "item" data and adds:

- IBulkRenderer BulkRenderer
- LOD selection config:
 - NativeList<CellObjectLayerLODSettings> LODSettings
 - int LODsCount
- Baked visuals data (copied into native memory on init):
 - NativeList<CellObjectVisualItemSettings> AllCellObjectVisuals
 - NativeList<CellObjectLODSettings> AllCellObjectsLODSettings
- Render outputs per LOD:
 - List<BulkRenderItemsDataLayer> VisualsByLODLayer
 - each is a NativeParallelMultiHashMapDataLayer<BulkRenderItemSettings, BulkRenderItem>

Capacity detail:

- each LOD output is initialized to `Settings.CellsCount * MaxSubmeshesPerCell`
- because NativeParallelMultiHashMap capacity must be known up-front for job writes

4.2 Baking step (Editor): precomputing BulkRenderItemSettings

The key performance concept: **render setup is baked once** (mesh/material/submesh/property block selection) and runtime only computes transforms.

CellObjectLayerConfigAsset.BakeCellObjectConfigs() does this:

1. Iterates ObjectConfigs (list of CellObjectConfigAuthoring)
2. Each authoring contains multiple *states* (CellObjectPrefabAuthoring)
3. Each state contains multiple *LODs* (CellObjectPrefabLODAuthoring)
4. Each LOD has a list of MeshRenderer s to be rendered

For each MeshRenderer :

- it calls `bulkRenderer.RegisterRenderer(renderer, meshFilter, ...)`
- which returns a list of BulkRenderItemSettings describing **what to draw**
 - mesh index, material index, submesh index, layer, shadows, property block index, etc.

Then the baker stores:

- CellObjectVisualItemSettings :
 - RenderItemSettings (the baked "what to draw")
 - Transform (renderer's localToWorldMatrix as a relative transform)
- CellObjectLODSettings ranges per (objectIndex, state, lodIndex) :
 - VisualsStartIndex
 - VisualsCount
 - HasVisuals

At runtime, CellObjectLayer.Init(...) copies these baked lists into:

- AllCellObjectVisuals (native)

- AllCellObjectsLODSettings (native)

4.3 Runtime calculation: converting cell data into render batches

Core entrypoints:

- CalculateCellObjects(...)
- CalculateCellObjectsLODs(...)
- CalculateCellObjectsLOD(...)

CalculateCellObjectsLOD(...) does:

- early-out unless something relevant is dirty:
 - ItemIndexMap, ItemStateMap, ItemTransformMap
 - surface metrics dirty (surfaceLayer.CellMetricsMap, optional overlap surface)
 - visibility dirty (new visible chunks in chunksLayer.ChunkVisibility)
- clears the LOD render batch:
 - renderItemsDataLayer.Data.ClearNativeParallelMultiHashMapAsync(...)
- schedules one of:
 - CalcCellObjectsLODLayerJob
 - CalcCellObjectsLODLayerJob_OverlapSurface

Job behavior (per cell):

- skip if the cell's chunk is not visible (ChunkVisibilityGrid[chunkIndex].IsVisible == false)
- read:
 - cellObjectIndex = ItemIndexMap[cellIndex]
 - cellObjectState = ItemStateMap[cellIndex]
- compute the state/LOD lookup index:
 - cellObjectIndex * StatesCountPerObject * LODsCount + cellObjectState * LODsCount + LODIndex
- for every visual in that LOD:
 - produce a BulkRenderItem with a final matrix:
 - chunkTransform * (cellMetrics.CellTransform_Local * ItemTransformMap[cellIndex]) * visual.Transform
 - add it to NativeParallelMultiHashMap under key visual.RenderItemSettings

Result:

- VisualsByLODLayer[lodIndex] becomes a grouped set of "instances to draw" keyed by BulkRenderItemSettings.

4.4 Rendering: CellObjectLayer.RenderLODs(...) → IBulkRenderer

Render path:

- CellObjectLayerGroup.Render(camera, normalizedCameraZoom) calls CellObjectLayer.Render(...)
- RenderLODs selects *one* LOD based on normalizedCameraZoom and LODSettings
- then calls Render(camera, BulkRenderer, renderEntitiesLOD)

Render(...) :

- opens the render batch data layer for read

- computes a conservative `worldBounds`
 - calls:
 - `IBulkRenderer.RenderEntities(renderItemsDataLayer.Data, camera, worldBounds)`
-

5) IBulkRenderer / BulkRendererAsset: how batched data becomes draw calls

Files:

- `Runtime/BulkRendering/IBulkRenderer.cs`
- `Runtime/BulkRendering/BulkRendererAsset.cs`
- `Runtime/BulkRendering/BulkRendererUtils.cs`
- `Runtime/BulkRendering/BulkRenderItemSettings.cs`

5.1 What IBulkRenderer provides

`IBulkRenderer` is both:

- a **registry** for meshes/materials/property blocks
- and a **renderer** that consumes batched `BulkRenderItems`

Key responsibilities:

- registration:
 - `RegisterMesh`, `RegisterMaterial`, `RegisterPropertyBlock`, `RegisterRenderer(...)`
- rendering:
 - `RenderEntities(...)` overloads for different input forms

5.2 Default implementation: BulkRendererAsset

`BulkRendererAsset` stores:

- `List<Mesh> Meshes`
- `List<Material> Materials`
- `List<MaterialPropertyBlock> PropertyBlocks`
- dictionaries to keep unique indices per asset instance id

When `RegisterRenderer(renderer, meshFilter, result, ...)` is called:

- it inspects the mesh and renderer materials
- it registers mesh/material/property blocks into the asset lists if needed
- it appends one or more `BulkRenderItemSettings` describing:
 - which mesh
 - which submesh
 - which material
 - shadow and layer flags
 - optional property block index

This is the “precalculation” step that allows runtime to remain lightweight.

5.3 How draw calls are issued

`BulkRendererUtils.Render(...)` chooses:

- `Graphics.DrawMesh` for a single instance
- `Graphics.DrawMeshInstanced` / `Graphics.RenderMeshInstanced` for many instances

The renderer groups by `BulkRenderItemSettings` so each group becomes one instanced draw call (or a few calls, if the group is large).

6) CellEntityLayer: spawning/despawning and keeping entities synchronized

Files:

- `Runtime/CellEntities/Data/CellEntityLayer.cs`
- `Runtime/CellEntities/DataLayers/CellEntityViewDataLayer.cs`
- `Runtime/CellEntities/Jobs/CalcCellEntityEntitiesJob.cs`
- `Runtime/CellEntities/Jobs/SaveCreatedCellEntityEntitiesJob.cs`
- `Runtime/CellEntities/Jobs/SaveClearedCellEntityEntitiesJob.cs`
- `Runtime/CellEntities/Systems/PlaybackUpdateCellEntityCommandBuffersSystem.cs`
- `Runtime/CellEntities/Systems/UpdateCellEntityEntitiesStateSystem.cs`

6.1 What CellEntityLayer adds

On top of `CellItemLayer`, it adds:

- `CellEntityViewDataLayer` `CellEntityViews`
 - stores `CellEntityView { Prefab, Instance }` per cell
 - also stores request buffers:
 - `CreateEntityRequests: prefab -> cellIndex`
 - `RemoveEntityRequests: instance -> cellIndex`
 - `ClearedCells`
 - `EntityByChunkIndex`
- `NativeList<CellEntityConfig>` `CellEntityConfigs`
 - per *entity index* configuration (color + prefab mapping per state)
- `EntityManager` `EntityManager`
- an `EntityCommandBuffer` used to add components/shared components from jobs:
 - `SetChunkIndexCommandBuffer`
 - `SetChunkIndexCommandBufferDependency`

6.2 Step 1 — Decide what entities should exist: `CalculateEntities()`

`CellEntityLayer.CalculateEntities(dependency)` :

- early-out if nothing dirty:
 - `ItemIndexMap`, `ItemStateMap`, `CellEntityViews`
- clears and re-inits request structures:

- `CellEntityViews.ClearRemoveAndCreateRequests()`
- `CellEntityViews.Init(Settings.CellsCount, Settings)`
- merges dirty grids from `ItemIndexMap` and `ItemStateMap` into `CellEntityViews`
- schedules `CalcCellEntityEntitiesJob`

`CalcCellEntityEntitiesJob` (per dirty cell):

- reads (`cellEntityIndex`, `cellEntityState`)
- uses `CellEntityConfigs[cellEntityIndex]` to compute `neededPrefab`:
 - it matches `cellEntityState` against `StatePerPrefab`
- compares to current view (`CellEntityViews[cellIndex].Prefab`)
- emits:
 - remove request if a prefab was previously present
 - create request if a prefab is now required
 - cleared cell index if it was removed and not replaced

No structural changes happen here; it only computes requests.

6.3 Step 2 — Apply requests: `UpdateEntities(...)`

`CellEntityLayer.UpdateEntities(layerEntity, layerIndex, dependency)`:

- early-out unless `CellEntityViews.IsDirty`

Then it:

1. Creates an ECB (`SetChunkIndexCommandBuffer = new EntityCommandBuffer(Allocator.TempJob)`).
2. Iterates **unique prefabs** in `CreateEntityRequests`:
 - `EntityManager.Instantiate(prefab, requestsCount, Allocator.TempJob)`
3. Schedules `SaveCreatedCellEntityEntitiesJob` per prefab:
 - fills `CellEntityViews[cellIndex] = { Prefab, Instance }`
 - adds instance into `EntityByChunkIndex`
 - enqueues structural additions via ECB:
 - `CellEntityTerrainReference { Value = terrainEntity }` (shared)
 - `HexChunkGridIndex { Value=chunkIndex, TerrainEntity, LayerIndex }` (shared)
 - `HexCellIndex { Value = cellIndex }` (component)
4. Schedules `SaveClearedCellEntityEntitiesJob`:
 - sets `CellEntityViews[cellIndex] = { Entity.Null, Entity.Null }` for cleared cells
5. Destroys instances in `RemoveEntityRequests` on the main thread:
 - `EntityManager.DestroyEntity(entitiesToRemove)`

Why ECB here:

- the code instantiates on the main thread, but adding shared components for many entities is pushed into a job via `EntityCommandBuffer.ParallelWriter`, then played back later.

6.4 Step 3 — Playback structural changes: `PlaybackUpdateCellEntityCommandBuffersSystem`

`PlaybackUpdateCellEntityCommandBuffersSystem` runs in `HexTerrainsStartPreRenderGroup` and calls:

- `layer.PlaybackSetChunkIndexCommandBuffer()`

`PlaybackSetChunkIndexCommandBuffer()`:

- completes `SetChunkIndexCommandBufferDependency`
- plays back the ECB into `EntityManager`
- disposes the ECB

This is the point when the spawned entities actually receive their terrain/chunk/cell components.

7) Keeping entity transforms and visibility updated (data changes → ECS state)

System:

- `UpdateCellEntityLayerEntitiesStateSystem`
(`Runtime/CellEntities/Systems/UpdateCellEntityEntitiesStateSystem.cs`)

Update group ordering:

- runs in `HexTerrainsStartPreRenderGroup`
- runs **after** `PlaybackUpdateCellEntityCommandBuffersSystem`
 - so newly spawned entities have the required components before transform updates

7.1 What it updates

Depending on what changed, it updates:

- `PostTransformMatrix` (entity transform)
- `CellEntityVisibility` (a component storing a `bool Value`)

7.2 When it runs per layer

For each terrain and each `CellEntityLayer` , it checks dirtiness:

- "data dirty" if any of these are dirty:
 - `surface CellMetricsMap` (and optional overlap surface metrics)
 - chunk visibility map has newly visible chunks
 - `cellEntityViews.IsDirty`
 - `cellItemTransforms.IsDirty` (`ItemTransformMap` from `CellItemLayer`)
- "visibility dirty" if `HexTerrainVisibility` component changed on the terrain entity since last update

Then it chooses one path:

- only data dirty → `UpdateCellEntitiesState(...)`
- only visibility dirty → `UpdateCellEntitiesVisibilities(...)`
- both → `UpdateCellEntitiesStateAndVisibilities(...)`

7.3 How the transform is computed

`UpdateCellEntitiesStateJob` / `UpdateCellEntitiesStateAndVisiblityJob` computes per entity:

- find `chunkIndex` from the entity's shared `HexChunkGridIndex`
- skip whole chunk if no relevant dirty grids are set for that chunk
- read `cellIndex` from `HexCellIndex`

- compute `cellPosition` :
 - `CellMetrics[cellIndex].CenterPosition_Global`
 - plus `ChunkVisibilityMap[chunkIndex].ChunkOffset` (if present)
- final matrix:
 - `(Matrix4x4)terrainLocalToWorld * TRS(cellPosition + TransformSettings.Position, TransformSettings.Rotation, TransformSettings.Scale) * LocalTransforms[cellIndex]`
- writes to `PostTransformMatrix`

If overlap surface is used, the job variant chooses the higher surface metrics before computing.

7.4 How visibility is applied

- If only terrain visibility changed:
 - `UpdateCellEntitiesVisibilityMarkerJob` writes `CellEntityVisibility.Value = isVisible` for all matching entities.
- If both changed:
 - `UpdateCellEntitiesStateAndVisibilityJob` updates both visibility and transforms in one pass.

8) Practical usage guide

8.1 Using `CellObjectLayer` (rendered, non-ECS)

1. Create a `CellObjectLayerConfigAsset` .
2. Assign a `BulkRendererAsset` to `BulkRenderer` .
3. Fill `ObjectConfigs` with `CellObjectConfigAuthoring` entries:
 - each entry references state prefabs (`CellObjectPrefabAuthoring`)
 - each state contains LOD authorings (`CellObjectPrefabLODAuthoring`) with `MeshRenderer` lists
4. Ensure baking runs (the asset runs `BakeCellObjectConfigs()` on `OnValidate`).
5. At runtime:
 - set `ItemIndexMap` / `ItemStateMap` to choose the object + state
 - optionally set local position/rotation/scale maps
 - call `UpdateCellItems()` to update `ItemTransformMap`
 - call `CalculateCellObjectsLODs(...)` to populate render batches
 - call `CellObjectLayerGroup.Render(camera, normalizedCameraZoom)` to draw

8.2 Using `CellEntityLayer` (ECS entities per cell)

1. Create a `CellEntityLayerConfigAsset` and set `CellEntities` authoring list.
2. Ensure baking produces a `NativeArray<CellEntityConfig>` on the terrain (consumed by `CellEntityLayerGroup.Init(...)`).
3. At runtime:
 - set `ItemIndexMap[cellIndex]` to the entity type index
 - set `ItemStateMap[cellIndex]` to choose which prefab to spawn for that entity type
4. Per update cycle:
 - `CellEntityLayerGroup.CalculateEntities(...)` schedules request calculation
 - `CellEntityLayerGroup.UpdateEntities(terrainEntity, ...)` instantiates/destroys and queues ECB additions

- `PlaybackUpdateCellEntityCommandBuffersSystem` plays back ECB (adds terrain/chunk/cell components)
 - `UpdateCellEntityLayerEntitiesStateSystem` updates transforms/visibility based on dirty data
-

9) Disposal responsibilities and common pitfalls

9.1 Don't confuse `Cleanup()` with `Dispose()`

- `Cleanup()` is expected to run every frame (or periodically) to clear dirty flags.
- `Dispose()` must run when the terrain/layer is destroyed to release native memory and, for `CellEntityLayer`, ensure spawned entities are destroyed.

9.2 Entity destruction on layer disposal/resize

`CellEntityViewDataLayer` overrides item disposal:

- when a `CellEntityView` item is disposed, it destroys `item.Instance` via `EntityManager.DestroyEntity(...)` (if it exists)

It also tracks "discarded cells" on `Init(layerSize)` and adds their entities to removal requests, preventing leaks when terrain shrinks.

9.3 Ensure correct ordering for entities

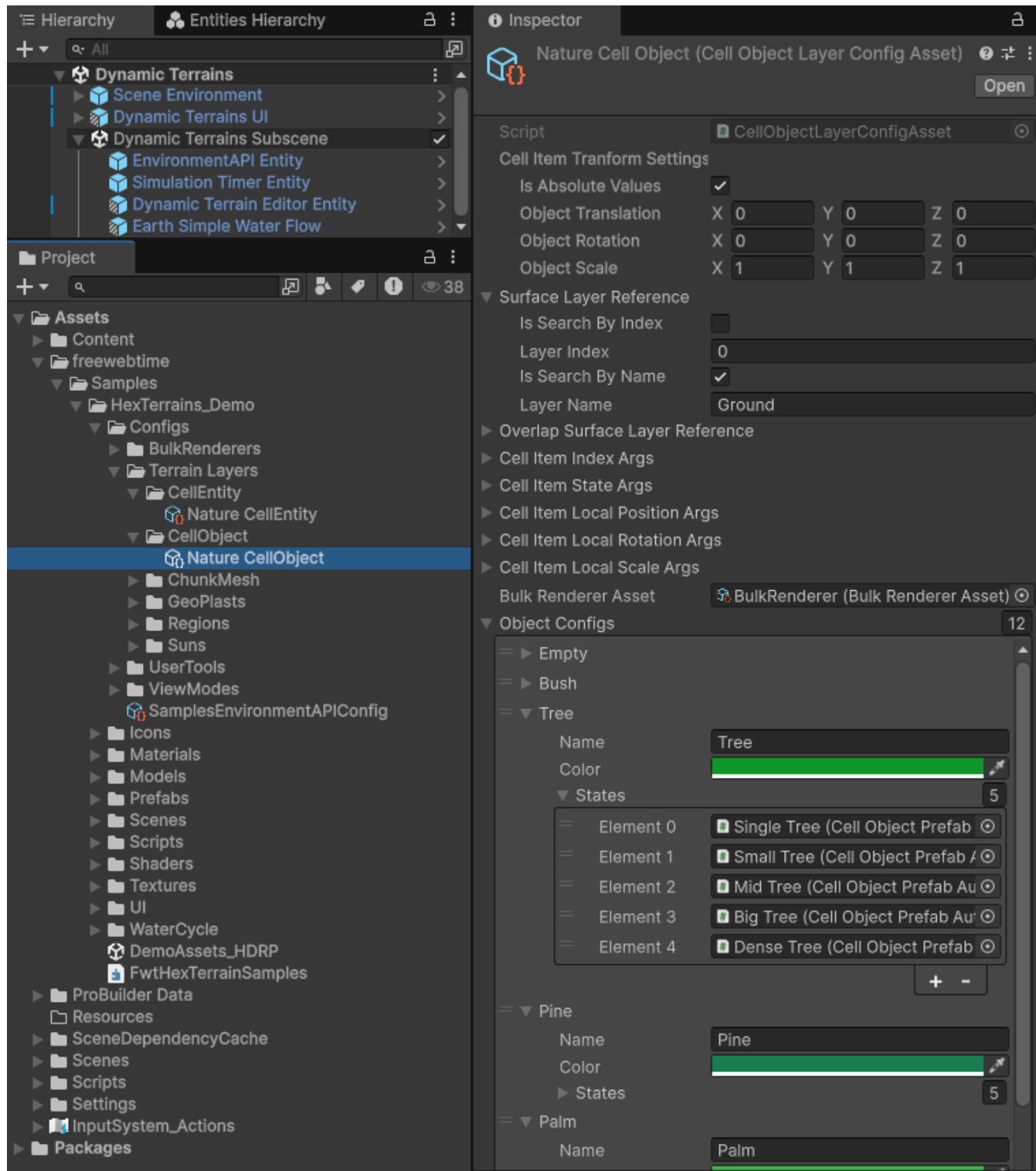
For correct results, entity lifecycle typically requires this order:

1. calculate spawn/despawn requests
2. instantiate/destroy entities
3. playback ECB that adds required components
4. update transform + visibility

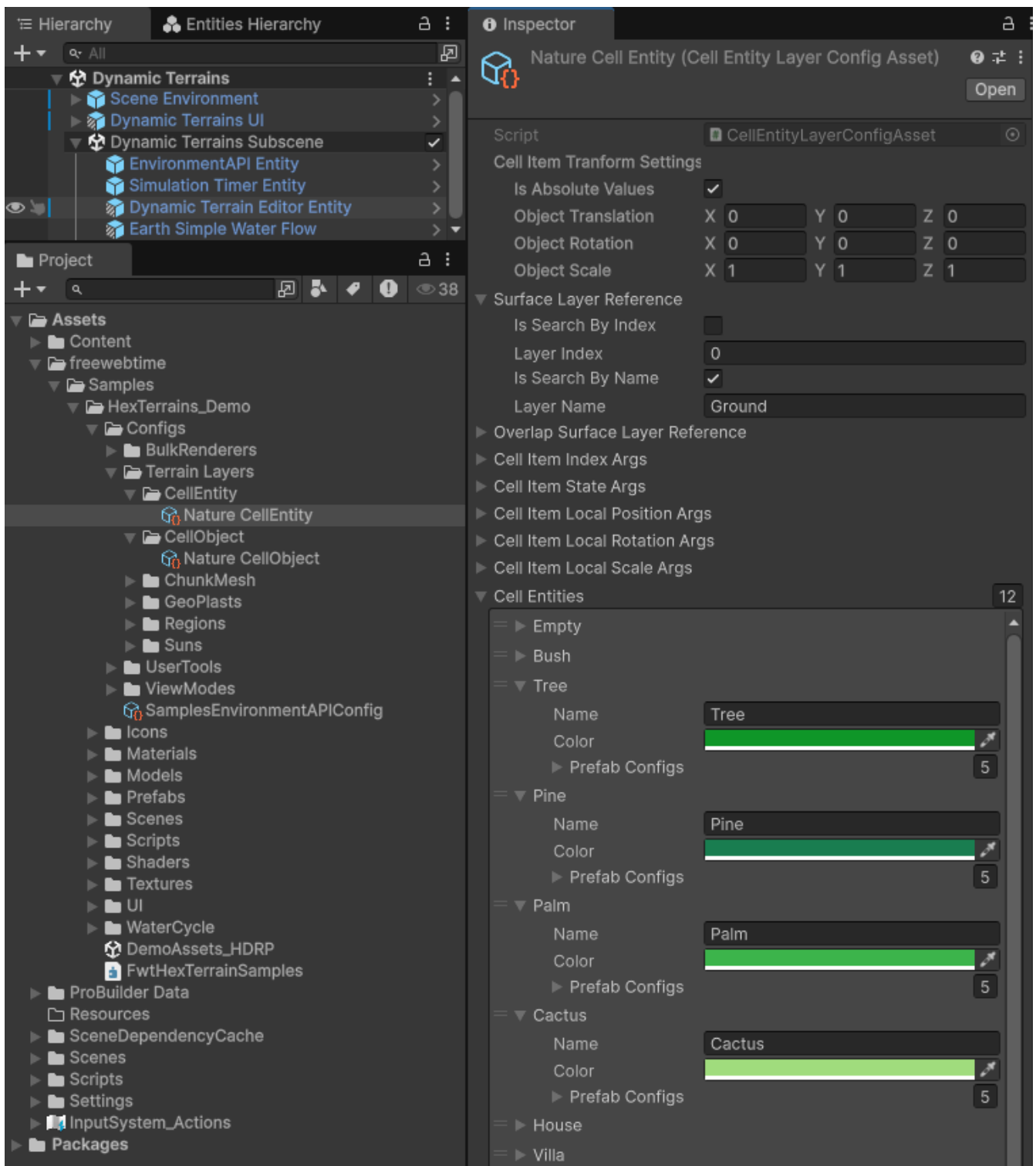
The built-in system ordering enforces this via `HexTerrainsStartPreRenderGroup` and `[UpdateAfter(typeof(PlaybackUpdateCellEntityCommandBuffersSystem))]`.

CellItemLayerConfigAsset (and derived layer config assets)

Cell Objects:



Cell Entities:



`CellItemLayerConfigAsset<TLayer>` is the common base `ScriptableObject` config for all "cell item" style layers: layers that store *one item per cell* plus per-cell transform components (position/rotation/scale) that can later be used to spawn entities or render instanced meshes.

It plays two roles:

1. Layer factory

Inherits `HexTerrainLayerConfigAsset<TLayer>` which implements `ITerrainLayerFactory`, so `HexTerrainLayerGroup<T>` can call `CreateTerrainLayer()` on the asset to instantiate the correct runtime layer.

2. Initialization payload

Implements `ICellItemLayerConfig`, which `CellItemLayer.Init(settings, initArgs)` reads to initialize all the internal data layers.

Source:

```
com.freewebtime.hexterrains/Runtime/CellItems/Data/CellItemLayerConfigAsset.cs
```

How this config is used during terrain initialization

A typical terrain setup uses `HexTerrainLayerGroup<TLayer>` and passes a list of config assets as init args. During initialization:

- `HexTerrainLayerGroup<T>.CreateTerrainLayer(initArgs)` detects `initArgs` is `ITerrainLayerFactory` and creates the runtime layer via `CreateTerrainLayer()`.
- Then `layer.Init(settings, initArgs)` is called.
- `CellItemLayer.Init<TInitArgs>` checks `initArgs` is `ICellItemLayerConfig` and:
 - copies references/settings into the layer
 - initializes cell-value data layers (`ItemIndexMap`, `ItemStateMap`, `ItemPositionMap`, `ItemRotationMap`, `ItemScaleMap`)

flowchart TD

```
A["Init args list contains cell-item config assets"] --> B["HexTerrainLayerGroup<T>.InitLayers (...)"]
B --> C["CreateTerrainLayer(initArgs) uses ITerrainLayerFactory"]
C --> D["Runtime layer created (CellItemLayer / CellEntityLayer / CellObjectLayer)"]
D --> E["layer.Init(settings, initArgs)"]
E --> F["CellItemLayer.Init<T> reads ICellItemLayerConfig and initializes maps"]
F --> G["Derived layers read their extra config (ICellEntityLayerConfig / ICellObjectLayerConfig)"]
```

Base config: CellItemLayerConfigAsset<TLayer>

This base class defines the shared fields used by **all** cell-item layers.

1) `_cellItemTransformSettings` / `CellItemTransformSettings`

Type: `CellItemTransformSettingsEditor` (serialized) → implicitly converts to `CellItemTransformSettings`

Meaning:

- Layer-wide transform settings applied during transform calculation (in addition to per-cell local position/rotation/scale maps).

Where it's used:

- Copied in `CellItemLayer.Init<T> :`
 - `ItemTransformSettings = config.CellItemTransformSettings`
- Consumed by `CellItemLayer.UpdateLocalTransforms()` → schedules `CalculateCellItemTransformsJob` using:
 - `TransformSettings = ItemTransformSettings`

Notes on `CellItemTransformSettingsEditor` fields (what you see in the Inspector):

- `IsAbsoluteValues`, `ObjectTranslation`, `ObjectRotation`, `ObjectScale`: author the base transform.
- `IsAutoRotation`, `RotationY`, `OffsetFromCenter`: optional editor helpers for computing rotation/offset.
- Produces `CellItemTransformSettings.Transform` (a matrix), cached into position/rotation/scale in `CellItemTransformSettings`.

2) `_surfaceLayerReference` / `SurfaceLayerReference`

Type: `HexTerrainLayerReference`

Meaning:

- Which surface layer (usually a `ChunkMeshLayer`) the cell items should treat as “ground” for placement.

Where it’s used:

- Copied in `CellItemLayer.Init<T> :`
 - `SurfaceLayerReference = config.SurfaceLayerReference`
- Used later by `CellObjectLayer.CalculateCellObjects(...)` to resolve:
 - `surfaceLayer = chunkMeshes.GetLayer<ChunkMeshLayer>(SurfaceLayerReference)`

3) `_overlapSurfaceLayerReference` / `OverlapSurfaceLayerReference`

Type: `HexTerrainLayerReference`

Meaning:

- Optional “overlap” surface. If set, placement logic can choose whichever surface is higher at a given cell. The cell item will be placed on the “overlap” surface if it’s higher than the main `SurfaceLayerReference` surface.

Where it’s used:

- Copied in `CellItemLayer.Init<T> :`
 - `OverlapSurfaceLayerReference = config.OverlapSurfaceLayerReference`
- Used later by `CellObjectLayer.CalculateCellObjects(...)` to resolve:
 - `overlapSurfaceLayer = chunkMeshes.GetLayer<ChunkMeshLayer>(OverlapSurfaceLayerReference)`
- Affects which job variant is scheduled:
 - `CalcCellObjectsLODLayerJob` (no overlap)
 - `CalcCellObjectsLODLayerJob_OverlapSurface` (with overlap)

4) `_cellItemIndexArgs` / `CellItemIndexArgs`

Type: `InitColorMapCellValueDataLayerArgs<int>`

Meaning:

- Initialization rules for `CellItemLayer.ItemIndexMap` (per-cell item index).

Where it's used:

- `CellItemLayer.Init<T>` calls:
 - `InitColoredDataLayer(ItemIndexMap, config.CellItemIndexArgs)`

Implications:

- This is the *primary* "what item is in the cell" value.
 - It also drives `ItemIndexMap`'s color map (palette-based), which is used by some layers (notably `CellObjectLayer` and `CellEntityLayer`) for visualization/minimap/debug coloring.
-

5) `_cellItemStateArgs` / `CellItemStateArgs`

Type: `InitCellValueDataLayerArgs<int>`

Meaning:

- Initialization rules for `ItemStateMap` (per-cell item state/variant).

Where it's used:

- `CellItemLayer.Init<T>` calls:
 - `InitDataLayer(ItemStateMap, config.CellItemStateArgs)`

Implications:

- State is typically interpreted by derived layers to pick visuals or prefab variants.
-

6) `_cellItemLocalPositionArgs` / `CellItemLocalPositionArgs`

Type: `InitCellValueDataLayerArgs<float3>`

Used by:

- `CellItemLayer.Init<T> → InitDataLayer(ItemPositionMap, config.CellItemLocalPositionArgs)`

Meaning:

- Per-cell local translation relative to the cell's placement reference.
-

7) `_cellItemLocalRotationArgs` / `CellItemLocalRotationArgs`

Type: `InitCellValueDataLayerArgs<quaternion>`

Used by:

- `CellItemLayer.Init<T> → InitDataLayer(ItemRotationMap, config.CellItemLocalRotationArgs)`

Meaning:

- Per-cell local rotation.
-

8) `_cellItemLocalScaleArgs` / `CellItemLocalScaleArgs`

Type: `InitCellValueDataLayerArgs<float3>`

Used by:

- `CellItemLayer.Init<T> → InitDataLayer(ItemScaleMap, config.CellItemLocalScaleArgs)`

Meaning:

- Per-cell local scale.
-

How the above maps affect `CellItemLayer` initialization

`CellItemLayer.Init(settings)` always creates/initializes the required data layers (sizes, allocators).

Then `CellItemLayer.Init(settings, initArgs)` applies your config:

- `ItemTransformSettings`, `SurfaceLayerReference`, `OverlapSurfaceLayerReference` are stored on the layer.
- `ItemIndexMap`, `ItemStateMap`, `ItemPositionMap`, `ItemRotationMap`, `ItemScaleMap` are initialized/fill-populated based on the args.

`ItemTransformMap` is **not directly initialized by the config**. Instead, it's computed when `UpdateLocalTransforms()` runs, based on:

- `ItemPositionMap` + `ItemRotationMap` + `ItemScaleMap`
 - and `ItemTransformSettings` (from the config)
-

Derived config assets (inherited from `CellItemLayerConfigAsset<TLayer>`)

`CellEntityLayerConfigAsset`

Source:

```
com.freewebtime.hexterrains/Runtime/CellEntities/Data/CellEntityLayerConfigAsset.c
```

Factory mapping:

- `CellEntityLayerConfigAsset.CreateTerrainLayer()` → `new CellEntityLayer()`

Additional fields:

`_cellEntities` / `CellEntities`

Type: `List<CellEntityConfigAuthoring>`

Meaning:

- Editor/baking-time authoring list for entity-prefab-backed cell items.

How it's used:

- Not consumed directly by `CellEntityLayer.Init(settings, initArgs)` at runtime.
- Typically baked into a combined `DynamicBuffer<CellEntityConfig>` on the terrain entity (the runtime code consumes the baked configs via the range fields below).

`_entityConfigsRangeStart` / `EntityConfigsRangeStart`

Type: `int`

Meaning:

- Start index into the **combined baked entity-config buffer** (shared across layers).

Where it's used during initialization:

- In `CellEntityLayer.Init(settings, ICellEntityLayerConfig args, NativeArray<CellEntityConfig> cellEntityConfigs)` :
 - selects the slice: `GetCellEntityConfigs(cellEntityConfigs, args.EntityConfigsRangeStart, args.EntityConfigsRangeSize)`
 - then calls `InitCellEntitiesConfigs(slice)`

`_entityConfigsRangeSize` / `EntityConfigsRangeSize`

Type: `int`

Meaning:

- Size of the slice belonging to this layer in the combined baked buffer.

Where it's used:

- Same place as `EntityConfigsRangeStart` (slice length).

What `InitCellEntitiesConfigs(...)` does with the slice

During initialization it:

- copies configs into `CellEntityLayer.CellEntityConfigs` (`NativeList<CellEntityConfig>`)
- builds a color palette from `CellEntityConfig.Color`
- initializes `ItemIndexMap`'s palette with those colors:
 - `ItemIndexMap.InitColorPalette(colorPalette)`

Why it matters:

- `ItemIndexMap` values are treated as *indices into `CellEntityConfigs`*.
- The palette allows consistent visualization of “which entity index is in this cell”.

CellObjectLayerConfigAsset

Source:

```
com.freewebtime.hexterrains/Runtime/CellObjects/Data/CellObjectLayerConfigAsset.cs
```

Factory mapping:

- `CellObjectLayerConfigAsset.CreateTerrainLayer()` → `new CellObjectLayer()`

This asset contains both:

- runtime-used fields (renderer + baked visuals + LOD settings), and
- editor/baking inputs (authoring objects, bake helpers).

Additional fields and how they participate in `CellObjectLayer` initialization:

`_bulkRendererAsset` / `BulkRenderer`

Type: `BulkRendererAsset` (serialized), exposed as `IBulkRenderer`

Where it’s used during initialization:

- In `CellObjectLayer.Init<T> :`
 - `BulkRenderer = args.BulkRenderer`

Used later during rendering:

- `CellObjectLayer.Render(...)` uses `BulkRenderer.RenderEntities(...)`.

`_useLODSettings` / `UseLODSettings`

Type: `bool`

Meaning:

- Whether this layer should use the layer-wide LOD ranges derived from `_LODDistances` / `_LODSettings`.

Where it’s used:

- Primarily affects editor-side baking (`BakeLODSettings`) and the getter `GetObjectsLODSettings()`.
- Runtime consumes the resulting `LODSettings` list (below).

`_LODDistances` / `LODDistances`

Type: `List<float>`

Meaning:

- Editor-friendly input for LOD band distances (each entry becomes a max distance for a LOD band).

Used by:

- BakeLODSettings() to produce _LODSettings .

`_LODSettings / LODSettings`

Type: `List<CellObjectLayerLODSettings>`

Where it's used during initialization:

- In `CellObjectLayer.Init<T>` when `initArgs` is `ICellObjectLayerConfig`:
 - copies list into `CellObjectLayer.LODSettings` (native list)
 - sets `CellObjectLayer.LODsCount = args.LODsCount`

Also used later:

- `RenderLODs(...)` selects which LOD layer to render based on camera zoom and `LODSettings` .

Baked data fields (`_bakedObjectConfigs`, `_bakedObjectStateConfigs`, `_bakedVisualItemSettings`, `_bakedStatesLODSettings`, `_colorPalette`)

Types:

- `List<CellObjectConfig>` (`BakedObjectConfigs`)
- `List<CellObjectStateConfig>` (`BakedObjectStateConfigs`)
- `List<CellObjectVisualItemSettings>` (`BakedVisualItemSettings`)
- `List<CellObjectLODSettings>` (`BakedStatesLODSettings`)
- `List<Color32>` (`ColorPalette`)

Meaning:

- These represent the precomputed runtime-ready data used by jobs that compute per-cell render items.

Where they're used during initialization:

- In `CellObjectLayer.Init<T>`:
 - calls `InitVisuals(...)` using:
 - `args.GetCellObjectConfigs()` (usually `BakedObjectConfigs`)
 - `args.GetCellObjectStateConfigs()`
 - `args.GetColorPalette()` (used to set `ItemIndexMap.ColorMap` palette)
 - `args.GetVisualItemSettings()` (usually `BakedVisualItemSettings`)
 - `args.GetObjectStatesLODSettings()` (usually `BakedStatesLODSettings`)

Key effect:

- Populates `CellObjectLayer.AllCellObjectVisuals` and `CellObjectLayer.AllCellObjectsLODSettings`
- Updates the `ItemIndexMap` color palette via `UpdateColorPalette(copyColorPaletteFrom)`

`_statesCountPerObject / StatesCountPerObject`

Type: `int`

Meaning:

- Defines how `ItemStateMap` values map into baked state data.
- Common pattern: `globalStateIndex = (objectIndex * StatesCountPerObject) + stateIndex`.

Where it's used during initialization:

- In `CellObjectLayer.Init<T> :`
 - `StatesCountPerObject = args.StatesCountPerObject`

Where it's used later:

- Passed into `CalcCellObjectsLODLayerJob*` as `StatesCountPerObject`.

`_maxSubmeshesPerCell / MaxSubmeshesPerCell`

Type: `int`

Meaning:

- Upper bound for how many render sub-items a single cell object can emit (capacity planning).

Where it's used during initialization:

- In `CellObjectLayer.Init<T> :`
 - `MaxSubmeshesPerCell = args.MaxSubmeshesPerCell`
- Then `InitRenderEntitiesLODs()` allocates/initializes each `BulkRenderItemsDataLayer` with:
 - `Settings.CellsCount * MaxSubmeshesPerCell`

Impact:

- Directly affects memory/capacity of the per-LOD render-items buffers.

Summary: which runtime layer each config asset creates

Config asset	Runtime layer created by <code>CreateTerrainLayer()</code>
<code>CellEntityLayerConfigAsset</code>	<code>CellEntityLayer</code>
<code>CellObjectLayerConfigAsset</code>	<code>CellObjectLayer</code>

Both inherit the shared initialization behavior from `CellItemLayerConfigAsset<TLayer>` via `CellItemLayer.Init(settings, initArgs)`.

Appendix: shared init-args structs used by this config

`InitCellValueDataLayerArgs<T>`

Used by: state, local position, local rotation, local scale

Key fields:

- DefaultValue (used when resizing layers)
- IsFillWithValue + FillValue
- IsFillWithRandomValues + RandomMinValue + RandomMaxValue
- IsApplySourceTexture + SourceTexture + SourceTextureValueOffset + SourceTextureValueScale

InitColorMapCellValueDataLayerArgs<T>

Used by: CellItemIndexArgs (index map + palette + optional auto-color mode)

Adds:

- ColorPalette
- AutoColorMapMode
- plus MinValue / MaxValue used by some color mapping modes

CellRegionLayer (Regions) — lifecycle, updates, rendering

This document explains how `CellRegionLayer` stores “region per cell” data, how it is created/initialized, how derived region data is rebuilt, and how the per-cell `ColorMap` is copied into `Texture2D` instances during a frame.

1) What `CellRegionLayer` is

`CellRegionLayer` (file: `Runtime/Regions/Data/CellRegionLayer.cs`) is a `HexTerrainLayer` responsible for:

- Storing **one integer region id per cell** (`CellRegionMap`)
- Building **derived structures** for region queries:
 - `RegionCells` : region id → list of cell indices in that region
 - `RegionSizes` : region id → number of cells in that region
- Producing a **per-cell color buffer** (`CellRegionMap.ColorMap`) that can be copied to a `Texture2D` for UI/material usage

Core data layers

Field	Type	Meaning
<code>CellRegionMap</code>	<code>ColorMapCellValueDataLayer_Int</code>	The authoritative “region id per cell” map (+ an associated <code>ColorMap</code>)
<code>RegionCells</code>	<code>NativeParallelMultiHashMapDataLayer<int, uint></code>	Built from <code>CellRegionMap</code> when it changes
<code>RegionSizes</code>	<code>NativeListDataLayer<uint></code>	Built from <code>CellRegionMap</code> when it changes (length is set to 255)

2) “CellRegion is simply an integer value per cell”

`CellRegionMap` stores an `int` per cell index.

- **Cell index**: linear index in `[0 .. CellsCount-1]`
- **Cell value**: region id (`int`)
 - Expected to be **non-negative**

Dirty tracking (why updates are cheap)

All these data layers are **chunked** (derive from `ChunkedDataLayer`). When you set one cell value, only the cell’s chunk (and sometimes neighbors if the cell sits on a chunk edge) is marked dirty.

Key behavior (from `ChunkedDataLayer` / `NativeListChunkedDataLayer`):

- `TrySetData(index, value) → SetData(index, value) → SetCellDirty(index, checkEdges: true)`
- `SetCellDirty(...)`:
 - marks the chunk dirty in `ChunkDirtyGrid`
 - adds chunk index to `DirtyChunks`
 - calls `SetDirty(true)` on the layer

This is what makes per-frame recalculation scalable: jobs can skip cells whose chunks aren't dirty.

3) Initialization: how a `CellRegionLayer` is created and initialized

There are two layers of "ownership":

1. The **layer instance**: `CellRegionLayer`
2. The **group component** attached to the terrain ECS entity: `CellRegionLayerGroup`

3.1 `CellRegionLayerGroup` (what it is)

`CellRegionLayerGroup` (file: `Runtime/Regions/Data/CellRegionLayerGroup.cs`) is:

- a managed ECS component: `class CellRegionLayerGroup : HexTerrainLayerGroup<CellRegionLayer>, IComponentData`
- a container for **multiple** `CellRegionLayer` instances

This is the standard pattern in this framework: a *group* component is attached to a terrain entity, and it contains one or more managed layer instances.

3.2 `CreateCellRegionLayerGroupRequest` → layer creation

`CreateCellRegionLayerGroupRequest` (file: `Runtime/Regions/Data/CreateCellRegionLayerGroupRequest.cs`) is a buffer element that can create a layer:

- It holds:
 - `Name (FixedString128Bytes)`
 - `Args (UnityObjectRef<CellRegionLayerConfigAsset>)`
- `CreateTerrainLayer()` calls `config.CreateTerrainLayer()` which returns `new CellRegionLayer()`.

3.3 `CellRegionLayerConfigAsset` (how init parameters are authored)

`CellRegionLayerConfigAsset` (file: `Runtime/Regions/Data/CellRegionLayerConfigAsset.cs`) provides:

- `InitValuesArgs` of type `InitColorMapCellValueDataLayerArgs<int>`
 - initial fill options (fill constant/random/from texture)
 - min/max values (used by some color modes)
 - `AutoColorMapMode`
 - `ColorPalette` (list of `Color32`)
- `AutoFillColorPalette()` helper (editor context menu)
 - uses `AutoColorMapSettings` to generate a palette sized for `MaxValue`

3.4 Group hooks that actually initialize the layer

`CellRegionLayerGroup` overrides two important methods:

- `CreateTerrainLayer<TInitArgs>(initArgs)`
 - creates the layer (usually via factory)
 - sets `layer.Name` from the request
- `InitTerrainLayer<TInitArgs>(layer, settings, initArgs)`
 - calls `layer.Init(settings, request.Args.Value)` if the init args match

3.5 `CellRegionLayer.Init(...)`: what gets allocated and configured

`CellRegionLayer.Init(HexTerrainSettings settings)` allocates/initializes:

- `CellRegionMap` → `Init(settings.CellsCount, settings)`
- `RegionCells` → `Init(settings.CellsCount, Allocator.Persistent)`
- `RegionSizes` → `Init(255, Allocator.Persistent)`
- then `base.Init(settings)` which updates `Settings` and may mark dirty on resize

`CellRegionLayer.Init(settings, ICellRegionConfig args)` then applies config:

- `InitColoredDataLayer(CellRegionMap, args.InitValuesArgs)`

That call delegates to the extension `ColorMapCellValueDataLayer<T>.InitColoredDataLayer(args)` which:

- applies fill options (`IsFillWithValue` , `IsFillWithRandomValues` , `IsApplySourceTexture`)
- sets `AutoColorMapMode` , `MinValue` , `MaxValue` when the layer supports auto color mapping
- initializes the `ColorPalette`
- marks all chunks dirty

4) Updating values at runtime

4.1 Writing values

Primary API:

- `SetCellRegion(int cellIndex, int regionIndex)`
 - calls `CellRegionMap.TrySetData(cellIndex, regionIndex)`
 - this marks the affected chunk(s) dirty

Bulk API:

- `SetAllCellsRegion(int regionIndex)`
 - fills the entire map
 - marks all chunks dirty

Read API:

- `GetCellRegion(int cellIndex)` returns `int?`

4.2 Rebuilding derived region data

When region ids change, you often need:

- `CalcRegionsCells(dependency)`
Builds `RegionCells` (region → cells list)
- `CalcRegionsSizes(dependency)`
Builds `RegionSizes` (region → count)

Both methods bail out unless `CellRegionMap.IsDirty == true`.

`CalcRegionsCells(...)` job

- Clears `RegionCells`
- Schedules `CalcRegionsCellsJob ( IJobParallelFor )`:
 - reads `CellValuesMap[index]` (region id)
 - does `SortedValues.Add(regionId, (uint)index)`

`CalcRegionsSizes(...)` job

- Ensures `RegionSizes` length is 255
- Resets all entries to 0
- Schedules `CalcRegionsSizesJob ( IJob )`:
 - loops through all cells
 - increments `RegionSizes[regionId]`

Important constraint:

- `CalcRegionsSizesJob` assumes region ids are valid indices (non-negative). In practice, keep region ids ≥ 0 .

5) How the integer region id becomes a cell color

`CellRegionMap` is `ColorMapCellValueDataLayer_Int`, which derives from:

- `AutoColorMapCellValueDataLayer<int> → ColorMapCellValueDataLayer<int>`
- and owns:
 - the values (`NativeList<int> Data`)
 - the colors (`ColorMapDataLayer ColorMap`), which is a `CellColorsDataLayer` + a `ColorPalette`

5.1 Color calculation modes

`AutoColorMapCellValueDataLayer<T>.CalculateColorMap(dependency)` chooses a mode:

- `GradientThroughPalette`
- `ColorIndexByValue`
- `Custom`

For region visualization, the typical choice is:

- `AutoColorMapMode.ColorIndexByValue`

5.2 ColorIndexByValue: palette lookup

`ColorMapCellValueDataLayer_Int.CalculateColorMap_ColorIndexByValue(...)` schedules `GetCellValueColorsFromPaletteJob_Int` :

- For each cell index:
 - skips work if the cell's chunk is not dirty (`ChunkDirtyGrid`)
 - `value = CellValues[index]` (region id)
 - if `0 <= value < ColorPalette.Length` : `Color = ColorPalette[value]`
 - else `Color = DefaultColor` (default is transparent)

Result: `CellRegionMap.ColorMap.Data[index]` becomes the final per-cell color.

6) How ColorMap is copied to a Texture2D

The actual CPU → Texture2D copy happens in `CellColorsDataLayer.ApplyColorsToTexture(Texture2D texture)` :

1. `CompleteAllJobs()`
Ensures any scheduled color calculation jobs are finished before reading `ColorMap.Data` .
2. Ensure texture size matches terrain size
If `texture.width/height != Settings.TerrainSize.x/y` :
 - `texture.Reinitialize(width, height, TextureFormat.RGBA32, mipmaps: false)` (defaults)
3. Upload pixels + apply
 - `texture.SetPixelData(ColorMap.Data.AsArray(), 0)`
 - `texture.Apply()`

So the `Texture2D` ends up containing a 2D image where each pixel corresponds to one terrain cell.

7) What happens during a frame (render-side path)

The system that performs the per-frame texture update is:

- `UpdateColorMapTexturesSystem` (file: `Runtime/Systems/UpdateColorMapTexturesSystem.cs`)
- runs in `HexTerrainsRenderGroup` (presentation phase)

7.1 System call chain

`UpdateColorMapTexturesSystem.OnUpdate()` does:

- Query terrains with:
 - `HexTerrain`, `HexTerrainViewMode`, `HexTerrainVisibility`, `ViewModeCollectionConfigComponent`
 - excluding `NotInitializedTerrain`
- If not visible → returns
- Loads the current view-mode config from `ViewModeCollectionConfigAsset`
- Computes `isViewModeDirty` if the `HexTerrainViewMode` component changed since last frame
- Calls:
 - `viewModeConfig.UpdateColorMap(EntityManager, terrainEntity, isViewModeDirty)`

7.2 View-mode config decides *which* map(s) are copied

`ViewModeConfigAssetBase` provides helpers for pulling layers from ECS:

- `GetTerrainLayer<TLayerComponent, TLayer>(...)`
 - uses `entityManager.TryGetComponentObject<TLayerComponent>(terrainEntity, out layerComponent)`
 - then `layerComponent.GetLayer<TLayer>(layerReference)`

Two common view-mode config implementations:

- `ViewModeConfigAsset` (texture list driven)
- `UniversalViewModeConfigAsset` (explicit list of "items" each with a texture)

For regions, `UniversalViewModeConfigAsset` uses:

- `GetTerrainLayer<CellRegionLayerGroup, CellRegionLayer>(...)`
- then returns `cellRegionLayer.CellRegionMap?.ColorMap`

7.3 The final "copy if dirty" condition

All view-mode implementations ultimately call:

- `ViewModeConfigAssetBase.UpdateColorMapTexture(CellColorsDataLayer colorMap, bool isViewModeDirty, Texture2D texture)`

It copies **only if**:

- `colorMap.IsDirty == true` **or** `isViewModeDirty == true`

And the copy itself is:

- `colorMap.ApplyColorsToTexture(texture)`

8) Cleanup and disposal

8.1 Cleanup() (per-frame dirty reset)

`CellRegionLayer.Cleanup()` calls:

- `CellRegionMap.Cleanup()`
- `RegionSizes.Cleanup()`
- `RegionCells.Cleanup()`

Most layers implement cleanup at the beginning of frame by clearing dirty chunk flags when `IsDirty` is true, so it is possible to cheaply detect new changes down the frame.

There is also:

- `CleanupAsync(dependency)` which schedules the "clear dirty flags" work as jobs and combines dependencies.

8.2 Dispose() (free persistent memory)

`CellRegionLayer.Dispose()` disposes:

- `CellRegionMap` (includes its `ColorMap` + palette)
- `RegionCells`
- `RegionSizes`

`CellColorsDataLayer.ApplyColorsToTexture()` and `CellRegionLayer.SerializeLayer()` both call `CompleteAllJobs()` to ensure no jobs are still using disposed native memory.

9) Serialization

`CellRegionLayer` supports `ISerializableTerrainLayer`:

- `SerializeLayer(BinaryWriter writer)`
 - `CompleteAllJobs()`
 - serializes `CellRegionMap` (values)
 - `DeserializeLayer(BinaryReader reader, HexTerrainSettings terrainSettings)`
 - `CompleteAllJobs()`
 - `Init(terrainSettings)` to ensure correct sizing
 - deserializes `CellRegionMap`
 - `SetAllDirty(true)` to force refresh (including `ColorMap` recalculation + texture copy)
-

10) Summary diagram (frame flow)

flowchart TD

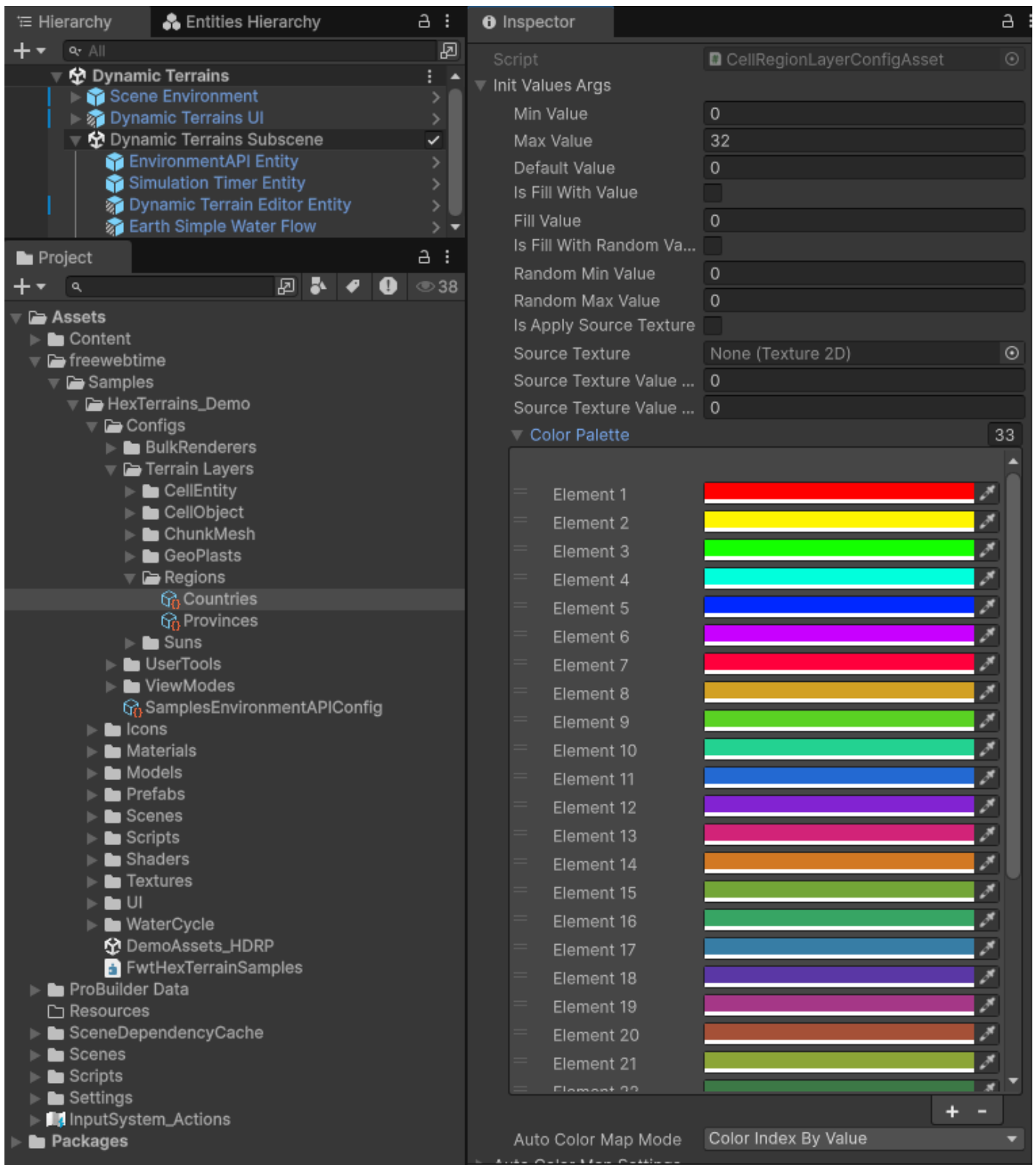
```
A["Gameplay/editor code modifies regions (SetCellRegion / SetAllCellsRegion)"] --> B["CellRegionMap marks chunks dirty (ChunkDirtyGrid + DirtyChunks)"]
B --> C["Optional: CalcRegionsCells / CalcRegionsSizes rebuild derived region data"]
B --> D["CellRegionMap.CalculateColorMap schedules jobs (palette lookup or gradient)"]
D --> E["Presentation: UpdateColorMapTexturesSystem calls viewModeConfig.UpdateColorMap(...)"]
E --> F["ViewModeConfig chooses CellRegionMap.ColorMap and target Texture2D"]
F --> G["CellColorsDataLayer.ApplyColorsToTexture completes jobs, SetPixelData, Apply"]
```

Practical notes / gotchas

- **Region id range matters**
 - For palette-based coloring (`ColorIndexByValue`), region ids should be valid palette indices.
 - For `RegionSizes` indexing, keep region ids non-negative and within `[0..InitValuesArgs.MaxValue]`
- **Texture size is terrain size**
 - The target `Texture2D` is reinitialized to `Settings.TerrainSize` if needed.
- **Color calculation is separate from texture copy**
 - The render system copies `ColorMap` → `Texture2D`.

- The `ColorMap` itself must be calculated (typically via `CellRegionLayer.CalculateColorMap(...)` / `CellRegionMap.CalculateColorMap(...)` in your update pipeline). The copy step will block until jobs complete, but it won't invent colors if you never schedule the calculation.

CellRegionLayerConfigAsset



`CellRegionLayerConfigAsset` is a Unity `ScriptableObject` that configures how a `CellRegionLayer` initializes its **cell → region index map** (`CellRegionMap`), including its **color palette / auto color mapping**.

It plays two roles:

1. Layer factory

Inherits `HexTerrainLayerConfigAsset<CellRegionLayer>` (implements `ITerrainLayerFactory`), so a `HexTerrainLayerGroup<T>` can call `CreateTerrainLayer()` on the asset to instantiate a `CellRegionLayer`.

2. Initialization payload

Implements `ICellRegionConfig`, which `CellRegionLayer.Init(settings, args)` consumes to initialize the region map.

Source:

```
com.freewebtime.hexterrains/Runtime/Regions/Data/CellRegionLayerConfigAsset.cs
```

How this config is used during `CellRegionLayer` initialization

At runtime the `CellRegionLayer` is initialized in two stages:

1. `CellRegionLayer.Init(settings)` allocates/initializes the internal data layers:
 - `CellRegionMap` (per-cell region index)
 - `RegionCells` (region index → list of cells)
 - `RegionSizes` (region index → cell count), initialized to capacity 255
2. `CellRegionLayer.Init(settings, ICellRegionConfig args)` applies the config:
 - calls `InitColoredDataLayer(CellRegionMap, args.InitValuesArgs)` to initialize:
 - the region indices (optionally filled/random/texture-driven)
 - the color palette & auto-color-map mode for `CellRegionMap.ColorMap`
 - dirty flags (so downstream computations can react)

flowchart TD

```
A["Scene passes CellRegionLayerConfigAsset as init args"] --> B["HexTerrainLayerGroup<T>.CreateTerrainLayer(initArgs)"]
B --> C["CellRegionLayerConfigAsset.CreateTerrainLayer() → new CellRegionLayer()"]
C --> D["CellRegionLayer.Init(settings) allocates Region layers"]
D --> E["CellRegionLayer.Init(settings, args) applies InitValuesArgs to CellRegionMap"]
E --> F["CellRegionMap becomes dirty → CalcRegionsCells(Entity, CellRegionLayer, int) / CalcRegionSizes(JobHandle) can run"]
```

What initialization affects later

Because `InitColoredDataLayer(...)` marks chunks dirty, the following methods will typically do work after initialization (or after edits):

- `CellRegionLayer.CalculateColorMap(...)` (uses palette + values)
- `CellRegionLayer.CalcRegionsCells(...)` (rebuilds `RegionCells`) — runs only if `CellRegionMap.IsDirty`
- `CellRegionLayer.CalcRegionsSizes(...)` (recomputes `RegionSizes`) — runs only if `CellRegionMap.IsDirty`

Field reference:

CellRegionLayerConfigAsset

1) Init Values Args (`_initValuesArgs` / `InitValuesArgs`)

Type: `InitColorMapCellValueDataLayerArgs<int>`

Meaning:

- Controls how `CellRegionLayer.CellRegionMap` is initialized:
 - what integer region index each cell starts with
 - how the color map is generated (palette + auto-color-map mode)

Where it's used:

- In `CellRegionLayer.Init(settings, ICellRegionConfig args) :`
 - `InitColoredDataLayer(CellRegionMap, args.InitValuesArgs)`

What it affects:

- **Initial region assignment** (the values stored in `CellRegionMap.Data`)
- **Color map rendering** of regions (via `CellRegionMap.ColorMap`), which depends on:
 - `InitValuesArgs.ColorPalette`
 - `InitValuesArgs.AutoColorMapMode`
 - `InitValuesArgs.MinValue / MaxValue` (depending on the selected mode)

Important implementation behavior (from `InitColoredDataLayer` extension):

- Always calls `InitDataLayer(...)` first (fill/random/texture apply if enabled)
- If the data layer supports auto color mapping, applies:
 - `AutoColorMapMode` , `MinValue` , `MaxValue`
- Calls `InitColorPalette(args.ColorPalette)`
- Marks all chunks dirty

Practical constraints implied by `CellRegionLayer`

- `RegionSizes` is initialized with a fixed length `255` , and region-size calculation assumes a fixed-size array of `255` entries.
- In practice, keep region indices in a range that matches that (`0..254` or `0..255` depending on how you treat the last slot). The layer jobs allocate/clear `255` entries each time.

2) Auto Color Map Settings (`_autoColorMapSettings`)

Type: `AutoColorMapSettings`

Meaning:

- Editor/runtime helper settings used to **generate** a color palette (list of `Color32`) for region indices.

Where it's used:

- Only inside the config asset method:
 - `AutoFillColorPalette()`
- That method calls:
 - `_autoColorMapSettings.AutoFillColorPalette(_initValuesArgs.ColorPalette, _initValuesArgs.MaxValue, true);`

What it affects:

- It mutates `InitValuesArgs.ColorPalette` in-place (clears and refills it).
- By default it makes the **first color transparent** (`isFirstColorTransparent = true`), which is commonly used to represent "region 0 = unassigned/none".

AutoColorMapSettings fields (generation behavior)

These fields control how the palette is generated in HSV space:

- `StepsPerCircle`
Used to compute how many "circles" of colors exist (affects saturation/brightness progression per circle). (Note: the current hue calculation uses `HueStep * i` , so "circle" impacts saturation/brightness more than hue.)
- `CircleOffset`
Present in the struct but currently not applied (the offset formula is commented out in `AutoFillColorPalette`).
- `MinSaturation` , `MaxSaturation`
Saturation is interpolated from min→max across circles.
- `MinBrightness` , `MaxBrightness`
Brightness/value is interpolated from min→max across circles.
- `HueStep`
Hue progresses by `HueStep` per color: `hue = (HueStep * i) % 1f` .

3) AutoFillColorPalette() (context menu action)

This is not a serialized field, but it's part of the asset's authoring workflow.

How it's intended to be used:

- In the Inspector, right-click the asset header and run `AutoFillColorPalette` .
- It regenerates `InitValuesArgs.ColorPalette` based on:
 - `InitValuesArgs.MaxValue` (the requested palette "count")
 - `_autoColorMapSettings` parameters
 - with the first color set to transparent

What to watch:

- The generated palette size depends on the exact value passed as `count` (`InitValuesArgs.MaxValue` as implemented).

- If you expect a palette entry for region index `MaxValue` *and* region indices are inclusive, verify the palette length matches your indexing scheme (this method does exactly what it's coded to do).
-

Summary: what this asset controls vs what it does not

Controls directly (during init):

- `CellRegionMap` initial values (region indices per cell)
- `CellRegionMap` color palette + auto-color-map mode

Controls indirectly (via dirty flags / downstream jobs):

- Whether `RegionCells` / `RegionSizes` will be recomputed after init

Does **not** directly configure:

- The maximum region count used by `RegionSizes` (hardcoded to 255 in `CellRegionLayer.Init`)
- Any region "metadata" beyond an integer id (names, borders, etc. are outside this layer)

GeoPlast Layers (Data, Simulation, Rendering)

This page documents the `GeoPlastLayer` base class and all layers that inherit from it, including how GeoPlast layers are **created**, **initialized**, **updated**, **simulated**, **rendered**, **cleaned up**, **serialized**, and **disposed**.

It also explains the **simulation timing model**:

- `HexTerrainSimulationTimer` (global simulation time + throttling)
- `FrameCycleSettings` (per-feature simulation cadence, e.g., heat every 8th simulation frame)

1. Class hierarchy

GeoPlast layers form a small inheritance chain:

- `HexTerrainLayer`
 - `GeoPlastLayer`
 - `VisualGeoPlastLayer`
 - `DynamicGeoPlastLayer`
 - `MaterialGeoPlastLayer`

In short:

- `GeoPlastLayer` = storage + volume/ceiling computation + simulation hooks.
- `VisualGeoPlastLayer` = renders layer maps into a `ChunkMeshLayer` (heightmap/opacity).
- `DynamicGeoPlastLayer` = **volume flow** simulation (horizontal + vertical via up/down links).
- `MaterialGeoPlastLayer` = **heat** (heat amount + temperature), **heat diffusion**, **heat advection with volume flow**, **temperature-driven vertical volume flow**, and optional **density-by-temperature**.

2. Core data model (`GeoPlastLayer`)

`GeoPlastLayer` stores per-cell scalar fields (implemented as data layers):

Concept	Field	Type	Meaning
Plast "mass"	<code>AmountMap</code>	<code>ColorMapCellValueDataLayer_Float</code>	Amount of geo plast (unitless "amount").
Density	<code>DensityMap</code>	<code>ColorMapCellValueDataLayer_Float</code>	Density factor (volume per amount).
Volume	<code>VolumeMap</code>	<code>ColorMapCellValueDataLayer_Float</code>	Computed: <code>Amount * Density</code> .
Bedrock height	<code>BedrockHeightMap</code>	<code>CellValueDataLayer<float></code>	Base height for this layer (usually copied from bedrock layer's ceiling).
Ceiling height	<code>CeilingHeightMap</code>	<code>CellValueDataLayer<float></code>	Computed: <code>BedrockHeight + Volume</code> .

Additionally:

- `GeoPlastSettings` (base density + whether a bedrock reference is required)
- `BedrockPlastReference` (`HexTerrainLayerReference`) to another `GeoPlastLayer` that acts as bedrock source

2.1 “Amount vs Density vs Volume”

GeoPlast uses a common pattern:

- **Amount** is the conserved-ish “stuff” that moves between cells and layers.
- **Density** converts that to volume/height for rendering and flow computations.
- **Volume** is derived:
 - `Volume = clamp(Amount * Density, 0, +inf)` (`CalculateGeoPlastVolumeJob`)

This is important because:

- Flow simulation is computed primarily in **volume space** (height/volume differences).
- Application of flow typically changes **AmountMap** (converted back using density).

3. Creation & initialization

3.1 Authoring (Unity scene → ECS buffers)

GeoPlast layers are requested via authoring components:

- `GeoPlastLayerGroupAuthoring` bakes a buffer of `CreateGeoPlastLayerRequest` onto the terrain entity.
 - Each request stores:
 - `Name`
 - `Args = GeoPlastLayerConfigAsset` (a `ScriptableObject` factory + init config)

Relevant code:

- `GeoPlastLayerGroupAuthoring` creates `CreateGeoPlastLayerRequest` entries.
- `CreateGeoPlastLayerRequest` implements `ITerrainLayerFactory` and calls `Args.Value.CreateTerrainLayer()`.

3.2 Config assets (layer factories + init config)

The package provides config assets matching the inheritance chain:

- `GeoPlastLayerConfigAsset` → creates `GeoPlastLayer`
- `VisualGeoPlastLayerConfigAsset` → creates `VisualGeoPlastLayer`
- `DynamicGeoPlastLayerConfigAsset` → creates `DynamicGeoPlastLayer`
- `MaterialGeoPlastLayerConfigAsset` → creates `MaterialGeoPlastLayer`

Each config asset implements the matching init interface:

- `IInitGeoPlastLayerConfig`
- `IVisualGeoPlastLayerConfig`
- `IInitDynamicGeoPlastLayerArgs`
- `IInitMaterialGeoPlastLayerArgs`

These interfaces supply:

- settings structs (GeoPlast / Visual / Dynamic / Material)
- initialization args for maps (amount, density, volume, heat, temperature)
- layer references (bedrock; up/down flow targets; chunk mesh layer target)

3.3 Runtime initialization (Init)

All GeoPlast layers follow this pattern:

1. `Init(HexTerrainSettings settings)` allocates/initializes data layers to match `settings.CellsCount`.
2. `Init(settings, args)` calls base `Init(settings)` and then `InitLayerData(args)` to apply config and initial map data.

Notable behavior:

- If `GeoPlastSettings.HasBedrock == false`, `BedrockHeightMap` is filled with 0 during init.

4. Update vs Simulation (two pipelines)

GeoPlast has two distinct “pipelines” you typically run every frame:

4.1 Update pipeline (derived maps, recomputed when dirty)

This computes maps that are *derived from other maps* and uses dirty flags to skip work.

`GeoPlastLayerGroup.Update()` runs, in order:

1. `PreparePlastUpdate()`
2. `CalculateDensity()`
3. `CalculateVolume()`
4. `CalculateBedrockAndCeiling()`
5. `DoPlastUpdate()`

Base `GeoPlastLayer` implements:

- `CalculateVolume()` (only if `AmountMap` or `DensityMap` dirty)
- `CalculateBedrock()` (copies bedrock ceiling → bedrock height, if enabled and bedrock ceiling dirty)
- `CalculateCeiling()` (only if bedrock or volume dirty)

Derived types extend `PreparePlastUpdate()` / `CalculateDensity()`:

- `MaterialGeoPlastLayer` computes:
 - `TemperatureMap = HeatMap / AmountMap` (`CalculateGeoPlastTemperatureJob`)
 - density optionally scales by temperature (`CalculateGeoPlastDensityByTemperatureJob`)

4.2 Simulation pipeline (behavioral “movement” over time)

Simulation is a 3-stage hook model called by `GeoPlastLayerGroup.Simulate(...)`:

1. `PrepareSimulation(simTime, group, deps)`
2. `CalculateSimulation(simTime, group, deps)`
3. `ApplySimulation(simTime, group, deps)`

The intent is:

- **Prepare:** clear/prepare intermediate buffers (flow potentials, flow maps, dirty chunk sets).
- **Calculate:** compute “what should happen” (potentials + flow maps).
- **Apply:** apply flow maps to persistent state (amount/heat maps).

`GeoPlastLayerGroup` also guards against double-simulating the same timer frame:

- It stores `LastSimulationFrame` and ignores repeated calls with the same `simulationTime.FrameCount`.

5. Simulation timing

5.1 HexTerrainSimulationTimer (global simulation clock)

`HexTerrainSimulationTimer` is an ECS component containing:

- `Elapsed` (total simulation seconds)
- `DeltaTime` (seconds since last simulation frame; used in flow speeds)
- `TimeScale`
- `FrameCount` (simulation frame index)
- `SimulationDelay` + `SimulationDelayCounter` (skip simulation frames globally)
- fixed timestep controls: `IsFixedTimeStep`, `FixedTimeStep`
- pause controls: `IsPaused`, `IsTickAndPause`

Creation

`HexTerrainSimulationAuthoring` bakes a `HexTerrainSimulationTimer` component with initial values (time scale, delay, pause flags, fixed step).

Updates (conceptual contract)

This package expects some “timer update” step in your world that:

- stops advancing if `IsPaused` is true
- advances one tick then pauses when `IsTickAndPause` is set
- uses `SimulationDelay` / `SimulationDelayCounter` to skip simulation ticks globally
- updates `DeltaTime`, `Elapsed`, and increments `FrameCount` on simulation ticks

The GeoPlast systems consume the *result* of this contract (especially `DeltaTime` and `FrameCount`) rather than implementing the timer progression themselves.

5.2 FrameCycleSettings (per-feature cadence)

`FrameCycleSettings` is used to run a *specific* simulation feature on only certain simulation frames:

- `FramesCycleLength` : cycle length in simulation frames
- `FramesCycleOffset` : which frame inside the cycle is active

A frame is a “tick” for the cycle if:

```
simulationTime.FrameCount % FramesCycleLength == FramesCycleOffset
```

Example

If:

- `FramesCycleLength = 4`
- `FramesCycleOffset = 2`

Then the feature runs on simulation frames:

- 2, 6, 10, 14, ...

Where it's used

- `DynamicGeoPlastSettings.VolumeFlowFrameCycle` controls **volume flow** cadence
- `MaterialGeoPlastSettings.HeatFlowFrameCycle` controls **independent heat diffusion** cadence

This means you can run:

- volume flow every 2nd simulation frame
- heat diffusion every 8th simulation frame ...while still updating derived maps every frame (if needed) via the update pipeline.

6. Volume flow (Dynamic GeoPlast)

6.1 Data structures: `VolumeFlowPotentialMap` and `VolumeFlowMap`

`DynamicGeoPlastLayer` adds:

- `VolumeFlowPotentialMap` : `FlowMapDataLayer`
- `VolumeFlowMap` : `FlowMapDataLayer`
- `IncomingVolumeFlowChunks` : `NativeParallelHashSetDataLayer<int>`

`FlowMapDataLayer` is a `CellValueDataLayer<FixedArray8<float>>` plus a scalar `TotalFlowMap`.

`FixedArray8<float>` slots map to `FlowDirections`:

- 0..5 = hex neighbors
- 6 = Up
- 7 = Down

Semantics used by jobs:

- Potential maps store "desired" flow *capacity* per direction.
- Flow maps store actual flow amounts per direction for this tick.
- Total flow maps store sum of all outflow from a cell.

6.2 Simulation gating

Volume flow simulation runs only when both are true:

- some flow direction is enabled (`GeoPlastFlowSettings.IsAnyFlowEnabled`)
- the current simulation frame matches the configured `FrameCycleSettings`

Code path:

- `DynamicGeoPlastSettings.IsAnyFlowEnabledAndIsSimulationTick(simTimer)`

6.3 Prepare stage

`DynamicGeoPlastLayer.PrepareSimulation(...)` clears:

- `VolumeFlowPotentialMap + TotalFlowMap` → zeros
- `VolumeFlowMap + TotalFlowMap` → zeros
- `IncomingVolumeFlowChunks` → cleared

This prevents stale flow data from previous simulation ticks.

6.4 Calculate stage (potential → flow map)

The calculation is split:

6.4.1 Horizontal volume flow potential

`CalculateHorizontalVolumeFlowPotentialJob` computes neighbor potentials using **ceiling height differences**:

- `ceiling = bedrock + volumeLeft`
- `heightDifference = myCeiling - neighborCeiling`
- potential is `max(heightDifference, 0)`, thresholded
- it then proportionally distributes and caps potential based on available volume

Important details:

- Potential is computed using `volumeLeft = max(myVolume - alreadyAssignedPotential, 0)`, so vertical potentials can “consume” available volume too.
- The algorithm includes a `* 0.5f` factor when distributing potential share.

6.4.2 Vertical volume flow potential

`DynamicGeoPlastLayer` base implementation returns no vertical potential. `MaterialGeoPlastLayer` overrides this to compute vertical potential based on temperature (see §8.6).

6.4.3 Flow map from potentials

`CalculateVolumeFlowMapJob` converts potentials to actual per-direction flow:

- Flow speed per direction is `clamp(FlowSpeed * simulationTimer.DeltaTime, 0..1)`
- It computes an outflow amount per slot (0..7) and a total outflow.
- For horizontal flow (0.5), it marks neighbor chunks in `IncomingFlowChunks` so only affected chunks do expensive “incoming sum” work during apply.

6.5 Apply stage (flow map → AmountMap)

Applying volume flow is done in three steps:

1. **Horizontal inflow** (`ApplyHorizontalVolumeFlowMapJob`)
 - For a cell, sum inflow from neighbors' flow maps.
 - Convert inflow volume → inflow amount using *neighbor density*:
 - `flowAmount = flowVolume / neighbourDensity`
 - Add to `AmountMap` .
2. **Vertical transfer to other layers** (`ApplyVerticalVolumeFlowMapJob`)
 - Uses `UpFlowTargetLayerRef` / `DownFlowTargetLayerRef` to find the target layer.
 - For each cell, take `FlowMap[cell][Up|Down]` , convert to amount via density, and add to target layer's `AmountMap` .
3. **Subtract outflow from source** (`ApplyVolumeFlowFromCellJob`)
 - Uses `TotalFlowMap[cell]` (total outflow volume)
 - Converts volume out → amount out via density
 - `AmountMap[cell] -= flownOutVolume / density`

This separation is why vertical apply jobs only add to targets: the source subtraction is centralized and uses `TotalFlowMap` .

7. Rendering (Visual GeoPlast)

`VisualGeoPlastLayer` renders into a `ChunkMeshLayer` referenced by `SurfaceLayerRef` .

7.1 Render modes

`VisualGeoPlastSettings.RenderMode` selects which scalar drives the surface height:

- `Amount` : render `AmountMap` directly
- `Volume` : render `VolumeMap`
- `Ceiling` : render `CeilingHeightMap` (but uses `VolumeMap` as "amount proxy" for transparency/threshold logic)

7.2 Render job

Rendering is performed by `RenderGeoPlastToHeightMapJob` :

- reads:
 - chosen render values map
 - chosen render amount map (for transparency/zero-height thresholding)
 - dirty chunk grid of the render values
- writes:
 - `ChunkMeshLayer.HeightMap`
 - `ChunkMeshLayer.TransparencyMap`
 - (biome map is present but currently unused in the job)

Key behaviors:

- If the render-values chunk isn't dirty, the job skips the cell early.
 - Transparency is computed by `renderAmount <= TransparencyTreshold` and depends on `IsRenderZeroAsTransparent`.
 - "Minimum visible height" is enforced by `ZeroHeightTreshold` :
 - If non-transparent and $0 < \text{renderAmount} < \text{ZeroHeightTreshold}$, the rendered height is increased so that tiny amounts are still visible.
-

8. Heat and temperature (Material GeoPlast)

`MaterialGeoPlastLayer` adds heat simulation on top of volume simulation.

8.1 Heat is stored as "heat amount"

- `HeatMap` stores a scalar "heat amount" per cell.
- Temperature is derived:
 - $\text{Temperature} = \text{Heat} / \text{Amount}$ (`CalculateGeoPlastTemperatureJob`)
 - If $\text{Amount} \leq 0$, temperature is set to 0.

This design allows:

- heat to move independently (diffusion)
- heat to be advected with moving plast volume

8.2 Heat advection with volume flow (heat flows *with* volume)

When volume flows, a corresponding "heat flow" is derived from it:

`ApplyVolumeFlowMapToHeatFlowMapJob` :

- For each direction:
 - $\text{flowShare} = \text{flowVolume} / \text{myVolume}$
 - $\text{heatToDirection} = \text{myHeat} * \text{flowShare}$
- Accumulates into `HeatFlowMap` and `TotalHeatFlowMap`

This is what makes heat "ride along" with flowing material.

8.3 Independent heat diffusion (heat flows *without* volume)

Material heat diffusion is a separate simulation feature with its own:

- `HeatFlowFrameCycle`
- `HeatFlowPotentialMap`
- `HeatFlowMap`
- `IncomingHeatFlowChunks`

It uses the same generic `CalculateVolumeFlowMapJob`, but with `HeatMap` passed as the "volume" array, meaning:

- the mechanics of potential → flow map → apply are shared,
- but the *potentials* are computed specifically for heat.

8.4 Horizontal heat diffusion potential

`CalculateHorizontalHeatFlowPotentialJob` computes potential based on **overlapping volume columns** between adjacent cells:

- Compute overlap height:
 - `commonBedrock = max(myBedrock, neighborBedrock)`
 - `commonCeiling = min(myCeiling, neighborCeiling)`
 - `touchingHeight = commonCeiling - commonBedrock`
- If `touchingHeight <= 0`, there is no contact → no heat flow.
- Otherwise, a touching share is applied to a per-side heat budget.

This models “heat diffuses where volumes touch”.

8.5 Vertical heat flow potential (between layers)

`CalculateVerticalHeatFlowPotentialJob` computes vertical potential when:

- source has volume and heat
- target has volume (it must be able to “receive” heat in a meaningful way)

It uses a simplified touching model:

- `touchingVolume = min(myVolume * 0.5, 1)`
- `touchingShare = touchingVolume / myVolume`
- `potential = touchingShare * heatLeft`

8.6 Temperature-driven vertical volume flow (between layers)

`MaterialGeoPlastLayer` overrides vertical volume flow potential calculation using:

- `VerticalFlowByTemperatureSettings` per direction (`UpFlowByTemperatureSettings` , `DownFlowByTemperatureSettings`)
- an `ExponentialCurve` evaluated by cell temperature

`CalculateVerticalVolumeFlowPotentialJob` :

- `temperatureFactor = curve.Evaluate(myTemperature)`
- `potential = min(BaseFlow * temperatureFactor, volumeLeft)`
- writes the result into potential slot Up (6) or Down (7)

This is how you implement “evaporation/condensation” style behavior:

- hot cells produce up-potential
- cold cells produce down-potential ...depending on the curve you author.

8.7 Applying heat flow (horizontal + vertical + subtract outflow)

Heat uses the same 3-step application pattern as volume:

1. `ApplyHorizontalHeatFlowMapJob` adds incoming heat from neighbors.
2. `ApplyVerticalHeatFlowMapJob` transfers heat to linked layers via up/down references.
3. `ApplyHeatFlowFromCellJob` subtracts total heat outflow from the source cell.

8.8 When does heat apply?

In `MaterialGeoPlastLayer.ApplySimulation(...)` :

- Heat apply happens if **either**:
 - volume flow is ticking this frame (because advected heat exists), **or**
 - heat flow is ticking this frame (because diffusion is computed)

This ensures heat stays consistent with volume movement even if diffusion runs less frequently.

9. Vertical linking model (Up/Down flow targets)

Vertical movement is organized by explicit layer references:

- `UpFlowTargetLayerRef` and `DownFlowTargetLayerRef` exist on `DynamicGeoPlastLayer`
- They are configured through:
 - `IInitDynamicGeoPlastLayerArgs.UpFlowTargetLayerReference`
 - `IInitDynamicGeoPlastLayerArgs.DownFlowTargetLayerReference`

At runtime, `GetVerticalFlowTarget<T>(...)` uses `GetTerrainLayerFromParent<T>` to resolve the target from the parent `GeoPlastLayerGroup`.

Key constraints:

- For **volume vertical flow**, the target is resolved as `GeoPlastLayer`.
 - For **heat vertical flow**, the target is resolved as `MaterialGeoPlastLayer`.
 - If you link to a non-material target, vertical heat diffusion won't find a target and will no-op.
-

10. Cleanup, completion, disposal, serialization

10.1 Cleanup

Each layer implements:

- `Cleanup()` (sync)
- `CleanupAsync(JobHandle)` (job-scheduled cleanup)

Base `GeoPlastLayer.Cleanup()` calls cleanup on:

- amount/density/volume maps
- bedrock and ceiling maps

Derived layers extend this to clean flow maps, heat maps, hash sets, etc.

10.2 Completing jobs

`CompleteAllJobs()` exists to safely get/set values immediately (e.g., for serialization or debug queries). Each layer completes jobs for its owned maps (including their colormaps where applicable).

10.3 Dispose

`Dispose()` releases native allocations owned by data layers.

Important: `HexTerrainLayer.ParentLayer` is *not* disposed when a child is disposed.

10.4 Serialization

`GeoPlastLayer` implements `ISerializableTerrainLayer` and serializes:

- `AmountMap`
- `DensityMap`

`MaterialGeoPlastLayer` extends serialization by serializing:

- `HeatMap`

Derived/computed maps such as:

- `VolumeMap`
- `BedrockHeightMap`
- `CeilingHeightMap`
- flow maps ...are expected to be recomputed after load via the update pipeline.

11. How to use (practical setup)

1. Add `HexTerrainAuthoring` to create the terrain entity.
2. Add `ChunkMeshLayerGroupAuthoring` and define at least one `ChunkMeshLayer` (surface) used for height rendering.
3. Add `GeoPlastLayerGroupAuthoring` and list your `GeoPlast` layers:
 - Choose config asset type based on needed features:
 - `GeoPlastLayerConfigAsset` (data only)
 - `VisualGeoPlastLayerConfigAsset` (rendering)
 - `DynamicGeoPlastLayerConfigAsset` (volume flow)
 - `MaterialGeoPlastLayerConfigAsset` (heat + temperature behavior)
4. Configure:
 - `BedrockPlastReference` if `GeoPlastSettings.HasBedrock` is enabled.
 - `ChunkMeshLayerReference` (visual layers) to point at the surface mesh layer.
 - `UpFlowTargetLayerReference` / `DownFlowTargetLayerReference` for vertical links.
 - `FrameCycleSettings` for performance control per feature (volume vs heat).
5. Ensure the world updates:
 - `HexTerrainSimulationTimer` (advancing `FrameCount` + `DeltaTime`)
 - calls into:
 - `GeoPlastLayerGroup.Update(...)` (derived map computations)
 - `GeoPlastLayerGroup.Simulate(simTime, ...)` (flow/heat behaviors)
 - `GeoPlastLayerGroup.Render(...)` (visualization)

12. How to extend

12.1 Add a new GeoPlast layer type

Recommended approach:

1. Create a new layer class deriving the closest base:
 - rendering only → derive `VisualGeoPlastLayer`
 - volume behavior → derive `DynamicGeoPlastLayer`
 - heat/material behavior → derive `MaterialGeoPlastLayer`
2. Override hooks with correct stage semantics:
 - `PrepareSimulation(...)` :
 - clear intermediate maps / hash sets used by your simulation
 - `CalculateSimulation(...)` :
 - compute potentials and flow maps (schedule jobs, mark dirty)
 - `ApplySimulation(...)` :
 - apply flow maps into persistent maps (amount/heat/etc)
3. Follow the existing job safety pattern:
 - call `PrepareToRead()` / `PrepareToWrite()`
 - combine dependencies
 - `AddReadDependency()` / `AddWriteDependency()`
 - set dirty flags (`SetDirty(true)`) on outputs

12.2 Provide an authorable config asset

Create a `ScriptableObject` config asset that:

- derives from an existing config asset type (for reuse), or `HexTerrainLayerConfigAsset<T>`
- implements the appropriate init interface
- overrides `CreateTerrainLayer()` to construct your derived layer class

This lets `CreateGeoPlastLayerRequest` instantiate your layer from authoring without custom runtime code.

12.3 Extend flow logic

Common extension points:

- Custom horizontal flow potential (override `CalculateHorizontalVolumeFlowPotential(...)`)
- Custom vertical flow (override `CalculateVerticalVolumeFlowPotential(...)`)
- Custom coupling between volume and heat (override `ApplyVolumeFlowMapToHeatFlowMap(...)`)
- Custom rendering (override `RenderGeoPlast(...)` or render into additional chunk mesh maps)

13. Terminology mapping (requested names)

This package uses “maps” directly; conceptually they correspond to:

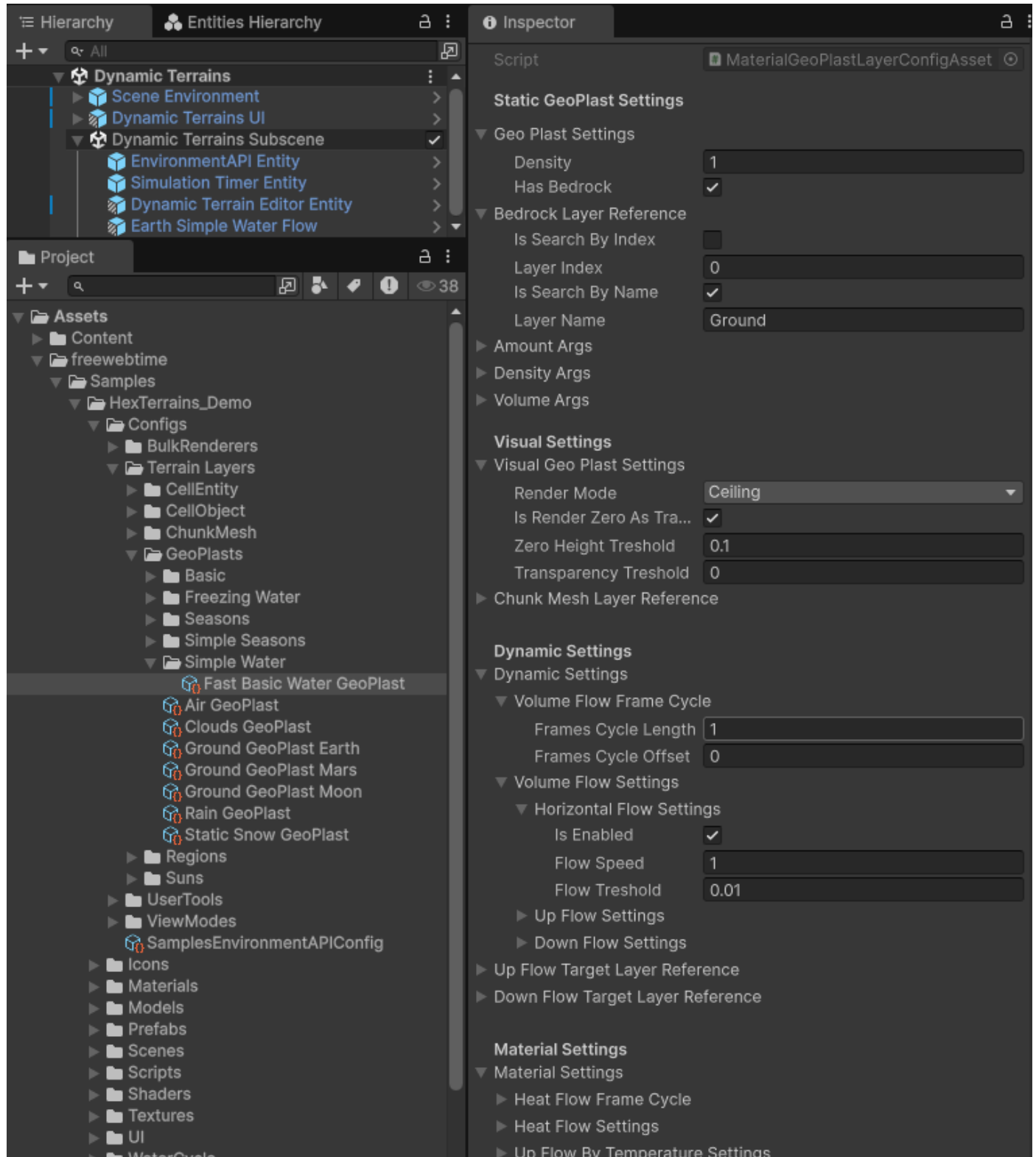
- **VolumeFlowPotential** → `DynamicGeoPlastLayer.VolumeFlowPotentialMap`
- **VolumeFlowMap** → `DynamicGeoPlastLayer.VolumeFlowMap`

- **HeatFlowPotential** → `MaterialGeoPlastLayer.HeatFlowPotentialMap`
- **HeatFlowMap** → `MaterialGeoPlastLayer.HeatFlowMap`

Each is a `FlowMapDataLayer` :

- a per-cell `FixedArray8<float>` (6 neighbors + up + down)
- plus a scalar `TotalFlowMap` for outflow totals.

GeoPlastLayer initialization (and GeoPlastLayerConfigAsset inheritance chain)



A `GeoPlastLayer` is a terrain layer that stores per-cell "plast" data (amount/density/volume) and derives additional maps (bedrock height, ceiling height). Derived `GeoPlast` layers add rendering and simulation (flow/heat) behavior.

Initialization is driven by **ScriptableObject config assets** (`GeoPlastLayerConfigAsset` and its derived types) which are passed to the runtime through `CreateGeoPlastLayerRequest` elements in a `GeoPlastLayerGroup`.

Where/how configs are applied at runtime

`GeoPlast` layers are hosted by `GeoPlastLayerGroup : HexTerrainLayerGroup<GeoPlastLayer>`.

Instead of passing config assets directly, the group expects init args of type `CreateGeoPlastLayerRequest`, which contains:

- Name (a `FixedString128Bytes`)
- Args (a `UnityObjectRef<GeoPlastLayerConfigAsset>`)

During group initialization:

- `GeoPlastLayerGroup.CreateTerrainLayer(initArgs)`:
 - calls `base.CreateTerrainLayer(initArgs)`
 - if `initArgs` is `CreateGeoPlastLayerRequest`, uses `request.Name` to set `layer.Name`
- `GeoPlastLayerGroup.InitTerrainLayer(layer, settings, initArgs)`:
 - if `initArgs` is `CreateGeoPlastLayerRequest` args, it calls:
 - `layer.Init(settings, args.Args.Value)`

The key detail is that `args.Args.Value` can be any derived asset type (`VisualGeoPlastLayerConfigAsset`, `DynamicGeoPlastLayerConfigAsset`, `MaterialGeoPlastLayerConfigAsset`). Each runtime layer reads the "extra" fields via `is IVisualGeoPlastLayerConfig`, `is IInitDynamicGeoPlastLayerArgs`, etc.

flowchart TD

```
A["Terrain entity has DynamicBuffer<CreateGeoPlastLayerRequest>"] --> B["GeoPlastLayerGroup.Init(...)"]
B --> C["CreateTerrainLayer(request) → request.Args.Value.CreateTerrainLayer()"]
C --> D["Runtime layer created (GeoPlastLayer / VisualGeoPlastLayer / DynamicGeoPlastLayer / MaterialGeoPlastLayer)"]
D --> E["InitTerrainLayer(...) calls layer.Init(settings, config)"]
E --> F["GeoPlastLayer.Init(settings) allocates all base maps"]
F --> G["InitLayerData(config) applies settings + init args (with is ... checks for derived configs)"]
```

GeoPlastLayer initialization behavior

Stage 1: allocation (`GeoPlastLayer.Init(settings)`)

Always created/initialized (per cell):

- `AmountMap` (`ColorMapCellValueDataLayer_Float`)

- `DensityMap ( ColorMapCellValueDataLayer_Float )`
- `VolumeMap ( ColorMapCellValueDataLayer_Float )`
- `BedrockHeightMap ( CellValueDataLayer<float> )`
- `CeilingHeightMap ( CellValueDataLayer<float> )`

Special-case:

- If `GeoPlastSettings.HasBedrock == false`, `BedrockHeightMap` is filled with `0` during `Init(settings)`.

Stage 2: config application (`GeoPlastLayer.Init(settings, IInitGeoPlastLayerConfig args)`)

Calls `InitLayerData(args)`, which:

- Copies layer-wide settings/references:
 - `GeoPlastSettings = args.GeoPlastSettings`
 - `BedrockPlastReference = args.BedrockPlastReference`
- Initializes value maps using config-provided init args:
 - `InitColoredDataLayer(AmountMap, args.AmountArgs)`
 - `InitColoredDataLayer(DensityMap, args.DensityArgs)`
 - `InitColoredDataLayer(VolumeMap, args.VolumeArgs)`

Implication:

- `AmountMap`, `DensityMap`, `VolumeMap` are *authorable initial state*. After that, runtime update/simulation may overwrite derived maps (and may recompute `VolumeMap` based on amount+density).

Config assets and how they affect initialization

1) Base config: `GeoPlastLayerConfigAsset`

Source: `com.freewebtime.hexterrains/Runtime/GeoPlasts/Data/GeoPlastLayerConfigAsset.cs`

Creates: `new GeoPlastLayer()`

Implements: `IInitGeoPlastLayerConfig`

`_geoPlastSettings / GeoPlastSettings (GeoPlastSettings)`

Affects:

- **Bedrock behavior**
 - If `HasBedrock` is false, `BedrockHeightMap` is initialized to `0` and `CalculateBedrock()` becomes a no-op.
- **Density math in some derived jobs**

- Used by jobs like `CalculateGeoPlastDensityByTemperatureJob` (via derived layers), as the “global” geo plast settings input.

Fields inside `GeoPlastSettings` :

- `Density`
A base density concept for the plast system. (Most of the base layer’s volume calculation uses `DensityMap` directly; temperature-based density uses this as an input in derived logic.)
- `HasBedrock`
Enables bedrock-copying behavior and bedrock-based calculations.

`_bedrockLayerReference / BedrockPlastReference` (`HexTerrainLayerReference`)

Meaning:

- Points to another `GeoPlastLayer` that acts as bedrock for this layer.

Used by:

- `GeoPlastLayer.CalculateBedrock()` :
 - resolves bedrock layer via `GetTerrainLayerFromParent<GeoPlastLayer>(BedrockPlastReference)`
 - copies bedrock’s `CeilingHeightMap` into this layer’s `BedrockHeightMap`

Affects:

- `CalculateCeiling()` (ceiling = bedrock height + volume)
- Flow potential calculations in dynamic/material layers (they depend on bedrock/ceiling comparisons)

`_amountArgs / AmountArgs` (`InitColorMapCellValueDataLayerArgs<float>`)

Used during init:

- `InitColoredDataLayer(AmountMap, AmountArgs)`

Meaning:

- Controls initial plast **amount per cell** (and its color map configuration).

Practical use:

- Fill with a constant (uniform plast), random range (noise), or apply a source texture.

`_densityArgs / DensityArgs` (`InitColorMapCellValueDataLayerArgs<float>`)

Used during init:

- `InitColoredDataLayer(DensityMap, DensityArgs)`

Meaning:

- Controls initial **density per cell** (units of volume per 1 unit of amount in this layer’s model).

Affects:

- `CalculateVolume()` because volume is computed from `AmountMap` and `DensityMap`.

`_volumeArgs / VolumeArgs` (`InitColorMapCellValueDataLayerArgs<float>`)

Used during init:

- `InitColoredDataLayer(VolumeMap, VolumeArgs)`

Meaning:

- Initial volume values (mainly useful as a starting state).

Important:

- Runtime `CalculateVolume()` can overwrite `VolumeMap` whenever `AmountMap` or `DensityMap` is dirty.

2) Visual config: `VisualGeoPlastLayerConfigAsset`

Source: `.../VisualGeoPlastLayerConfigAsset.cs`

Creates: `new VisualGeoPlastLayer()`

Implements: `IVisualGeoPlastLayerConfig` (extends `IInitGeoPlastLayerConfig`)

`_chunkMeshLayerReference / ChunkMeshLayerReference` (`HexTerrainLayerReference`)

Used during init:

- `VisualGeoPlastLayer.InitLayerData(...)` sets:
 - `SurfaceLayerRef = visualArgs.ChunkMeshLayerReference`

Used later:

- `VisualGeoPlastLayer.RenderGeoPlast(...)` resolves:
 - `ChunkMeshLayer surfaceLayer = chunkMeshLayerList.GetLayer<ChunkMeshLayer>(SurfaceLayerRef)`

Meaning:

- Which `ChunkMeshLayer` the GeoPlast values are rendered *onto* (height/biome/transparency).

`_visualGeoPlastSettings / VisualGeoPlastSettings` (`VisualGeoPlastSettings`)

Used during init:

- `VisualGeoPlastLayer.InitLayerData(...)` sets:
 - `VisualGeoPlastSettings = visualArgs.VisualGeoPlastSettings`

Used later:

- `RenderGeoPlastToHeightMapJob` reads `VisualGeoPlastSettings` to decide how to write height/biome/transparency.

Key fields:

- `RenderMode` (`Ceiling` , `Amount` , `Volume`)
 - Controls which map is rendered to the surface heightmap:
 - `Amount` : uses `AmountMap`
 - `Volume` : uses `VolumeMap`
 - `Ceiling` : uses `CeilingHeightMap` and `VolumeMap`
- `IsRenderZeroAsTransparent`
 - If true, "zero-ish" cells become transparent in the target surface's `TransparencyMap` .
- `ZeroHeightTreshold`
 - Enforces a minimum height when rendering non-zero values.
- `TransparencyTreshold`
 - Values at/below this threshold can be treated as transparent (depending on `IsRenderZeroAsTransparent`).

3) Dynamic config: `DynamicGeoPlastLayerConfigAsset`

Source: `.../DynamicGeoPlastLayerConfigAsset.cs`

Creates: `new DynamicGeoPlastLayer()`

Implements: `IInitDynamicGeoPlastLayerArgs` (extends `IVisualGeoPlastLayerConfig`)

`_dynamicSettings / DynamicSettings` (`DynamicGeoPlastSettings`)

Used during init:

- `DynamicGeoPlastLayer.InitLayerData(...)` sets:
 - `DynamicSettings = dynamicArgs.DynamicSettings`

Affects:

- Whether flow simulation runs this tick:
 - `DynamicSettings.IsAnyFlowEnabledAndIsSimulationTick(simulationTimer)`
- Which flow types are enabled:
 - `DynamicSettings.VolumeFlowSettings.HorizontalFlowSettings`
 - `...UpFlowSettings` , `...DownFlowSettings`

Fields inside `DynamicGeoPlastSettings` :

- `VolumeFlowFrameCycle` (`FrameCycleSettings`)
 - Controls simulation frequency (every N frames, with an offset).
- `VolumeFlowSettings` (`GeoPlastFlowSettings`)
 - Controls horizontal/up/down flow enablement and speeds (via `DirectionFlowSettings`).

`_upFlowTargetLayerReference / UpFlowTargetLayerReference (HexTerrainLayerReference)`

Used during init:

- `UpFlowTargetLayerRef = dynamicArgs.UpFlowTargetLayerReference`

Used later:

- Vertical flow “up” resolves target via `GetTerrainLayerFromParent<T>(UpFlowTargetLayerRef)`

Meaning:

- Which GeoPlast layer receives *upward* flow from this layer (evaporation/melting-like mechanics depending on implementation).

`_downFlowTargetLayerReference / DownFlowTargetLayerReference (HexTerrainLayerReference)`

Same idea as up flow, but for downward flow (condensation/freezing-like mechanics depending on implementation).

4) Material config: `MaterialGeoPlastLayerConfigAsset`

Source: `.../MaterialGeoPlastLayerConfigAsset.cs`

Creates: `new MaterialGeoPlastLayer()`

Implements: `IInitMaterialGeoPlastLayerArgs` (extends `IInitDynamicGeoPlastLayerArgs`)

`_materialSettings / MaterialSettings (MaterialGeoPlastSettings)`

Used during init:

- `MaterialGeoPlastLayer.InitLayerData(...)` sets:
 - `MaterialSettings = materialArgs.MaterialSettings`

Affects:

- Heat flow simulation (frequency + flow settings)
- Temperature-driven vertical flow behavior
- Whether density scales by temperature (`DensityByTemperatureSettings.TemperatureScalesDensity`)

Key fields inside `MaterialGeoPlastSettings` :

- `HeatFlowFrameCycle` (`FrameCycleSettings`)
- `HeatFlowSettings` (`GeoPlastFlowSettings`)
- `UpFlowByTemperatureSettings / DownFlowByTemperatureSettings (VerticalFlowByTemperatureSettings)`
 - Includes `BaseFlow` and `FlowMultiplierCurve` (`ExponentialCurve`)

- `DensityByTemperatureSettings ( DensityByTemperatureSettings )`
 - Includes `TemperatureScalesDensity` , `DensityScale` , `DensityByTemperatureFactorCurve`

`_heatMapArgs / HeatMapArgs` (`InitColorMapCellValueDataLayerArgs<float>`)

Used during init:

- `InitColoredDataLayer(HeatMap, HeatMapArgs)`

Meaning:

- Initial heat amount per cell.

`_temperatureMapArgs / TemperatureMapArgs` (`InitColorMapCellValueDataLayerArgs<float>`)

Used during init:

- `InitColoredDataLayer(TemperatureMap, TemperatureMapArgs)`

Meaning:

- Initial temperature per cell.

Note:

- `MaterialGeoPlastLayer.CalculateTemperature()` can recompute temperature from `HeatMap` and `AmountMap` later when those maps are dirty.

How to use these config assets (typical workflow)

1. Create the config asset matching the runtime layer you want:
 - `GeoPlastLayerConfigAsset` → static, non-visual
 - `VisualGeoPlastLayerConfigAsset` → renders onto a `ChunkMeshLayer`
 - `DynamicGeoPlastLayerConfigAsset` → adds volume flow simulation
 - `MaterialGeoPlastLayerConfigAsset` → adds heat/temperature + temperature-dependent behavior
 2. Add a `CreateGeoPlastLayerRequest` to the terrain entity:
 - `Args` must reference the config asset (stored as `UnityObjectRef<GeoPlastLayerConfigAsset>`)
 - `Name` is optional but recommended (helps debugging/logs)
 3. Ensure referenced layers exist and are resolvable by `HexTerrainLayerReference` :
 - `BedrockPlastReference` (if `HasBedrock`)
 - `ChunkMeshLayerReference` (for visual rendering)
 - `UpFlowTargetLayerReference` / `DownFlowTargetLayerReference` (for vertical flow)
-

Appendix:

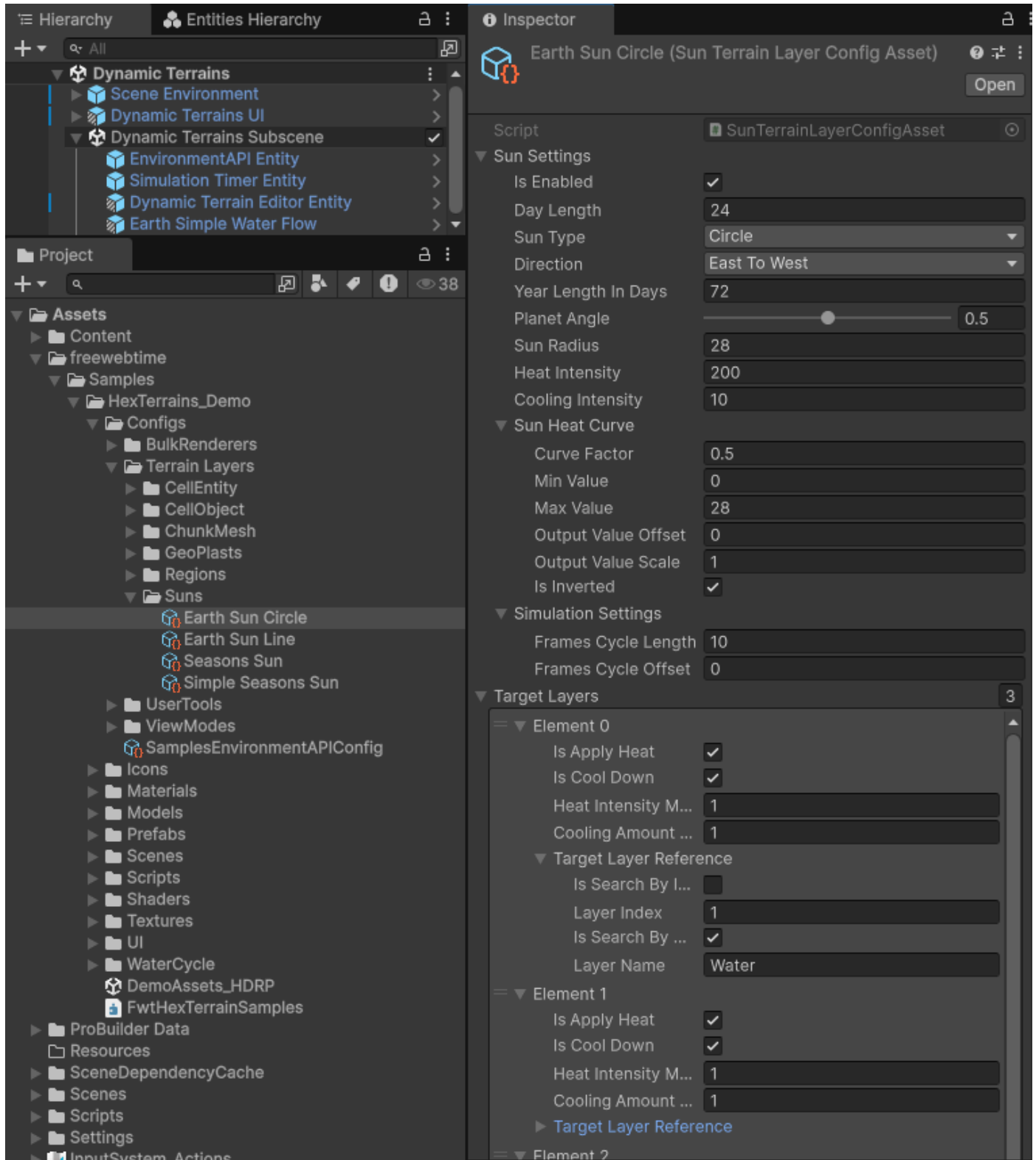
InitColorMapCellValueDataLayerArgs<float> (what matters at init)

These args control initial values and color map settings for AmountMap , DensityMap , VolumeMap , HeatMap , TemperatureMap .

Common controls:

- Fill modes:
 - IsFillWithValue + FillValue
 - IsFillWithRandomValues + RandomMinValue / RandomMaxValue
 - IsApplySourceTexture + SourceTexture (+ offset/scale)
- Color map:
 - ColorPalette
 - AutoColorMapMode
 - MinValue / MaxValue (used by some auto-color modes)

Sun Terrain Layer (Sun simulation → heat/cooling on GeoPlast)



This page documents the SunTerrainLayer feature:

- how a sun layer is **created** and **initialized**
- how it **moves** over the terrain (day/year progression)

- how it **applies heat and cooling** to **GeoPlast** `MaterialGeoPlastLayer` instances
- what `SunTerrainLayerConfigAsset` and `CreateSunLayerRequest` do

1. Main types (at a glance)

Type	Role
<code>SunTerrainLayer</code>	Runtime layer: computes <code>SunPosition</code> over time and schedules <code>ApplySunHeatJob</code> for target <code>GeoPlast</code> layers.
<code>SunTerrainLayerGroup</code>	Holds multiple <code>SunTerrainLayer</code> instances and simulates them in list order. Prevents double-simulating the same simulation frame.
<code>SunTerrainLayerGroupAuthoring</code> + <code>SunLayerBaker</code>	Authoring + baking: produces an ECS buffer of <code>CreateSunLayerRequest</code> on the terrain entity.
<code>SunTerrainLayerConfigAsset</code>	ScriptableObject config implementing <code>ISunTerrainLayerConfig</code> (settings + target list + initial day/year progress).
<code>CreateSunLayerRequest</code>	ECS buffer element: <code>{ Name, Args(ConfigAssetRef) }</code> used to create/init layers in the group.
<code>ApplySunHeatJob</code>	Burst job: per-cell heat/cooling update into the target <code>MaterialGeoPlastLayer.HeatMap</code> .

2. Authoring → ECS: how a Sun layer is created

2.1 `SunTerrainLayerGroupAuthoring` (scene authoring)

`SunTerrainLayerGroupAuthoring` is a `MonoBehaviour` with a list of authoring entries:

- `Name` (string)
- `Config` (`SunTerrainLayerConfigAsset`)

2.2 Baking (`SunLayerBaker`)

During baking, `SunLayerBaker` adds a `DynamicBuffer<CreateSunLayerRequest>` to the terrain entity and fills it:

- `CreateSunLayerRequest.Name` = authoring name
- `CreateSunLayerRequest.Args.Value` = the `SunTerrainLayerConfigAsset` reference

This mirrors how `GeoPlast` layers are requested (see `GeoPlastLayerGroupAuthoring` / `CreateGeoPlastLayerRequest`):

`CreateSunLayerRequest` implements `ITerrainLayerFactory` and can delegate layer creation to the config asset.

3. Runtime container: SunTerrainLayerGroup

`SunTerrainLayerGroup` : `HexTerrainLayerGroup<SunTerrainLayer>`, `IComponentData` is the runtime container.

3.1 Per-request creation and naming

`SunTerrainLayerGroup.CreateTerrainLayer(request)` :

- creates a `SunTerrainLayer` instance (default creation path)
- if `request.Args.Value != null`, sets:
 - `layer.Name = request.Name.ToString()`

3.2 Initialization with `SunTerrainLayerConfigAsset`

`SunTerrainLayerGroup.InitTerrainLayer(layer, settings, request)` calls:

- `layer.Init(settings, request.Args.Value)`

This is where the `ScriptableObject` config is actually applied (see next section).

3.3 Simulation cadence guard (per simulation frame)

`SunTerrainLayerGroup.Simulate(...)` stores `LastSimulationFrame` and returns early if the same `HexTerrainSimulationTimer.FrameCount` is passed again.

This avoids applying sun heat twice when multiple systems call `simulate` within the same simulation tick.

4. SunTerrainLayer lifecycle & fields

4.1 Core state

`SunTerrainLayer` stores:

- `float2 SunPosition` (center of the sun in "cell-coordinate space")
- `float DayProgress` in `[0..1]` (fraction of a day cycle)
- `float YearProgress` in `[0..1]` (fraction of a year cycle)
- `SunSettings SunSettings`
- `List<SunTargetLayerSettings> TargetLayers`

4.2 Initialization (`Init(settings, config)`)

When initialized with an `ISunTerrainLayerConfig` (which `SunTerrainLayerConfigAsset` implements), the layer copies:

- `SunSettings = config.SunSettings`
 - `TargetLayers = config.TargetLayers` (list is created/cleared/copied)
 - `DayProgress = config.DayProgress`
 - `YearProgress = config.YearProgress`
-

5. Configuration types

5.1 SunTerrainLayerConfigAsset

`SunTerrainLayerConfigAsset` : `ScriptableObject`, `ISunTerrainLayerConfig` provides:

- `SunSettings` `SunSettings`
- `ICollection<SunTargetLayerSettings>` `TargetLayers`
- `float` `DayProgress` (initial)
- `float` `YearProgress` (initial)

It also exposes `CreateTerrainLayer()` => `new SunTerrainLayer()` , but in the current implementation this factory method is **not used by** `CreateSunLayerRequest` (because the request is not an `ITerrainLayerFactory`).

5.2 CreateSunLayerRequest

`CreateSunLayerRequest` : `IBufferElementData` contains:

- `FixedString128Bytes` `Name` — the layer name used by `SunTerrainLayerGroup` for lookup/registration
- `UnityObjectRef<SunTerrainLayerConfigAsset>` `Args` — `ScriptableObject` reference used for initialization

5.3 SunSettings

`SunSettings` controls:

- whether simulation is enabled (`IsEnabled`)
- day/year timing (`DayLength` , `YearLengthInDays`)
- movement shape (`Direction` , `PlanetAngle`)
- heat/cooling parameters (`SunRadius` , `HeatIntensity` , `CoolingIntensity` , `SunHeatCurve`)
- simulation cadence (`FrameCycleSettings` `SimulationSettings`)

Simulation cadence: `FrameCycleSettings`

`SunTerrainLayer.Simulate(...)` runs only when:

- `SunSettings.IsEnabled == true`
- `SunSettings.SimulationSettings.IsSimulationTick(simTimer) == true`

`FrameCycleSettings.IsSimulationTick` is:

- always true when `FramesCycleLength <= 1`
- otherwise: `simTimer.FrameCount % FramesCycleLength == FramesCycleOffset`

6. Sun movement over terrain (MoveTheSun)

`SunTerrainLayer.MoveTheSun(simTimer)` updates both:

1. `SunPosition` from current `DayProgress` / `YearProgress`
2. the progress values themselves using `simTimer.DeltaTime`

6.1 Horizontal position (day/night)

- `dayProgress = DayProgress % 1`
- if `Direction == EastToWest`, it flips:
 - `dayProgress = 1 - dayProgress`
- horizontal coordinate:
 - `SunPosition.x = dayProgress * Settings.TerrainSize.x`

So the sun travels across the full terrain width every in-game “day”.

6.2 Vertical position (seasons)

Vertical offset is a sinusoidal function of `YearProgress` :

- `verticalProgress = sin(radians(360 * YearProgress))`
- `terrainHalfHeight = Settings.TerrainSize.y / 2`
- `maxVerticalOffset = terrainHalfHeight * PlanetAngle`
- `SunPosition.y = terrainHalfHeight + verticalProgress * maxVerticalOffset`

Interpretation:

- `PlanetAngle = 0` → sun stays on the equator (no seasons)
- `PlanetAngle = 1` → full swing from one “pole” to the other over a year

6.3 Progress accumulation

- `deltaDay = (DayLength > 0) ? simTimer.DeltaTime / DayLength : 0`
- `DayProgress = (DayProgress + deltaDay) % 1`

Year progresses in “days”:

- `deltaYear = (YearLengthInDays > 0) ? deltaDay / YearLengthInDays : 0`
- `YearProgress = (YearProgress + deltaYear) % 1`

7. Applying heat/cooling to GeoPlast (Simulate → ApplySunHeat)

7.1 Which target layers can be affected?

Each `SunTargetLayerSettings` points at a GeoPlast layer via `HexTerrainLayerReference TargetLayerReference`.

At runtime, `SunTerrainLayer.ApplySunHeat(...)` resolves:

- `MaterialGeoPlastLayer targetLayer = geoPlastLayers.GetLayer<MaterialGeoPlastLayer>(TargetLayerReference)`

It will **only** apply to `MaterialGeoPlastLayer` (because it requires `AmountMap` and `HeatMap`).

7.2 Scheduling model

For each configured target:

- read dependencies are acquired from `AmountMap`
- write dependencies are acquired from `HeatMap`
- `ApplySunHeatJob` is scheduled over `Settings.CellsCount` with a batch size of `Settings.CellsPerChunk`
- dirty chunk tracking is written into `targetLayer.HeatMap.DirtyChunks`

Finally:

- `HeatMap` is marked dirty (`HeatMap.SetDirty(true)`), so downstream update/render steps can recompute dependent maps.

8. ApplySunHeatJob: exact heat/cooling behavior

`ApplySunHeatJob.Execute(cellIndex)` :

8.1 Cells with no material are ignored

If `AmountMap[cellIndex] <= 0` the job returns immediately.

Effect:

- empty cells do not get heated
- empty cells do not get cooled
- `HeatMap` remains unchanged there

8.2 Heat/cooling gating flags per target

If both are false, nothing happens:

- `IsApplyHeat == false AND IsCoolDown == false → return`

8.3 Heat formula

If `IsApplyHeat` :

1. Compute distance-to-sun based on `SunType` :
 - `SunType.Circle` :
 - distance = Euclidean distance to `SunPosition`
 - if the terrain is connected/wrapped, it tests shifted positions $(x,y) \in \{-1,0,1\}^2$ (respecting `Settings.IsConnectedHorizontally/Vertically`) to find a closer wrap-around distance
 - `SunType.Line` :
 - distance = `abs(SunPosition.y - cellPosition.y)`
 - if vertically connected, it also tests wrap-around distances by shifting `cellPosition.y` by $\pm \text{TerrainSize.y}$
 - `SunType.EveryCell` :
 - distance = 0 (all cells treated as "under the sun")
2. Evaluate the heat curve:
 - `curveFactor = SunHeatCurve.Evaluate(distanceToSun)`
3. Accumulate:

- `deltaHeat += HeatIntensity * DeltaTime * curveFactor * HeatIntensityMultiplier`

8.4 Cooling formula (night / out-of-sun cooling)

Cooling is applied only when:

- `IsCoolDown == true`
- AND the sun did not add any heat for this cell in this tick (`deltaHeat <= 0`)

Then:

- `deltaHeat -= CoolingIntensity * DeltaTime * CoolingAmountMultiplier`

Important implication:

- To actually *reduce* heat, `CoolingIntensity` should typically be **positive** (because it is subtracted).
- Heat is clamped to non-negative after update (see below), so “below zero cold” is not represented in `HeatMap` .

8.5 Clamp and dirty chunks

Final write:

- `HeatMap[cellIndex] = max(HeatMap[cellIndex] + deltaHeat, 0)`

Dirty marking:

- computes `chunkIndex = TerrainSettings.GetChunkIndexByCellIndex(cellIndex)`
- adds it to `DirtyChunks`

9. How sun heat affects GeoPlast “temperature” (and why it matters)

The sun writes into `MaterialGeoPlastLayer.HeatMap` .

Downstream in GeoPlast update:

- `TemperatureMap` is derived from:
 - `Temperature = Heat / Amount`
- many behaviors (e.g., temperature-driven density or vertical flow) depend on temperature

So the sun’s effect typically propagates as:

1. sun modifies `HeatMap`
2. GeoPlast update recomputes `TemperatureMap`
3. subsequent GeoPlast simulations (heat diffusion/advection, temperature-dependent density/flow) use the updated temperature

10. Serialization notes (current behavior)

`SunTerrainLayer` implements `ISerializableTerrainLayer` and serializes:

- `SunPosition` , `DayProgress` , `YearProgress`
 - `SunSettings` (enabled, timing, geometry, intensities, heat curve parameters, sun type, direction)
-

11. Practical setup checklist

1. Add `SunTerrainLayerGroupAuthoring` to the terrain `GameObject`.
 2. Add one or more layer entries:
 - set `Name`
 - assign a `SunTerrainLayerConfigAsset`
 3. In the config asset:
 - enable `SunSettings.IsEnabled`
 - set `DayLength` , `YearLengthInDays` , `PlanetAngle`
 - choose `SunType` and `SunRadius`
 - configure `HeatIntensity` , `SunHeatCurve`
 - optionally configure cooling (`IsCoolDown` per target + `CoolingIntensity`)
 - define `TargetLayers` that reference **MaterialGeoPlastLayer** layers (by name and/or index via `HexTerrainLayerReference`)
-



System Execution Pipeline

The simulation logic of the Hex Terrains Framework is structured into well-defined **execution phases**, organized through a hierarchy of `ComponentSystemGroup`s. This design ensures that all systems run in a deterministic and performant order, respecting job dependencies and data lifecycle phases such as cleanup, initialization, simulation, rendering.

Each major phase of the pipeline is represented by a dedicated system group and often accompanied by a corresponding **barrier system** (`EntityCommandBufferSystem`) to queue structural changes safely at the end of the phase.



Overview of Execution Order

The system groups are executed in the following sequence throughout each frame:

1. Initialization Phase (`InitializationSystemGroup`)

- `HexTerrainsCleanupGroup`
- `HexTerrainsInitGroup`

Systems	World	Namespace	Entity Count	Time (ms)
Initialization				
Initialization System Group	Default World	Unity.Entities		0.42
Begin Initialization Entity Command Buffer System	Default World	Unity.Entities	1	0.00
Hex Terrains Cleanup Group	Default World	Fwt.HexTerrains		0.29
Cleanup Chunk Mesh Layers System	Default World	Fwt.HexTerrains.Ch...	1	0.07
Cleanup Cell Object Layer System	Default World	Fwt.HexTerrains.Ce...	1	0.00
Cleanup Cell Entity Layers System	Default World	Fwt.HexTerrains.Ce...	1	0.00
Cleanup Chunks Grid Layer System	Default World	Fwt.HexTerrains.Sy...	1	0.01
Cleanup Geo Plast Layers System	Default World	Fwt.HexTerrains.Ge...	1	0.19
Destroy Camera Controller System	Default World	Fwt.HexTerrains.C...	0	0.01
Cleanup Hex Regions Layer Group System	Default World	Fwt.HexTerrains.Re...	1	0.01
Hex Terrains Cleanup Barrier	Default World	Fwt.HexTerrains	0	0.00
Update User Tools State Machine System	Default World	Fwt.HexTerrains.Us...	1	0.00
Update World Time System	Default World	Unity.Entities	0	0.01
Retain Blob Asset System	Default World	Unity.Entities	0	-
World Update Allocator Reset System	Default World	Unity.Entities	0	0.00
Create Environment API System	Default World	Fwt.HexTerrains.Sy...	0	-
Hex Terrains Init Group	Default World	Fwt.HexTerrains		0.04
Create Hex Terrain Brush View System	Default World	Fwt.HexTerrains.Br...	0	0.01
Create Sun Terrain Layer System	Default World	Fwt.HexTerrains.Su...	0	-
Attach Main Camera To Terrain System	Default World	Fwt.HexTerrains.Sy...	0	-
Create Chunks Grid Layer System	Default World	Fwt.HexTerrains.Sy...	0	0.00
Create User Tools State Machine System	Default World	Fwt.HexTerrains.Us...	1	0.00
Create Geo Plast Layer Group System	Default World	Fwt.HexTerrains.Ge...	0	0.00
Create Chunk Mesh Layer Group System	Default World	Fwt.HexTerrains.Ch...	0	0.00
Create Hex Regions Layer Group System	Default World	Fwt.HexTerrains.Re...	0	0.00
Create Camera Controller System	Default World	Fwt.HexTerrains.C...	0	0.00
Create Cell Entity Layer Group System	Default World	Fwt.HexTerrains.Ce...	0	0.00
Create Cell Object Layer Group System	Default World	Fwt.HexTerrains.Ce...	0	0.00
Load Terrain After Initialization System	Default World	Fwt.HexTerrains.Sy...	0	-
Complete Terrain Initialization System	Default World	Fwt.HexTerrains.Sy...	0	-
Hex Terrains Init Barrier	Default World	Fwt.HexTerrains	0	0.00
Live Conversion Editor System Group	Default World	Unity.Scenes.Editor		0.05
Scene System Group	Default World	Unity.Scenes		0.01
End Initialization Entity Command Buffer System	Default World	Unity.Entities	1	0.00
Update				

2. Simulation Phase (`SimulationSystemGroup`)

- `HexTerrainsSimulationGroup`
- `HexTerrainsUpdateGroup`
- `HexTerrainsStartPreRenderGroup`

Systems	World	Namespace	Entity Count	Time (ms)
► Initialization				
▼ Update				
▼ Simulation System Group	Default World	Unity.Entities		0.14
◂ Begin Simulation Entity Command Buffer System	Default World	Unity.Entities	1	0.00
► Fixed Step Simulation System Group	Default World	Unity.Entities		0.00
► Variable Rate Simulation System Group	Default World	Unity.Entities		0.00
◂ Companion Game Object Update System	Default World	Unity.Entities	0	0.00
◂ Companion Game Object Live Baking Init System	Default World	Unity.Entities	0	-
▼ Hex Terrains Simulation Group	Default World	Fwt.HexTerrains		0.01
◂ Update Hex Terrain Simulation System	Default World	Fwt.HexTerrains.Si...	1	0.00
◂ Simulate Sun Terrain Layer System	Default World	Fwt.HexTerrains.Su...	2	0.00
◂ Simulate Geo Plast Layer System	Default World	Fwt.HexTerrains.Ge...	2	0.00
◂ Update Geo Plast Layers System	Default World	Fwt.HexTerrains.Ge...	1	0.00
◂ Render Geo Plast Layers System	Default World	Fwt.HexTerrains.Ge...	1	0.00
◂ Hex Terrains Simulatio Barrier	Default World	Fwt.HexTerrains	0	0.00
▼ Hex Terrains Update Group	Default World	Fwt.HexTerrains		0.04
◂ Update Camera Controller System	Default World	Fwt.HexTerrains.C...	2	0.01
◂ Calc Chunk Visibility System	Default World	Fwt.HexTerrains.Sy...	1	0.00
◂ Calc Regions Sizes System	Default World	Fwt.HexTerrains.Re...	1	0.00
◂ Calc Regions Cells System	Default World	Fwt.HexTerrains.Re...	1	0.00
◂ Calc Chunk Mesh Cell Metrics System	Default World	Fwt.HexTerrains.Ch...	1	0.00
◂ Calc Dirty Chunk Mesh Sources System	Default World	Fwt.HexTerrains.Ch...	1	0.00
◂ Calc Cell Object Layers System	Default World	Fwt.HexTerrains.Ce...	1	0.00
◂ Calc Cell Entity Entities System	Default World	Fwt.HexTerrains.Ce...	1	0.00
◂ Update Cell Entities System	Default World	Fwt.HexTerrains.Ce...	1	0.01
◂ Hex Terrains Update Barrier	Default World	Fwt.HexTerrains	0	0.00
▼ Hex Terrains Start Pre Render Group	Default World	Fwt.HexTerrains		0.06
◂ Playback Update Cell Entity Command Buffers System	Default World	Fwt.HexTerrains.Ce...	1	0.01
◂ Update Cell Entity Layer Entities State System	Default World	Fwt.HexTerrains.Ce...	1	0.00
◂ Calc Chunk Mesh Sources System	Default World	Fwt.HexTerrains.Ch...	1	0.03
◂ Calc Geo Plast Color Map System	Default World	Fwt.HexTerrains.Ge...	1	0.01
◂ Calc Cell Entity Color Map System	Default World	Fwt.HexTerrains.Ce...	1	0.00
◂ Calc Regions Color Map System	Default World	Fwt.HexTerrains.Re...	1	0.00
◂ Calc Chunk Mesh Color Map System	Default World	Fwt.HexTerrains.Ch...	1	0.00
◂ Calc Cell Objects Color Map System	Default World	Fwt.HexTerrains.Ce...	1	0.00
◂ Hex Terrains Start Pre Render Barrier	Default World	Fwt.HexTerrains	0	0.00
► Transform System Group	Default World	Unity.Transforms		0.01
◂ Companion Game Object Update Transform System	Default World	Unity.Entities	0	0.00
► Late Simulation System Group	Default World	Unity.Entities		0.01
◂ End Simulation Entity Command Buffer System	Default World	Unity.Entities	1	0.00
► Pre Late Update				

3. Late Simulation Phase (LateSimulationSystemGroup)

◦ HexTerrainsFinishPreRenderGroup

Systems	World	Namespace	Entity Count	Time (ms)
► Initialization				
▼ Update				
▼ Simulation System Group	Default World	Unity.Entities		0.21
◂ Begin Simulation Entity Command Buffer System	Default World	Unity.Entities	1	0.00
► Fixed Step Simulation System Group	Default World	Unity.Entities		0.00
► Variable Rate Simulation System Group	Default World	Unity.Entities		0.00
◂ Companion Game Object Update System	Default World	Unity.Entities	0	0.00
◂ Companion Game Object Live Baking Init System	Default World	Unity.Entities	0	-
► Hex Terrains Simulation Group	Default World	Fwt.HexTerrains		0.02
► Hex Terrains Update Group	Default World	Fwt.HexTerrains		0.06
► Hex Terrains Start Pre Render Group	Default World	Fwt.HexTerrains		0.09
► Transform System Group	Default World	Unity.Transforms		0.01
◂ Companion Game Object Update Transform System	Default World	Unity.Entities	0	0.00
▼ Late Simulation System Group	Default World	Unity.Entities		0.02
▼ Hex Terrains Finish Pre Render Group	Default World	Fwt.HexTerrains		0.01
◂ Create Chunk Meshes System	Default World	Fwt.HexTerrains.Ch...	1	0.01
◂ Hex Terrains Finish Pre Render Barrier	Default World	Fwt.HexTerrains	0	0.00
◂ Update Cell Entity Visibility System	Default World	Fwt.HexTerrains.Ce...	0	0.00
◂ End Simulation Entity Command Buffer System	Default World	Unity.Entities	1	0.00
► Pre Late Update				

4. Presentation Phase (PresentationSystemGroup)

◦ HexTerrainsRenderGroup

Systems	World	Namespace	Entity Count	Time (ms)
► Initialization				
► Update				
▼ Pre Late Update				
▼ Presentation System Group	Default World	Unity.Entities		0.14
◻ Begin Presentation Entity Command Buffer System	Default World	Unity.Entities	1	0.00
◻ Hybrid Light Baking Data System	Default World	Unity.Rendering	0	0.00
▼ Hex Terrains Render Group	Default World	Fwt.HexTerrains		0.07
◻ Raycast Hex Terrains System	Default World	Fwt.HexTerrains.Sy...	1	0.03
◻ Update Hex Terrain Brush View System	Default World	Fwt.HexTerrains.Br...	1	0.01
◻ Destroy Hex Terrain Brush View System	Default World	Fwt.HexTerrains.Br...	0	0.01
◻ Render Cell Object Layers System	Default World	Fwt.HexTerrains.Ce...	1	0.00
◻ Update Color Map Textures System	Default World	Fwt.HexTerrains.Sy...	1	0.01
◻ Update View Modes Config On UI System	Default World	Fwt.HexTerrains.Sy...	2	0.00
◻ Update Mini Map Screen System	Default World	Fwt.HexTerrains.Sy...	3	0.00
◻ Render Chunk Mesh System	Default World	Fwt.HexTerrains.Ch...	1	0.01
◻ Hex Terrains Render Barrier	Default World	Fwt.HexTerrains	0	0.00
◻ Register Materials And Meshes System	Default World	Unity.Rendering	0	0.02
► Deformations In Presentation	Default World	Unity.Rendering		0.00
► Structural Change Presentation System Group	Default World	Unity.Rendering		0.01
► Update Presentation System Group	Default World	Unity.Rendering		0.00
◻ Matrix Previous Initialization System	Default World	Unity.Rendering	0	0.00
◻ Entities Graphics System	Default World	Unity.Rendering	2	0.02
◻ Matrix Previous System	Default World	Unity.Rendering	0	0.01
◻ Entities Journaling Frame Count System	Default World	Unity.Entities	0	0.00
◻ Cache Cell Entity Data System	Default World	Fwt.HexTerrains.Ce...	1	0.01

Each group is scheduled inside a broader Unity ECS phase (`InitializationSystemGroup` , `SimulationSystemGroup` , `LateSimulationSystemGroup` , `PresentationSystemGroup`) to ensure correct integration into Unity's default update loop.



1. HexTerrainsCleanupGroup

- **Parent:** `InitializationSystemGroup`
- **Order:** Executes **first** in the frame (`OrderFirst = true`)
- **Purpose:** Resets flags, clears buffers, and prepares terrain data for the new simulation frame.
- **Typical Systems:** Reset dirty flags, mark layers for recomputation.



3. HexTerrainsInitGroup

- **Parent:** `InitializationSystemGroup`
- **Order:** Runs **after** `HexTerrainsSimulationGroup`
- **Purpose:** Handles the creation of new terrain entities, initialization of ECS components, and data allocation.



2. HexTerrainsSimulationGroup

- **Parent:** `SimulationSystemGroup`
- **Order:** Runs **before** `HexTerrainsUpdateGroup`
- **Purpose:** Handles the simulation processes like water flow, snow melting, etc.



3. HexTerrainsUpdateGroup

- **Parent:** `SimulationSystemGroup`
- **Order:** Runs **after** `HexTerrainsSimulationGroup`

- **Purpose:** Every frame update logic runs here. Processes input, accumulated changes to terrain state. Here happens the reaction on data change of the terrain. This includes terrain analysis, updates to data layers, generation of mesh data, etc.
-



4. HexTerrainsStartPreRenderGroup

- **Parent:** SimulationSystemGroup
 - **Order:** Executes **after** HexTerrainsUpdateGroup
 - **Purpose:** Runs all the logic that happens after the input is processed. Such as ColorMap colors, CellEntityLayer entities, etc.
-



5. HexTerrainsFinishPreRenderGroup

- **Parent:** LateSimulationSystemGroup
 - **Purpose:** Final cleanup and processing just before rendering.
 - **Typical Use:** Create meshes, combine buffers, finalize render settings, compress or normalize data.
-



6. HexTerrainsRenderGroup

- **Parent:** PresentationSystemGroup
 - **Purpose:** Renders the terrain using data prepared in previous steps. Filling ColorMap textures with calculated colors.
 - **Use Case:** Rendering systems using `Graphics.DrawMeshInstanced` , material property block application, GPU data upload.
-



Barrier Systems

Each phase has a corresponding **EntityCommandBufferSystem** that ensures deferred structural changes do not break parallel simulation:

Barrier System	Associated Group
HexTerrainsCleanupBarrier	HexTerrainsCleanupGroup
HexTerrainsInitBarrier	HexTerrainsInitGroup
<i>(others exist for each group)</i>	<i>(other hex terrain groups)</i>



Summary Diagram (Text)

```
[InitializationSystemGroup]
├─ HexTerrainsCleanupGroup (first)
│   └─ HexTerrainsCleanupBarrier
└─ HexTerrainsInitGroup (after cleanup)
    └─ HexTerrainsInitBarrier

[SimulationSystemGroup]
├─ HexTerrainsSimulationGroup
│   └─ HexTerrainsSimulationBarrier
├─ HexTerrainsUpdateGroup
│   └─ HexTerrainsUpdateBarrier
└─ HexTerrainsStartPreRenderGroup
    └─ HexTerrainsStartPreRenderBarrier

[LateSimulationSystemGroup]
└─ HexTerrainsFinishPreRenderGroup
    └─ HexTerrainsFinishPreRenderBarrier

[PresentationSystemGroup]
└─ HexTerrainsRenderGroup
    └─ HexTerrainsRenderBarrier
```




Camera Controller System

The Camera Controller provides an ECS-driven camera system designed to smoothly navigate procedural hex terrains. It handles input processing, boundary wrapping (for infinite or looped terrains), camera state saving/loading, and minimap integration.

Overview

The system operates using Unity's Entity Component System (ECS) and relies on an authoring component to configure input keys and speeds. Behind the scenes, the framework handles the creation, update, and cleanup of the physical camera target object.

Features

- **Configurable Input:** Customizable keys for movement, rotation, zoom, acceleration, and movement locking.
- **UI Detection:** Safely ignores input when the mouse is hovering over UI elements using the Unity Event System.
- **Boundary Wrapping:** Automatically wraps camera position around the terrain bounds if the terrain is configured to be connected horizontally or vertically.
- **State Management:** Quick save (F5) and load (F9) of camera position, rotation, and zoom using `PlayerPrefs`.
- **Minimap Integration:** Automatically synchronizes the normalized camera position and rotation mapping with the `IMinimapScreen` interface.

Setup and Authoring

To use the camera controller, attach the `CameraControllerAuthoring` script to a `GameObject` in your subscene. The Baker will automatically convert this into the required ECS setup (`CreateCameraControllerRequest` and `IgnoreCameraZoomInputKeys` buffer).

Authoring Properties

Input Keys

Property	Default Key	Description
MoveUpKey	W	Moves the camera target forward along the Y axis (2D plane).
MoveDownKey	S	Moves the camera target backward.
MoveLeftKey	A	Moves the camera target left.
MoveRightKey	D	Moves the camera target right.
RotateLeftKey	Q	Rotates the camera counter-clockwise.

Property	Default Key	Description
RotateRightKey	E	Rotates the camera clockwise.
AccelerationKey	LeftShift	Multiplies movement speeds by the acceleration modifier.
LockMovementKey	LeftControl	Locks the current movement velocity and auto-moves the camera continuously.
SaveCameraStateKey	F5	Saves the current camera rotation, zoom, and position to <code>PlayerPrefs</code> .
LoadCameraStateKey	F9	Loads the saved camera state from <code>PlayerPrefs</code> .

Speeds and Modifiers

Property	Description
ZoomSpeed	Scroll wheel zoom sensitivity multiplier.
MovementSpeed	Base panning movement speed.
RotationSpeed	Base rotation speed when using <code>Q</code> / <code>E</code> .
AccelerationMultiplier	Speed multiplier applied when holding the <code>AccelerationKey</code> .
PreventZoomKeys	List of <code>KeyCode</code> s that, when held, ignore mouse scroll zoom (Defaults: <code>LeftAlt</code> , <code>LeftControl</code>).
IsFindCameraControllerComponentOnScene	If true, automatically tries to find a <code>CameraControllerComponent</code> in the active scene and link it to the target transform during initialization.

Architecture & Systems

The mechanic is divided into three primary ECS Systems:

1. CreateCameraControllerSystem

- Runs in the `HexTerrainsInitGroup` .
- Processes the `CreateCameraControllerRequest` .
- Generates a new `GameObject` named "CameraControllerTarget" to act as the scene anchor.
- Links the active `CameraControllerComponent` from the scene if requested via `IsFindCameraControllerComponentOnScene` .
- Assigns the `CameraControllerTarget` component to track all target attributes and references.

2. UpdateCameraControllerSystem

- Runs in the `HexTerrainsUpdateGroup` .
- Only updates if the terrain is visible (`HexTerrainVisibility`).

- Computes framerate-independent deltas for continuous movement, rotation, and zooming based on the configured inputs.
- Handles the locking behavior logic to continuously orbit or pan without further user input.
- Computes out-of-bounds positioning. Using `HexTerrainSettings.IsConnectedHorizontally` and `IsConnectedVertically`, it seamlessly wraps the X/Y positions on cyclic environments or clamps them to boundaries for fixed terrains.
- Synchronizes with UI minimaps via the `UpdateMinimapScreen` lifecycle method.

3. DestroyCameraControllerSystem (Cleanup)

- Runs in the `HexTerrainsCleanupGroup`.
- Responds to the absence of a `HexTerrain` component on entities that still possess a `CameraControllerTarget`.
- Cleans up and destroys the instantiated `CameraControllerTarget` `GameObject` to prevent memory and hierarchy leaks.



Terrain Layers Overview

This document explains the HexTerrains **Terrain Layer** architecture: what a layer is, how layers are initialized and updated, how layers are organized into `HexTerrainLayerGroup`s, which layers are provided by the framework, and how to implement custom layers.

Terminology note: in this framework a “layer” is a **runtime subsystem + data container**. It is *not* a Unity `LayerMask`.

Table of contents

- 1. What is a Terrain Layer?
- 2. `HexTerrainLayer` : lifecycle and responsibilities
- 3. Data layers, jobs, and dirty flags
- 4. Referencing other layers: `HexTerrainLayerReference`
- 5. `HexTerrainLayerGroup` : organizing multiple layers
- 6. Initialization patterns
- 7. The 6 main layer types (and how to use them)
 - 7.1 `ChunkMeshLayer`
 - 7.2 `CellEntityLayer`
 - 7.3 `CellObjectLayer`
 - 7.4 `CellRegionLayer`
 - 7.5 `GeoPlastLayer`
 - 7.6 `SunTerrainLayer` (Sun Layer)
- 8. Creating your own Terrain Layer
- 9. Best practices & pitfalls

1. What is a Terrain Layer?

A **Terrain Layer** is a modular unit of terrain functionality. Each layer:

- Owns a coherent set of terrain data (typically stored in native collections / data layers).
- Implements a predictable lifecycle (`Init` , per-frame work via jobs, `Cleanup` , `Dispose`).
- Can depend on other layers (via `HexTerrainLayerReference`).
- Can be grouped and managed alongside other layers using `HexTerrainLayerGroup` .

The goal is to keep the terrain system composable:

- Rendering is separated from simulation.
- Entities are separated from purely visual objects.
- Region logic is separated from geometry.
- Layers can be added/removed/replaced without rewriting the whole pipeline.

2. HexTerrainLayer: lifecycle and responsibilities

All terrain layers ultimately derive from:

- `HexTerrainLayer` (abstract base class)

Key members and concepts from `HexTerrainLayer` :

Core state

- `public string Name { get; set; }`
Optional but strongly recommended. `HexTerrainLayerGroup` can index layers by name.
- `public HexTerrainSettings Settings;`
The settings this layer was initialized with (terrain size, chunk counts, etc.).
- `public HexTerrainLayer ParentLayer { get; set; }`
If the layer is inside a group, it typically points to the owning `HexTerrainLayerGroup`.

Lifecycle methods

- `Init(HexTerrainSettings settings)`
Base method completes jobs, updates settings, and marks data dirty if settings changed.
- `Init<TInitArgs>(HexTerrainSettings settings, TInitArgs initArgs)`
Used to inject configuration (usually `ScriptableObject` assets implementing config interfaces). Most concrete layers override this to read their config.
- `Resize(int2 terrainSize)`
Convenience wrapper that updates `Settings.TerrainSize` then re-`Init`s.
- `CalculateColorMap(JobHandle dependency)`
A common "hook" used by several layers to schedule color-map related jobs.
- `CompleteAllJobs()`
Should complete any outstanding job handles used by the layer's data layers.
- `SetAllDirty(bool isDirty)` (*abstract*)
Marks all internal data layers dirty/clean.
- `Cleanup()` and `CleanupAsync(JobHandle dependency)` (*abstract*)
Used to reset dirty flags and/or schedule "start-of-frame" cleanup jobs.
- `Dispose()`
Releases native allocations.

Cross-layer access helpers

`HexTerrainLayer` provides helper methods to fetch layers from the parent group:

- `GetTerrainLayerFromParent<TLayer>(int index)`
- `GetTerrainLayerFromParent<TLayer>(string name)`
- `GetTerrainLayerFromParent<TLayer>(HexTerrainLayerReference reference)`

These are useful when a layer needs to read/write other layers' data.

3. Data layers, jobs, and dirty flags

Most runtime terrain data in HexTerrains is stored using *data layer* abstractions (examples seen in the codebase):

- `CellValueDataLayer<T>`
- `ColorMapCellValueDataLayer_Int` , `ColorMapCellValueDataLayer_Float` , ...
- Chunk-scoped layers such as:
 - `ChunkMetricsDataLayer`
 - `ChunkVisibilityDataLayer`
 - `NativeParallelHashSetDataLayer<int>`
 - `NativeParallelMultiHashMapDataLayer<TKey, TValue>`
 - `NativeListDataLayer<T>`

These wrappers typically provide:

- Native storage (`NativeArray` , `NativeList` , hash sets/maps).
- Dirty tracking (global and often per-chunk).
- Job dependency tracking (read/write fences).

Typical job scheduling pattern

A common pattern across layers (e.g., `ChunksGridLayer` , `VisualGeoPlastLayer` , `SunTerrainLayer`) looks like:

1. **Early-out** if nothing is dirty / nothing changed.
2. **Prepare dependencies:**
 - `PrepareToRead()` for inputs
 - `PrepareToWrite()` for outputs
 - Combine with incoming dependency .
3. **Schedule jobs.**
4. **Register dependencies** back on data layers:
 - `AddReadDependency(handle)` / `AddWriteDependency(handle)`
5. **Mark dirty:**
 - `SetDirty(true)`
 - and often schedule "mark dirty chunks" jobs when using per-chunk dirty sets.

Example (conceptual):

```
var depsA = inputLayer.PrepareToRead();
var depsB = outputLayer.PrepareToWrite();
dependency = JobHandle.CombineDependencies(dependency, depsA, depsB);
dependency = job.Schedule(Settings.CellsCount, Settings.CellsPerChunk, dependency);
inputLayer.AddReadDependency(dependency);
outputLayer.AddWriteDependency(dependency);
outputLayer.SetDirty(true);
```

Dirty flags: why they matter

Dirty flags are used to avoid unnecessary work:

- If a data layer is not dirty, many layers simply return the incoming `JobHandle` unchanged.
 - Some layers also track *dirty chunks* to minimize chunk mesh regeneration.
-

4. Referencing other layers: `HexTerrainLayerReference`

`HexTerrainLayerReference` is a serializable struct used to locate a layer within a `HexTerrainLayerGroup`.

It supports:

- Lookup by index (`IsSearchByIndex` , `LayerIndex`)
- Lookup by name (`IsSearchByName` , `LayerName`)
- Or both (index + name)

Helpers:

- `HexTerrainLayerReference.ByLayerIndex(int)`
- `HexTerrainLayerReference.ByLayerName(string)`
- `HexTerrainLayerReference.ByLayerIndexAndName(int, string)`
- `HexTerrainLayerReference.Default`

This enables clean cross-layer wiring from configuration assets (e.g., “this GeoPlast layer renders into surface layer X”).

5. `HexTerrainLayerGroup`: organizing multiple layers

A `HexTerrainLayerGroup<TTerrainLayer>` is itself a `HexTerrainLayer`, but its role is to manage a list of child layers.

Key capabilities (from the framework API surface):

- Stores:
 - `List<TTerrainLayer> Layers`
 - `Dictionary<string, TTerrainLayer> LayersByName`
 - `Dictionary<string, int> LayerIndexByName`
 - `Dictionary<TTerrainLayer, int> LayerIndexByInstance`
- Provides many `GetLayer(...)` overloads:
 - by index
 - by name
 - by type
 - by `HexTerrainLayerReference`
- Provides group-wide lifecycle:
 - `Init(...)` initializes and/or recreates all child layers.
 - `CalculateColorMap(...)` can combine color map job handles from all layers.
 - `SetAllDirty(...)`, `Cleanup(...)`, `CleanupAsync(...)`, `Dispose()` forward to all children.

Specialized groups in the framework

You will commonly work with groups dedicated to specific layer types, e.g.:

- `ChunkMeshLayerGroup` : `HexTerrainLayerGroup<ChunkMeshLayer>`
- `CellEntityLayerGroup` : `HexTerrainLayerGroup<CellEntityLayer>`
- `CellObjectLayerGroup` : `HexTerrainLayerGroup<CellObjectLayer>`
- `CellRegionLayerGroup` : `HexTerrainLayerGroup<CellRegionLayer>`
- `GeoPlastLayerGroup` : `HexTerrainLayerGroup<GeoPlastLayer>`

These derived groups often add orchestration methods, e.g.:

- `ChunkMeshLayerGroup.CalcMeshSources(...), CreateChunkMeshes(), Render(...)`
- `CellEntityLayerGroup.CalculateEntities(...), UpdateEntities(...)`
- `GeoPlastLayerGroup.Simulate(...), Render(...)`
- `CellObjectLayerGroup.Render(...)`

Parent-child relationship

When a layer is created by a group, the group should set:

- `child ParentLayer = this`
- `child Name` (commonly from creation request args)

This is what enables `GetTerrainLayerFromParent<T>` lookups from inside a child layer.

6. Initialization patterns

Most runtime layers are created and configured using `ScriptableObject` config assets.

The common pattern

1. **Create a config asset** in Unity:
 - For example `ChunkMeshLayerConfigAsset`, `CellEntityLayerConfigAsset`, `GeoPlastLayerConfigAsset`, etc.
2. **The config asset implements an interface** used by the layer's `Init<TInitArgs>`:
 - Example: `ChunkMeshLayerConfigAsset : IChunkMeshLayerConfig`
3. **The asset is used as an init arg** when building the terrain:
 - The group creates the layer via `CreateTerrainLayer()` (factory pattern)
 - The group calls `InitTerrainLayer(layer, settings, initArgs)`
 - The layer reads config and initializes internal data layers

What should happen in `Init(...)`

Concrete layers typically do two things:

- Ensure their internal data layers exist and are sized to match `settings`.
- Apply config parameters, references, and default values.

Example evidence from the codebase:

- `ChunksGridLayer.Init(settings)` allocates chunk visibility/metrics layers, resets viewport caches, and recalculates metrics when settings change.
- `SunTerrainLayer.Init<TInitArgs>` reads `ISunTerrainLayerConfig` and populates `SunSettings`, `TargetLayers`, and progress values.
- `VisualGeoPlastLayer.InitLayerData(args)` reads `IVisualGeoPlastLayerConfig` and stores `SurfaceLayerRef` + visual rendering settings.

7. The 6 main layer types (and how to use them)

This section describes the framework's six "pillar" layer types and the standard workflow for each.

Some types include multiple derived/related layers in the codebase; this section focuses on the conceptual role and the visible API surface.

7.1 ChunkMeshLayer

Purpose: Surface-like cell data (height/biome/opacity) and cell metrics used for chunk mesh generation.

Common data owned by `ChunkMeshLayer` :

- `HeightMap` : `ColorMapCellValueDataLayer_Float`
- `BiomeMap` : `ColorMapCellValueDataLayer_Int`
- `TransparencyMap` : `CellValueDataLayer<bool>`
- `CellMetricsMap` : `CellMetricsDataLayer`
- `ChunkMeshLayerSettings` : `ChunkMeshLayerSettings`
- Sync references:
 - `SyncHeightMapLayerReference`
 - `SyncBiomeMapLayerReference`
 - `SyncTransparencyMapLayerReference`

Key operations (conceptually):

- **Sync** values from another layer (`SyncData` , `SyncHeightMap` , etc.)
- **Calculate** cell metrics (`CalcCellMetrics`)
- **CalculateColorMap** (often biome/height based)
- **Serialize/Deserialize** layer state for persistence

Rendering pipeline connection: `VisualChunkMeshLayer`

`VisualChunkMeshLayer` extends the chunk mesh concept into actual mesh generation and rendering. It typically uses:

- `ChunkMeshSources` (mesh source buffers per chunk)
- `ChunkMeshes` (Unity `Mesh` instances per chunk)
- Render configs (`HexSurfaceRenderConfigAsset`) per view mode
- A `RenderSettings` struct controlling meshing parameters

Key steps:

1. `CalcMeshSources(...)` schedules per-chunk mesh source jobs.
2. `CreateChunkMeshes()` uploads mesh data to Unity meshes.
3. `Render(...)` draws the meshes (respecting view mode and visibility).

Group orchestration: `ChunkMeshLayerGroup`

`ChunkMeshLayerGroup` adds methods that operate across many layers:

- `SyncData(dependency)`
- `CalcCellMetrics(dependency)`
- `CalcDirtyMeshSources(dependency)`
- `CalcMeshSources(chunksGridLayer, dependency)`
- `CreateChunkMeshes()`
- `Render(chunksGridLayer, viewMode, terrainTransform, camera)`

Related but important: `ChunksGridLayer`

Even though it is not one of the “six main types”, `ChunksGridLayer` is foundational for rendering workflows:

- Tracks per-chunk metrics and visibility.
- Calculates visible chunk sets based on camera frustum.
- Provides `VisibleChunks` as a `NativeParallelHashSetDataLayer<int>`.

Most render systems use `ChunksGridLayer` to avoid generating or rendering offscreen chunks.

7.2 `CellEntityLayer`

Purpose: Spawn and update ECS entities associated with terrain cells.

Key data and members (as seen in `CellEntityLayer`):

- `CellEntityViews` : `CellEntityViewDataLayer`
- `NativeList<CellEntityConfig>` `CellEntityConfigs`
- `EntityManager`
- Optional `EntityCommandBuffer` for batch structural updates
- `CalculateEntities(dependency)` and `UpdateEntities(...)`

Configuration pattern:

- `CellEntityLayerConfigAsset` supplies:
 - authoring list (`CellEntities`)
 - baked range info (`EntityConfigsRangeStart` , `EntityConfigsRangeSize`)
 - plus common cell-item config inherited behavior (index/state/transform maps)

Group orchestration:

- `CellEntityLayerGroup` stores the combined baked configs and passes slices into each layer.
- It provides:
 - `CalculateEntities(dependency)` across all layers
 - `UpdateEntities(layerEntity, dependency)` across all layers

When to use:

- Use `CellEntityLayer` when cell content should be represented as ECS entities (AI, physics, gameplay systems).
- Prefer `CellObjectLayer` for large volumes of purely visual, instanced objects.

7.3 CellObjectLayer

Purpose: Render a large number of cell-attached visual objects efficiently using bulk instancing.

Key concepts in `CellObjectLayer` :

- Uses an `IBulkRenderer` implementation (from `Fwt.Core.BulkRendering`) for instanced rendering.
- Maintains LOD logic:
 - `LODSettings` : `NativeList<CellObjectLayerLODSettings>`
 - `AllCellObjectsLODSettings` : `NativeList<CellObjectLODSettings>`
 - `VisualsByLODLayer` : `List<BulkRenderItemsDataLayer>`
- Supports “states” per object and multiple submeshes per cell.
- Main runtime entry points:
 - `CalculateCellObjects(...)` / `CalculateCellObjectsLOD(...)`
 - `Render(camera, normalizedCameraZoom)` OR `RenderLODs(...)`

Configuration and baking:

- `CellObjectLayerConfigAsset` (implements `ICellObjectLayerConfig`) contains:
 - object authoring list (`ObjectConfigs`)
 - LOD distances / baked LOD settings
 - baked configs, visuals, palette, state configs, etc.
- Baking is explicit via context menu commands:
 - `BakeCellObjectConfigs`
 - `BakeLODSettings`
 - `ClearBakedData`

When to use:

- Use for foliage, rocks, props, decorative clutter, or any high-count visuals.
- It is the “visual object” counterpart to `CellEntityLayer`.

7.4 CellRegionLayer

Purpose: Maintain and compute “regions” (clusters of cells) and provide region-based lookups.

Key data (from `CellRegionLayer`):

- `CellRegionMap` : `ColorMapCellValueDataLayer_Int`
Per-cell region index.
- `RegionCells` : `NativeParallelMultiHashMapDataLayer<int, uint>`
Maps region index → set of cell indices.
- `RegionSizes` : `NativeListDataLayer<uint>`
Stores region sizes.

Core operations:

- `CalcRegionsCells(dependency)` and `CalcRegionsSizes(dependency)`

- `GetCellRegion(cellIndex)` and setters:
 - `SetCellRegion(...)`
 - `SetAllCellsRegion(...)`
- Serialization / deserialization support

Configuration:

- `CellRegionLayerConfigAsset` implements `ICellRegionConfig`
 - `InitValuesArgs` controls default values and color mapping (palette, auto-color mode)
 - Provides a context-menu helper: `AutoFillColorPalette()`

When to use:

- Political regions, biome regions, provinces, connected-component labeling, flood-fill results, pathfinding zones, etc.

7.5 GeoPlastLayer

Purpose: Simulate and/or store “material volumes” on the terrain (amount, density, volume), including derived heights like bedrock and ceiling.

`GeoPlastLayer` is the base type. It owns maps such as:

- `AmountMap` : `ColorMapCellValueDataLayer_Float`
- `DensityMap` : `ColorMapCellValueDataLayer_Float`
- `VolumeMap` : `ColorMapCellValueDataLayer_Float`
- `BedrockHeightMap` : `CellValueDataLayer<float>`
- `CeilingHeightMap` : `CellValueDataLayer<float>`

Core phases (exposed by `GeoPlastLayerGroup` and layers):

- `PrepareSimulation(...)`
- `CalculateSimulation(...)`
- `ApplySimulation(...)`
- Update / derived data phases:
 - `PreparePlastUpdate(...)`
 - `CalculateDensity(...)`
 - `CalculateVolume(...)`
 - `CalculateBedrock(...)`
 - `CalculateCeiling(...)`

Visual rendering: `VisualGeoPlastLayer`

`VisualGeoPlastLayer` extends `GeoPlastLayer` and renders plast values into a target `ChunkMeshLayer` :

- `SurfaceLayerRef` : `HexTerrainLayerReference`
- `VisualGeoPlastSettings` :
 - render mode: Amount or Volume
 - transparency behavior and thresholds

It schedules `RenderGeoPlastToHeightMapJob` that writes into:

- surface `HeightMap`

- surface BiomeMap
- surface TransparencyMap

This is the bridge between simulation data and the visible terrain surface.

Dynamic simulation: DynamicGeoPlastLayer

Adds flow maps and flow potentials:

- VolumeFlowPotentialMap , VolumeFlowMap
- Target references:
 - UpFlowTargetLayerRef
 - DownFlowTargetLayerRef
- Chunk-level incoming sets to optimize updates

It provides specialized flow computations (vertical and horizontal), and clear passes with ProfilerMarker s.

Material + thermal: MaterialGeoPlastLayer

Adds:

- HeatMap , TemperatureMap
- HeatFlowPotentialMap , HeatFlowMap
- Plus material settings controlling behavior

This is the primary layer type targeted by the Sun system (see SunTerrainLayer.ApplySunHeat).

7.6 SunTerrainLayer (Sun Layer)

Purpose: A global system layer that simulates sun position and applies heat/cooling to target GeoPlast layers.

Key state:

- SunPosition : float2
- DayProgress , YearProgress
- SunSettings
- TargetLayers : List<SunTargetLayerSettings>

Core behavior:

- Simulate(GeoPlastLayerGroup geoPlastLayers, HexTerrainSimulationTimer timer, JobHandle dependency)
 - checks tick settings
 - moves the sun (MoveTheSun)
 - applies sun heat to each configured target layer (ApplySunHeat)

ApplySunHeat targets MaterialGeoPlastLayer and writes into its HeatMap using ApplySunHeatJob .

Persistence:

- Implements ISerializableTerrainLayer :
 - SerializeLayer(BinaryWriter writer)
 - DeserializeLayer(BinaryReader reader, HexTerrainSettings terrainSettings)

When to use:

- Day/night cycles, seasonal cycles, climate-driven simulation, energy input for thermal flow, etc.
-

8. Creating your own Terrain Layer

A custom layer typically consists of:

1. A **config interface** (optional but recommended)
2. A **ScriptableObject config asset** that implements that interface and `CreateTerrainLayer()`
3. A **layer class** inheriting `HexTerrainLayer`
4. (Optional) A **group** inheriting `HexTerrainLayerGroup<T>` if you want multiple instances

8.1 Define a config interface

Keep it small: only what the layer needs at runtime.

```
using Fwt.HexTerrains.Data;

public interface IMyLayerConfig
{
    InitCellValueDataLayerArgs<float> ValuesArgs { get; set; }
    float Multiplier { get; set; }
}
```

8.2 Implement the layer

Key points:

- Allocate/resize native data in `Init(HexTerrainSettings)`.
- Read config in `Init<TInitArgs>`.
- Use `PrepareToRead/Write + AddRead/WriteDependency`.
- Respect dirty flags for performance.
- Release native memory in `Dispose()`.

```

using Fwt.HexTerrains.Data;
using Fwt.HexTerrains.DataLayers;
using Unity.Jobs;

public class MyLayer : HexTerrainLayer
{
    public float Multiplier { get; private set; } = 1f;
    public ColorMapCellValueDataLayer_Float Values;

    public override void Init(HexTerrainSettings settings)
    {
        Values ??= new ColorMapCellValueDataLayer_Float();
        Values.InitColoredDataLayer(new InitColorMapCellValueDataLayerArgs<float>
        {
            DefaultValue = 0f
        });

        base.Init(settings);
    }

    public override void Init<TInitArgs>(HexTerrainSettings settings, TInitArgs initArgs)
    {
        base.Init(settings, initArgs);

        if (initArgs is IMyLayerConfig config)
        {
            Multiplier = config.Multiplier;
            InitColoredDataLayer(Values, config.ValuesArgs);
        }
    }

    public JobHandle DoWork(JobHandle dependency)
    {
        if (Values == null || !Values.IsDirty)
        {
            return dependency;
        }

        var deps = Values.PrepareToWrite();
        dependency = JobHandle.CombineDependencies(dependency, deps);

        // Schedule jobs here...
        // dependency = job.Schedule(Settings.CellsCount, Settings.CellsPerChunk, dependenc
y));

        Values.AddWriteDependency(dependency);
        Values.SetDirty(true);
        return dependency;
    }

    public override void SetAllDirty(bool isDirty)
    {

```

```

        Values?.SetAllChunksDirty(isDirty);
    }

    public override void CompleteAllJobs()
    {
        base.CompleteAllJobs();
        Values?.CompleteAllJobs();
    }

    public override void Cleanup()
    {
        Values?.Cleanup();
    }

    public override JobHandle CleanupAsync(JobHandle dependency)
    {
        return Values?.CleanupAsync(dependency) ?? dependency;
    }

    public override void Dispose()
    {
        base.Dispose();
        Values?.Dispose();
    }
}

```


8.3 Create the ScriptableObject config asset

```
using Fwt.HexTerrains.Data;
using UnityEngine;

[CreateAssetMenu(fileName = "MyLayerConfig", menuName = "Fwt/HexTerrains/Custom/My Layer Config")]
public class MyLayerConfigAsset : HexTerrainLayerConfigAsset<MyLayer>, IMyLayerConfig
{
    [SerializeField]
    private InitColorMapCellValueDataLayerArgs<float> _valuesArgs;

    [SerializeField]
    private float _multiplier = 1f;

    public InitCellValueDataLayerArgs<float> ValuesArgs
    {
        get => _valuesArgs;
        set => _valuesArgs = (InitColorMapCellValueDataLayerArgs<float>)value;
    }

    public float Multiplier { get => _multiplier; set => _multiplier = value; }

    public override HexTerrainLayer CreateTerrainLayer()
    {
        return new MyLayer();
    }
}
```

Implementation note: prefer matching the exact argument type you use (InitCellValueDataLayerArgs<T> vs InitColorMapCellValueDataLayerArgs<T>). The snippet above illustrates the idea; use the appropriate type for your layer's data.

8.4 (Optional) Add a group

If you want multiple instances (e.g., multiple MyLayer s), create:

- MyLayerGroup : HexTerrainLayerGroup<MyLayer>

Then add orchestration methods the way existing groups do (combine job handles, render loops, etc.).

9. Best practices & pitfalls

9.1 Always respect job dependencies

- Call PrepareToRead() / PrepareToWrite() before scheduling.

- Combine dependencies with the incoming `JobHandle` .
- Register the resulting handle back into each data layer.

This prevents race conditions and hard-to-debug memory safety issues.

9.2 Avoid unnecessary work

- Use `IsDirty` checks early.
- Prefer chunk-level dirty sets when generating meshes.

9.3 Complete jobs before resizing or disposing

- `HexTerrainLayer.Init` calls `CompleteAllJobs()` for safety.
- In your layer, override `CompleteAllJobs()` and complete your data layers too.

9.4 Keep UnityEngine API calls out of jobs

Jobs should operate on blittable/native data. Keep any Unity object manipulation (like creating `Mesh` instances) on the main thread, typically in methods such as `CreateChunkMeshes()` .

9.5 Use `HexTerrainLayerReference` for cross-layer wiring

Prefer references over hard-coded indices so configurations remain stable when layer order changes.

Summary

- `HexTerrainLayer` defines a strict lifecycle and safe job-based data access patterns.
- `HexTerrainLayerGroup` composes layers, provides lookup by name/index/reference, and orchestrates jobs across many layers.
- The framework's main pillar layers cover:
 - surface data & meshes (`ChunkMeshLayer` / `VisualChunkMeshLayer`)
 - ECS-backed content (`CellEntityLayer`)
 - instanced visuals (`CellObjectLayer`)
 - region clustering (`CellRegionLayer`)
 - geo/material simulation (`GeoPlastLayer` family)
 - global energy input (`SunTerrainLayer`)
- Custom layers follow the same pattern: config interface + config asset + layer class (+ optional group).



Data Layers Overview

What is a Data Layer?

A **Data Layer** is a specialized container used to store, manage, and process data efficiently in Unity. Specifically designed to work seamlessly with Unity's Job System and Burst Compiler, Data Layers provide built-in dependency tracking, state monitoring (dirty flags), and memory management.

Data Layers excel in scenarios where massive amounts of data—such as terrain cell values, colors, or heights—need to be modified on the main thread and read by background worker jobs, or vice versa.

Core Capabilities:

1. **Dependency Tracking:** Built-in `JobHandle` management for safe, parallel reading and writing without race conditions.
2. **State & Versioning:** Tracks if the data is dirty (`IsDirty`) and maintains a `Version` number, making it easy to invalidate caches or trigger updates only when necessary.
3. **Memory Management:** Automatically handles disposal of unmanaged memory, native collections, and optionally, disposable data items contained within the layer.
4. **Chunking Support:** Capable of dividing localized grid data into "chunks" to track dirty states spatially (e.g., when a single terrain cell is modified, only its specific chunk is marked for regeneration).

How to Work with Data Layers

Data layers are designed to be accessed both immediately on the main thread and asynchronously via the Unity Job System.

Synchronous Access (Immediate)

If you need to read or write data immediately on the main thread, you must signal to the layer to complete any running jobs before proceeding.

- **`OpenToRead()`** : Completes all currently scheduled *write* jobs. Use this before reading data on the main thread.
- **`OpenToWrite()`** : Completes *all* currently scheduled (read and write) jobs. Use this before modifying data on the main thread.

```
myNativeDataLayer.OpenToWrite();  
myNativeDataLayer.SetData(cellIndex, newValue);  
myNativeDataLayer.CommitChanges(); // Marks the layer as dirty
```

Asynchronous Access (Unity Jobs)

When scheduling jobs that use a Data Layer's underlying structures, you request the necessary dependencies and update the layer once the job is scheduled.

- **PrepareToRead()** : Returns a `JobHandle` representing all current write dependencies. Your job runs after the writes finish.
- **PrepareToWrite()** : Returns a `JobHandle` representing all current read and write dependencies. Your job runs after everything else finishes.
- **AddReadDependency(JobHandle)** / **AddWriteDependency(JobHandle)** : Stores your newly scheduled job's handle in the layer so future operations wait for it.

```
// 1. Prepare to write
JobHandle deps = myNativeDataLayer.PrepareToWrite();

// 2. Schedule your job
var myJob = new ModifyDataJob
{
    Data = myNativeDataLayer.Data.AsArray()
};
JobHandle jobHandle = myJob.Schedule(myNativeDataLayer.Length, 64, deps);

// 3. Register the newly scheduled job
myNativeDataLayer.AddWriteDependency(jobHandle);
myNativeDataLayer.SetDirty(true);
```

Types of Data Layers

The framework provides a comprehensive hierarchy of generic Data Layers catering to various storage needs.

1. Basic & Native Collections

These standard models wrap common collection types with Data Layer tracking logic.

- **Managed Collections:** `ArrayDataLayer<T>`, `ListDataLayer<T>`, `DictionaryDataLayer<TKey, TItem>`, `HashSetDataLayer<T>`.
- **Native Collections:** Provide `Unity.Collections` variants safe for use inside the Burst Compiler (e.g., `NativeArrayDataLayer<T>`, `NativeListDataLayer<T>`, `NativeHashMapDataLayer<TKey, TItem>`, `NativeParallelHashSetDataLayer<T>`).

2. Chunked Data Layers

`ChunkedDataLayer` forms the backbone of spatial data tracking. It splits grid-based datasets (like terrain maps) into localized "chunks."

When you set a cell as dirty via `SetCellDirty(cellIndex)`, the layer flags the underlying chunk as dirty via the `ChunkDirtyGrid` and `DirtyChunks` arrays.

- **Edge Wrapping:** Chunk layers understand grid connections. If `IsConnectedHorizontally` or `IsConnectedVertically` are enabled, setting a cell on the grid seam automatically flags the wrapped adjacent chunk on the far side of the map as dirty.
- **Subclasses:** `ArrayChunkedDataLayer<T>`, `ListChunkedDataLayer<T>`, `NativeArrayChunkedDataLayer<T>`, `NativeListChunkedDataLayer<T>`.

3. Hex Terrain Specific Layers

These provide direct integration with `HexTerrainSettings` ensuring automatic size matching and terrain chunk topology rules.

- **HexTerrainNativeListChunkedDataLayer<TItem>** : Inherits the Native List chunking concepts but auto-configures sizes through a `HexTerrainSettings` profile.
- **CellValueDataLayer<TCellValue>** : Stores a numeric or structural value per discrete hexagon cell.
- **CellColorsDataLayer** : Explicitly stores a `Color32` value per cell. Allows bulk-applying its stored color data directly to a given `Texture2D` utilizing fast memory transfer operations (`ApplyColorsToTexture()`).
- **ColorMapDataLayer** : An extension of `CellColorsDataLayer` that also stores a `ColorPalette` (`NativeList<Color32>`). Ideal for coloring terrain surfaces based on specific index-to-color palettes.
- **ColorMapCellValueDataLayer<TCellValue>** : A synchronized pairing of a `CellValueDataLayer` and a `ColorMapDataLayer`. It stores the actual *value* (e.g., height, temperature, moisture) and maintains an explicit visual *Color Map* layer linked to it.
- **AutoColorMapCellValueDataLayer<TCellValue>** : Automates the pipeline of converting cell values into visual colors via Jobs. It supports different mapping modes via `AutoColorMapMode` :
 - **ColorIndexByValue:** The raw cell value is an exact index mapping to an entry in the Color Palette.
 - **GradientThroughPalette:** Normalized lerp between `MinValue` and `MaxValue` determines the position across the color palette array.
 - **Custom:** Override `CalculateColorMap_Custom()` to supply entirely bespoke translation Jobs. *(Implementations provided out-of-the-box include `ColorMapCellValueDataLayer_Int` and `ColorMapCellValueDataLayer_Float`.)*

Memory Management and Disposal

Data Layers implement `IDisposable`. Because they heavily utilize Unity Native Collections (`NativeList`, `NativeArray`, etc.), calling `Dispose()` on the Data Layer is required to prevent memory leaks.

By default:

1. `Dispose()` calls `CompleteAllJobs()` ensuring underlying data is no longer actively being accessed by worker threads.
 2. Unmanaged collections are freed.
 3. If `IsDisposableItems` is `true`, it iterates and safely disposes of the inner discrete element items before structural release.
-

Practical Example: Chunk Mesh Layer & Cell Metrics

To fully grasp how Data Layers interact in practice, let's look at `ChunkMeshLayer` and how it calculates `HexCellMetrics`.

A `ChunkMeshLayer` holds multiple Data Layers representing different terrain features:

- `HeightMap` (`ColorMapCellValueDataLayer_Float`)
- `BiomeMap` (`ColorMapCellValueDataLayer_Int`)
- `TransparencyMap` (`CellValueDataLayer<bool>`)
- `CellMetricsMap` (`CellMetricsDataLayer` - purely an output layer based on the above)

When terrain generation or modification occurs, we need to recalculate the physical cell properties (metrics) such as local/global coordinates, calculated height in units, and transformation matrices. Data Layers ensure this process is performant, asynchronous, and only processes what has actually changed.

The Calculation Pipeline

The `CalcCellMetrics(JobHandle dependency)` method in `ChunkMeshLayer` demonstrates the complete lifecycle of reading from multiple Data Layers and writing to another using the Unity Job System.

1. Checking Dirty States

First, the system prevents unnecessary work by checking the `IsDirty` flag of the source layers and the destination layer.

```
// If nothing has changed, simply return the input dependency
if (!HeightMap.IsDirty && !BiomeMap.IsDirty && !CellMetricsMap.IsDirty && !TransparencyMap.IsDirty)
{
    return dependency;
}
```

2. Preparing Job Dependencies

Before reading or writing to Native Collections, the layer must wait for any previously scheduled jobs to finish. `PrepareToRead()` and `PrepareToWrite()` fetch these dependencies.

```
// The Metrics map will be modified, so we prepare to WRITE
var deps1 = CellMetricsMap.PrepareToWrite();

// Height, Biome, and Transparency maps will only be read, so we prepare to READ
var deps2 = HeightMap.PrepareToRead();
var deps3 = BiomeMap.PrepareToRead();
var deps4 = TransparencyMap.PrepareToRead();

// Combine all handles with the input dependency
dependency = JobHandle.CombineDependencies(dependency, deps1, deps2);
dependency = JobHandle.CombineDependencies(dependency, deps3, deps4);
```

3. Merging Dirty Grids (Chunking Optimization)

Since these are *Chunked* Data Layers, we don't want to recalculate metrics for the entire map—only for the chunks where height, biome, or transparency changed. `MergeChunkDirtyGrids` combines the dirty flags from the source layers into the destination's chunk grid.

```
dependency = CellMetricsMap.MergeChunkDirtyGrids(HeightMap, BiomeMap, TransparencyMap, dependency);

// CellMetricsMap's ChunkDirtyGrid now contains 'true' for any chunk
// that was marked dirty in HeightMap, BiomeMap, or TransparencyMap.
```

4. Scheduling the Burst Job

Next, the actual data is passed to a Burst-compiled `IJobParallelFor` struct (`CalcHexCellMetricsJob`). Notice the use of `.ToArray()` to extract the underlying Native Arrays cleanly.

```
var job = new CalcHexCellMetricsJob
{
    TerrainSettings = Settings,
    TerrainMetrics = TerrainMetrics,
    TransparencyMap = TransparencyMap.Data.ToArray(),
    HeightMap = HeightMap.Data.ToArray(),
    ColorMap = BiomeMap.Data.ToArray(),
    // We pass the merged dirty grid so the job knows which chunks to process
    ChunkDirtyGrid = CellMetricsMap.ChunkDirtyGrid.ToArray(),

    // Output arrays
    CellMetrics = CellMetricsMap.Data.ToArray(),
    CellPositions = CellMetricsMap.CellPositions.ToArray(),
};

dependency = job.Schedule(Settings.CellsCount, Settings.CellsPerChunk, dependency);
```

Inside the Job's `Execute(int index)` method, the code checks `ChunkDirtyGrid[chunkIndex]` . If the chunk isn't dirty, it immediately returns, saving massive amounts of CPU time.

5. Registering the Scheduled Job

Finally, the modified and read Data Layers need to be informed of this newly scheduled job so they can protect their memory in future operations. The destination layer is also marked as dirty, triggering its own downstream updates (like mesh generation).

```
// Set write dependency on the output layer
CellMetricsMap.SetWriteDependency(dependency);

// Add read dependencies on the source layers
HeightMap.AddReadDependency(dependency);
BiomeMap.AddReadDependency(dependency);
TransparencyMap.AddReadDependency(dependency);

// Mark the CellMetricsMap as dirty so downstream systems know it changed
CellMetricsMap.SetDirty(true);
return dependency;
```

Summary of the Workflow

By utilizing Data Layers, `ChunkMeshLayer` completely avoids blocking the main thread during heavy calculations. Data Layers safely bridge the gap between complex game logic state, dependency tracking, chunk-based culling, and highly optimized Unity Burst jobs.

Serialization & Deserialization

This document explains how **saving/loading** works in HexTerrains, how **terrain layers** participate in serialization via `ISerializableTerrainLayer`, how `HexTerrainSerializer` writes/reads the binary format, and how to add serialization support to a **custom user terrain layer**.

1) High-level model

HexTerrains stores runtime terrain state on a **terrain entity** (Unity Entities / ECS):

- The terrain entity always contains `HexTerrain ( IComponentData )` which holds `HexTerrainSettings`.
- Terrain “layers” are typically stored as **managed components** (component objects) on the same entity.
- Any managed component that implements `ISerializableTerrainLayer` can be saved/loaded by `HexTerrainSerializer`.

Key interface:

- `ISerializableTerrainLayer`
 - `bool SerializeLayer(BinaryWriter writer)`
 - `bool DeserializeLayer(BinaryReader reader, HexTerrainSettings terrainSettings)`
-

2) HexTerrainSerializer overview

`HexTerrainSerializer` is a static utility that serializes a **single terrain entity** to/from a binary stream or file.

Entry points

Saving:

- `HexTerrainSerializer.SaveTerrainToFile(filePath, terrainEntity, entityManager, customSerializer)`
- `HexTerrainSerializer.Serialize(stream, terrainEntity, entityManager, customSerializer)`
- `HexTerrainSerializer.Serialize(writer, terrainEntity, entityManager, customSerializer)`

Loading:

- `HexTerrainSerializer.LoadTerrainFromFile(filePath, terrainEntity, entityManager, customDeserializer)`
- `HexTerrainSerializer.LoadTerrainFromFile(byte[] fileContent, terrainEntity, entityManager, customDeserializer)`
- `HexTerrainSerializer.Deserialize(stream, terrainEntity, entityManager, customDeserializer)`
- `HexTerrainSerializer.Deserialize(reader, terrainEntity, entityManager, customDeserializer)`

Serializer versioning

`HexTerrainSerializer.Version` is written first (currently 2).

- Version 1+ : introduces the managed-component layer serialization loop (type hash + layer payload).

- Version 2+ : adds `HexTerrainSettings.SlopeSize` to the saved settings payload.

When adding new fields to `HexTerrainSettings` , the serializer version should be bumped and `ReadTerrainSettings(...)` should be updated with version guards.

3) Binary format (what actually gets written)

At a high level the file is:

1. **Serializer version** (`int`)
2. **Terrain settings** (`HexTerrainSettings` fields written in a stable order)
3. **Zero or more layer/component records** until end-of-stream:
 - `StableTypeHash` (`ulong`)
 - component/layer payload written by `ISerializableTerrainLayer.SerializeLayer(...)`

There is **no component count** stored for the layer records: the reader continues until `reader.BaseStream.Position == reader.BaseStream.Length` .

Type identity: Stable Type Hash

For each serialized managed component, `HexTerrainSerializer` writes:

- `TypeHash.CalculateStableTypeHash(componentType.GetManagedType())`

During load:

- `TypeManager.GetTypeIndexFromStableTypeHash(typeHash)`
- `TypeManager.GetType(typeIndex)`

This means save files depend on the **stable identity** of component types. Renaming/moving a type (or changing assemblies) may break loading unless handled via a custom deserializer.

4) How terrain layers participate

4.1 Managed components are scanned automatically

During save (`WriteVersion1`), the serializer enumerates all component types on the terrain entity and selects:

- **managed components**
- non-zero-sized

For each managed component object:

1. If `customSerializer` is provided and returns `true` , the serializer assumes the component was handled and skips default logic.
2. Otherwise, if `componentObj` is `ISerializableTerrainLayer` , it writes the type hash and calls `SerializeLayer(writer)` .

4.2 Deserialization expects components to exist

During load (`ReadVersion1`):

1. It reads the type hash and resolves `componentType`.
2. If `customDeserializer` is provided and returns `true`, it assumes you handled that record (including reading bytes) and continues.
3. Otherwise it does:
 - `entityManager.GetComponentObject<object>(terrainEntity, componentType)`
 - if it implements `ISerializableTerrainLayer`, calls `DeserializeLayer(reader, terrainSettings)`.

Implication: **the terrain entity must already have the corresponding managed component attached** for the default path to work (because `GetComponentObject` retrieves an existing component instance). If you need to create/attach missing components dynamically, do it in `customDeserializer`.

5) Layer groups (`HexTerrainLayerGroup`) are serializable too

`HexTerrainLayerGroup : HexTerrainLayer, ISerializableTerrainLayer` provides a standard way to serialize a *collection of layers*:

- Writes `Layers.Count (int)`
- For each index:
 - `hasLayer (bool)`
 - `layer.Name (string)`
 - delegates to the layer's `SerializeLayer(...)` / `DeserializeLayer(...)` if it implements `ISerializableTerrainLayer`

This means:

- If your terrain uses a group component (for example, a mesh-layer group), the group can be a single serializable managed component that recursively serializes its children.
-

6) Example: `ChunkMeshLayer` serialization

`ChunkMeshLayer : HexTerrainLayer, ISerializableTerrainLayer` demonstrates best practices:

- Calls `CompleteAllJobs()` before reading/writing (important for job-driven data layers).
 - Serializes only the **authoritative** data:
 - `HeightMap.Serialize(writer)`
 - `BiomeMap.Serialize(writer)`
 - `TransparencyMap.Serialize(writer)`
 - It does **not** serialize derived/runtime-only data like `CellMetricsMap` (those are recalculated).
 - On load:
 - calls `Init(terrainSettings)` to allocate data layers to the correct size
 - deserializes maps
 - calls `SetAllDirty(true)` so downstream systems recompute dependent data (metrics, meshes, color maps, etc.)
-

7) Custom hooks: customSerializer / customDeserializer

HexTerrainSerializer supports two optional callbacks:

`CustomSerializerCallback(BinaryWriter writer, object componentObject)`

Use this when:

- a component does **not** implement `ISerializableTerrainLayer`
- you want a different format than `SerializeLayer`
- you want to skip a component entirely

Return `true` to tell the serializer "I handled it".

`CustomDeserializerCallback(BinaryReader reader, Type componentType, HexTerrainSettings terrainSettings)`

Use this when:

- a component type hash no longer maps to a known type
- you want to **create/add** a missing managed component before deserializing
- you want to apply migrations/rename mappings
- you want to read custom payloads

Return `true` only if you fully consumed the corresponding payload bytes from the stream.

8) Adding serialization support to a new custom terrain layer

Step-by-step checklist

1. **Store your runtime state** inside the layer (often via data layers like `CellValueDataLayer<T>`, `ColorMapCellValueDataLayer<T>`, etc.).
2. Implement `ISerializableTerrainLayer` on your layer component.
3. In `SerializeLayer` :
 - call `CompleteAllJobs()` (if the layer uses jobs/native containers)
 - write a **layer-local version** (`int`) if you expect the layer format to evolve
 - write your data in a strict order
4. In `DeserializeLayer` :
 - call `CompleteAllJobs()`
 - call `Init(terrainSettings)` (or equivalent) so containers match the saved terrain size
 - read version and data in the exact order you wrote it
 - mark derived outputs dirty (or recompute) so visuals and dependent layers update

Minimal example

Below is a simple managed layer that stores one integer per cell and persists it.

```

using System.IO;
using Fwt.HexTerrains.Data;
using Fwt.HexTerrains.DataLayers;

namespace Fwt.HexTerrains
{
    public sealed class MyCustomIntLayer : HexTerrainLayer, ISerializableTerrainLayer
    {
        private const int LayerFormatVersion = 1;

        public CellValueDataLayer<int> Values;

        public override void Init(HexTerrainSettings settings)
        {
            Values ??= new CellValueDataLayer<int>();
            Values.Init(settings.CellsCount, settings);

            base.Init(settings);
        }

        public override void CompleteAllJobs()
        {
            Values?.CompleteAllJobs();
            base.CompleteAllJobs();
        }

        public override void Cleanup()
        {
            Values?.Cleanup();
        }

        public override Unity.Jobs.JobHandle CleanupAsync(Unity.Jobs.JobHandle dependency)
        {
            return Values?.CleanupAsync(dependency) ?? dependency;
        }

        public override void SetAllDirty(bool isDirty)
        {
            Values?.SetAllChunksDirty(isDirty);
        }

        public bool SerializeLayer(BinaryWriter writer)
        {
            if (writer == null)
            {
                return false;
            }

            CompleteAllJobs();

            writer.Write(LayerFormatVersion);
        }
    }
}

```

```

        // Persist the data layer. NativeListChunkedDataLayer.Serialize writes:
        // - a presence flag (bool)
        // - the NativeArray payload
        return Values?.Serialize(writer) ?? false;
    }

    public bool DeserializeLayer(BinaryReader reader, HexTerrainSettings terrainSettings)
    {
        if (reader == null)
        {
            return false;
        }

        CompleteAllJobs();
        Init(terrainSettings);

        var version = reader.ReadInt32();
        if (version > LayerFormatVersion)
        {
            // Optionally handle forward-compat here (or fail).
        }

        var ok = Values?.Deserialize(reader) ?? false;

        // Ensure dependent systems recompute anything derived from Values
        SetAllDirty(true);

        return ok;
    }

    public override void Dispose()
    {
        Values?.Dispose();
        base.Dispose();
    }
}

```

Step: make sure the layer is on the terrain entity

For the default deserialization path to work, the layer instance must already exist on the terrain entity as a **managed component**.

If you need to add it on demand (or migrate), use `customDeserializer` to attach/create it before calling its `DeserializeLayer(...)`.

9) Common pitfalls

- **Forgetting** `CompleteAllJobs()` before serialization: can lead to partial/invalid data.

- **Serializing derived caches** (like metrics or meshes): prefer serializing the minimal authoritative inputs, then recompute.
 - **Type rename breaks stable hashes**: use `customDeserializer` to map old types or handle missing components.
 - **Changing field order** in `SerializeLayer` without a version guard: always version your layer payload if it might evolve.
-

UserTools

`UserTools` is the HexTerrains runtime “tooling” layer: a set of interactive states (tools) driven by a state machine. A tool is represented by a `UserToolStateBase` (or a derived class) and is typically selected by a `UserToolTypes` id.

At runtime you:

1. Build a `UserToolsStateMachine`
 2. Initialize it with a list of tool configs (`IUserToolStateConfig` , usually `UserToolStateConfigAsset` `ScriptableObject`s)
 3. Initialize it with the current `ISHexTerrainAPI`
 4. Switch active tool by `UserToolTypes`
 5. Call `Tick()` each frame
-

Key types overview

UserToolTypes

`UserToolTypes` is the canonical list of tool ids (ints) used to switch tools without relying on state indices.

File: `Runtime\UserTools\UserToolTypes.cs`

Example:

- `UserToolTypes.Pointer`
 - `UserToolTypes.PaintCellObjects` (value 306)
-

UserToolStateBase

File: `Runtime\UserTools\SM\UserToolStateBase.cs`

`UserToolStateBase` is the root base class for tool states. It inherits `SmState` (from `Fwt.Core.StateMachines`) and adds:

- `UserToolType` (abstract `int`): the id used by `UserToolsStateMachine` to find and switch the tool.
- `Settings` (`UserToolStateSettings`): basic tool metadata (currently only `Name`).
- `Init(UserToolStateSettings)` and `Init<TInitArgs>(TInitArgs)` :
 - If `TInitArgs` implements `IUserToolStateConfig` , the tool is initialized with `IUserToolStateConfig.ToolSettings` .
 - Otherwise, default settings (`UserToolStateSettings.Default`) are used.

Notes:

- `Tick()` is virtual and empty here. Actual tool behavior is implemented in derived states.
-

Tool state families (derived from `UserToolStateBase`)

HexTerrainUserToolStateBase

File: `Runtime\UserTools\SM\HexTerrainUserToolStateBase.cs`

Adds HexTerrains integration to a tool state:

- `TerrainAPI` (`ITerrainAPI`): the runtime API entry point for terrain operations and UI.
- `HexTerrainUserToolSettings` (`HexTerrainUserToolStateSettings`): currently controls view mode behavior:
 - `IsChangeViewMode`
 - `RequiredViewMode`
- Lifecycle integration:
 - `PrepareToRun()` stores current view mode and optionally switches to the required view mode.
 - `PrepareToStop()` optionally restores the previous view mode.
- UI helpers:
 - `GetUIScreen<TScreen>()` via `TerrainAPI.GetOrCreateUIScreen<TScreen>()`
 - `ShowSettingsScreen(...)` / `HideSettingsScreen<TScreen>()`
- Cursor helpers:
 - `SetupTerrainCursor(...)` variants for visibility, size, color, resizability.

This is the typical base for any tool that needs terrain data, cursor, and/or UI.

Brush tools: `BrushUserToolState<...>`

File: `Runtime\UserTools\SM\BrushUserToolState.cs`

Brush tools are interactive tools that apply an operation to one or many cells based on:

- mouse input
- raycast hit (`TerrainAPI.GetRaycastData()`)
- brush size / opacity (`TerrainAPI.GetBrushSize()` , `TerrainAPI.GetBrushOpacity()`)

`BrushUserToolState<TBrushTarget>`

Core brush behavior:

- Input and interaction settings:
 - `TimeThreshold` (rate limit between brush applies)
 - `CanChangeBrushSize`
 - `AllowRightMouseButton`
 - hotkeys: `ChangeModeKey` , `ChangeBrushSizeKey` , `ChangeOpacityKey` , plus +/- keys
 - `CursorColor`
- `Tick()` :
 1. updates cursor and brush parameters (`UpdateBrush()`)
 2. attempts to apply brush (`TryApplyBrush()`)
- Brush application rules:
 - brush mode is 0 by default, 1 when `ChangeModeKey` is held
 - calls one of:
 - `ApplyBrushToAllCells(...)` (if `IsAppliedToEveryCellOnMap(brushMode)` is true)
 - `ApplyToSingleCell(...)` (single cell or non-resizable brush)
 - `ApplyBrushToAllBrushPoints(...)` (area brush using `HexMath.GetCellsRange_Offset(...)`)
- The tool-specific operation is implemented by overriding:

- `ApplyBrush(int brushMode, int2 cellCoord, int cellIndex, TBrushTarget brushTarget, int mouseButton)`

Brush tools with persistent settings (data source + PlayerPrefs)

Brush tools often use the additional generic layers:

- `BrushUserToolState<TBrushTarget, TSettings>`
 - adds `DataSource` (usually a UI-friendly settings model)
 - loads settings on start (`PrepareToRun()` → `InitSettings()` → `LoadSettings()`)
 - saves settings on stop (`PrepareToStop()` → `SaveSettings()`)
 - includes helpers to store values in `PlayerPrefs` :
 - `SaveSettingsValue<TValue>(...)`
 - `LoadSettingsValueOrDefault<TValue>(...)`
- `BrushUserToolState<TBrushTarget, TSettings, TSettingsScreen>`
 - shows/hides a settings UI screen while the tool is active
 - uses `ShowSettingsScreen(...)` from `HexTerrainUserToolStateBase`
- `BrushUserToolState<TBrushTarget, TSettings, TSettingsScreen, TTerrainLayer>`
 - adds a standard way to resolve the active terrain layer by index and/or name
 - supports per-layer view mode mapping (`ViewModeByLayerIndex`)

Cell-item painting tool states

A representative chain (simplified):

- `UserToolStateBase`
 - `HexTerrainUserToolStateBase`
 - `BrushUserToolState<...>`
 - `PaintCellItemUserToolStateBase<...>`
 - `PaintCellItemAllDataUserToolStateBase<...>`
 - `PaintCellObjectsUserToolState`

`PaintCellItemUserToolStateBase<...>`

File: `Runtime\UserTools\SM\States\CellItems\PaintCellItemUserToolStateBase.cs`

Builds a standard “paint a cell item layer” tool:

- Uses `UserToolSettingsDataSource` + `UniversalToolSettingsScreen`
- Adds common parameters to `DataSource` :
 - `TerrainLayerIndex`
 - `ChunkMeshLayerIndex`
 - optional filters:
 - `IsCheckCellHeight, MinCellHeight, MaxCellHeight`
 - `IsCheckBiome, MinBiomeIndex, MaxBiomeIndex`
- Supports “read value under cursor instead of painting”:
 - `ReadCellKey` (default `LeftAlt`, configurable)

`PaintCellItemAllDataUserToolStateBase<...>`

File: `Runtime\UserTools\SM\States\CellItems\PaintCellItemAllDataUserToolStateBase.cs`

Adds parameters for painting all common item fields:

- `ItemIndex`, `ItemState`
- `ItemPosition`, `ItemRotation`, `ItemScale`

Implements `ApplyBrush(...)`:

- If `ReadCellKey` is held: reads the cell values from the layer and updates the tool parameters (no painting).
- Brush mode `0`: paints only the targeted cell (subject to optional filters).
- Brush mode `1`: paints every cell (or filtered subset), depending on filter flags.

Tool configuration: `UserToolStateConfigAsset` and derived types

`IUserToolStateConfig`

File: `Runtime\UserTools\SM\Data\IUserToolStateConfig.cs`

A tool config must provide:

- `ToolSettings` (`UserToolStateSettings`)
- `CreateUserToolState(ISmState parent)` (factory method)

`UserToolStateConfigAsset`

File: `Runtime\UserTools\SM\Configs\UserToolStateConfigAsset.cs`

A Unity `ScriptableObject` implementation of `IUserToolStateConfig`:

- `serialized UserToolStateSettings _toolSettings`
- `abstract CreateUserToolState(...)`

This is the most common way to declare tools in the Unity Editor and initialize them in a consistent way.

HexTerrain-specific config layers

These add more config surfaces without changing the state machine contract:

- `HexTerrainUserToolStateConfigAsset`
 - adds `HexTerrainUserToolStateSettings TerrainToolSettings`
- `HexTerrainBrushUserToolStateConfigAsset`
 - adds brush behavior fields (time threshold, keys, cursor color, etc.)
 - matches what `BrushUserToolState<TBrushTarget>.Init<TInitArgs>()` consumes via `IHexTerrainBrushUserToolStateConfig`
- `HexTerrainLayerGroupBrushUserToolStateConfigAsset`
 - adds `ViewModeByLayerIndex`
- `PaintCellItemUserToolStateConfigAsset`
 - adds `ReadValueKey` (key used to read cell value under cursor)

Tool-specific config assets usually derive from one of these and implement `CreateUserToolState(...)`.

Initialization flow (UserTools + state machine)

UserToolsStateMachine

File: Runtime\UserTools\SM\UserToolsStateMachine.cs

UserToolsStateMachine is a specialized SmStateMachine that:

- stores states in the base States list (state-machine order)
- additionally indexes tool states by UserToolType (StatesByType) for fast selection

Key methods:

- InitStates<TInitArgs>(IEnumerable<TInitArgs> requests) where TInitArgs : IUserToolStateConfig
 - creates/replaces states based on the config sequence
 - calls state.Init(request) for each created/reused state
- InitStates(IHexTerrainAPI terrainAPI)
 - for each state in States, if it is a HexTerrainUserToolStateBase, calls userToolState.Init(terrainAPI)
- SwitchStateByUserToolType(int userToolType)
 - finds a tool in StatesByType and switches the state machine to it (calls PrepareToStop() on the previous state and PrepareToRun() on the new state via SmStateMachine.SwitchState(...))

How tools are typically initialized

A common initialization sequence is:

1. Prepare a list of configs (usually UserToolStateConfigAsset references from the Inspector)
2. Create UserToolsStateMachine
3. Call:
 - userToolsSm.Init(configs, terrainAPI)
 - (this calls Init(configs) then Init(terrainAPI))

In update loop:

- call userToolsSm.Tick() every frame

On shutdown:

- call userToolsSm.Dispose() (disposes disposable states)
- optionally ClearStates() if you need to rebuild the tool set

graph TD;

```
A["Unity bootstrap (MonoBehaviour / system)"] --> B["Create UserToolsStateMachine"]
B --> C["Init(configAssets) → create states + apply config"]
C --> D["Init(terrainAPI) → inject IHexTerrainAPI into hex-terrain states"]
D --> E["Select tool: SwitchStateByUserToolType((int)UserToolTypes.X)"]
E --> F["Each frame: Tick() → tool logic"]
F --> G["State transition: old PrepareToStop() / new PrepareToRun()"]
```

How to use UserTools

1) Provide tool configs

Create (or reference) a set of `UserToolStateConfigAsset` `ScriptableObjects`. Each config must implement `CreateUserToolState(...)`.

2) Initialize state machine

Call `UserToolsStateMachine.Init(...)` with:

- `configs ( IEnumerable<IUserToolStateConfig> )`
- `IHexTerrainAPI`

3) Switch tools

Switch by type id (`UserToolTypes`) using:

- `SwitchStateByUserToolType((int)UserToolTypes.PaintCellObjects)`

4) Tick

Call `Tick()` each frame from your update loop. Brush tools apply operations during `Tick()` based on input + raycast hit.

Creating a new UserTool (example: PaintCellObjectsUserToolState)

`PaintCellObjectsUserToolState` is a minimal “concrete tool state” because all behavior is inherited from `PaintCellItemAllDataUserToolStateBase<...>`.

File: `Runtime\UserTools\SM\States\CellObjects\PaintCellObjectsUserToolState.cs`

```
public class PaintCellObjectsUserToolState : PaintCellItemAllDataUserToolStateBase<CellObjectLayerGroup, CellObjectLayer, ChunkMeshLayerGroup, ChunkMeshLayer>
{
    public override int UserToolType => (int)UserToolTypes.PaintCellObjects;
    public PaintCellObjectsUserToolState(ISmState parent) : base(parent) { }
}
```

Step-by-step: adding a similar tool

Step 1: Add/choose a `UserToolTypes` id

If you are adding a brand new tool type, add a new enum value to `UserToolTypes` (or reuse an existing one).

Step 2: Implement the tool state

Option A (simple): inherit an existing base (like `PaintCellItemAllDataUserToolStateBase`) and only override `UserToolType` .

Option B (custom): inherit `UserToolStateBase` / `HexTerrainUserToolStateBase` / `BrushUserToolState<TBrushTarget>` and implement:

- `ApplyBrush(...)` (for brush tools)
- optional UI settings (via the `BrushUserToolState<..., TSettings, TSettingsScreen>` layers)

Step 3: Create a config asset for the tool (recommended)

Create a `ScriptableObject` config asset so the tool can be instantiated and configured from the editor.

Below is an example config asset for `PaintCellObjectsUserToolState` . Place it near other tool configs (for consistency, under `Runtime\UserTools\SM\Configs\States\...`).

`com.freewebtime.hexterrains\Runtime\UserTools\SM\Configs\States\CellObjects\PaintCellObjectsUserToolStateConfigAsset`

```
using Fwt.Core.StateMachines;
using Fwt.HexTerrains.UserTools.SM;
using UnityEngine;

namespace Fwt.HexTerrains.UserTools.SM.Configs
{
    [CreateAssetMenu( fileName = "PaintCellObjectsUserToolStateConfig", menuName = "Fwt/HexTerrains/UserTools/Paint Cell Objects Tool Config" )]
    public class PaintCellObjectsUserToolStateConfigAsset : PaintCellItemUserToolStateConfigAsset
    {
        public override UserToolStateBase CreateUserToolState(ISmState parent)
        {
            return new States.CellObjects.PaintCellObjectsUserToolState(parent);
        }
    }
}
```

Step 4: Register the config in your tool initialization list

Add the created config asset to the collection passed into `UserToolsStateMachine.Init(configs, terrainAPI)` .

Step 5: Switch to the tool at runtime

```
userToolsSm.SwitchStateByUserToolType((int)UserToolTypes.PaintCellObjects);
```

Notes / gotchas

- `UserToolsStateMachine` indexes tools by `UserToolStateBase.UserToolType` . If two states return the same `UserToolType` , the last one added wins in `StatesByType` .
- Brush tools intentionally rate-limit changes via `TimeTreshold` .
- Many brush tools persist user parameters via `PlayerPrefs` (see `BrushUserToolState<TBrushTarget, TSettings>`). If you change setting key names, existing saved values may no longer load.

User Interface (UI) in Hex Terrains Framework

Hex Terrains Framework UI is built on **Unity UI Toolkit** and a lightweight MVVM-style pattern:

- **View:** `UIDocument` + `UXML/USS` (UI Toolkit)
- **View host / screen:** `UIScreen` (and derived types) that own the `UIDocument` and control show/hide
- **View model / data:** plain C# objects (usually derived from `UIDataSource`) assigned to `rootVisualElement.dataSource`
- **Binding:** UI Toolkit **data binding** (binding paths + change/version tracking)

This document explains the core pieces and how to use them together.

UI Toolkit usage in the framework

What UI Toolkit provides

UI Toolkit is Unity's retained-mode UI system:

- Layout + styling via **UXML** and **USS**
- A runtime UI root via `UIDocument`
- A binding system that can **bind VisualElement properties** to properties on a C# `dataSource` object

Hex Terrains Framework leans into this by:

- Using `UIDocument` for screens (`UIScreen` and friends)
- Putting all runtime "state" into data sources (typically `UIDataSource`)
- Using UI Toolkit binding paths to connect UXML elements to that data

The binding root: `VisualElement.dataSource`

A screen assigns its view-data to the document root:

- `UIDocument.rootVisualElement.dataSource = viewData;`

Once set, UI elements in that document can bind to properties on that object using **binding paths**.

This is the single most important rule: **if the root `dataSource` is not set, bindings won't resolve**.

Screens: `UIScreen` and screen management

`UIScreen`: a UI Toolkit screen prefab

File: `com.freewebsite.core/Runtime/UI/UIScreen.cs`

`UIScreen` is a `MonoBehaviour` that hosts a `UIDocument` (via `UIDocumentView`) and implements `IUIScreen`:

- `Show()` → `gameObject.SetActive(true)`
- `Hide()` → `gameObject.SetActive(false)`
- `Name` → used for lookup/creation by name

A `UIScreen` is typically used as a **prefab**:

- prefab contains `UIScreen` + `UIDocument`
- `UIDocument` references a UXML asset (and optional panel settings, USS, etc.)

UIDocumentView and UIDocumentView<TViewData>

File: `com.freewebtime.core/Runtime/UI/UIDocumentView.cs`

`UIDocumentView` contains common helpers:

- Auto-finds `UIDocument` on `Start()` / `OnValidate()`
- Calls `InitUI()` on enable and `DisposeUI()` on disable
- Utility methods like `TryGetRootElement(out root)`

`UIDocumentView<TViewData>` implements the standard “bind view-data to the document” flow:

- Stores a private `_viewData`
- On `InitUI()` sets `rootVisualElement.dataSource = _viewData`
- Exposes `SetViewData(TViewData viewData)`

UIScreen<TViewData>

File: `com.freewebtime.core/Runtime/UI/UIScreen.cs`

`UIScreen<TViewData>` is the common base for “screen + view-data” prefabs:

- It has a serialized `_viewData` field (so you can assign a default instance in prefab/scene)
- It sets `rootVisualElement.dataSource = _viewData` in `InitUI()`
- It exposes `SetViewData(viewData)` to update the binding target at runtime

Screen API: IUISystemAPI

File: `com.freewebtime.core/Runtime/UI/IUISystemAPI.cs`

The framework standardizes screen operations behind:

- `CreateScreen<TScreen>()`
- `GetOrCreateScreen<TScreen>()`
- `GetScreen<TScreen>()`
- `DestroyScreen<TScreen>()` / `DestroyScreen(UIScreen screen)`

UIManager: MonoBehaviour screen manager

File: `com.freewebtime.core/Runtime/UI/UIManager.cs`

`UIManager` is a `MonoBehaviour` implementation of `IUISystemAPI` that:

- Stores screen **prefabs**:
 - `ScreenPrefabs`
 - `ScreenPrefabByName`

- `ScreenPrefabByType`
- Stores created/registered **instances**:
 - `AllScreens`
 - `ScreensByName`
 - `ScreensByType`
- Instantiates screens under a `UIRoot` transform (`UIScreenRoot`)
- Optionally collects screens already present in the scene:
 - `IsCollectUIScreensFromSceneOnStart`
 - `CollectUIScreensFromScene()`
- Provides `IsCursorOverUI()` (EventSystem-based)

In practice:

1. Put `UIManager` in your scene (bootstrap).
2. Provide it a list of screen prefabs (via `ApplyConfig(...)` or by calling `AddScreenPrefab(...)`).
3. Request screens with `GetOrCreateScreen<TScreen>()` .

UISystemBase: ECS screen manager

File: `com.freewebtime.core.ecs/Runtime/UI/UISystemBase.cs`

If you run UI creation from an `Entities SystemBase` , use `UISystemBase` (also implements `IUISystemAPI`).

It mirrors `UIManager` 's logic (prefabs + instances + dictionaries), but is designed to live in the ECS world.

Convenience via IHexTerrainAPI

File: `com.freewebtime.hexterrains/Runtime/IHexTerrainAPI.cs` and `HexTerrainAPI.cs`

`HexTerrainAPI` exposes UI helpers that forward to its `IUISystemAPI` :

- `CreateUIScreen<TScreen>()`
- `GetOrCreateUIScreen<TScreen>()`
- `GetUIScreen<TScreen>()`
- `DestroyUIScreen<TScreen>()` / `DestroyUIScreen(UIScreen screen)`

This is what tools/states typically use to show tool-related screens.

Data sources and change tracking (UIDataSource)

UIDataSource: base class for bindable view-models

File: `com.freewebtime.uitoolkit/Runtime/DataSources/UIDataSource.cs`

`UIDataSource` is the standard base for view-data in the framework:

- Holds a monotonically increasing `Version`
- Implements `CommitChanges()` → increments `Version`
- Implements view-hash via `GetViewHashCode()` returning `Version`

Conceptually:

- **Every meaningful change** to UI-facing data should call `CommitChanges()` .
- The binding system can use the view-hash/version to decide when to re-read values.

Recommended pattern for properties:

- Mark bindable properties with `[CreateProperty]`
- In the setter, call `CommitChanges()` when the value changes

```
// Typical pattern (used throughout the framework)
[CreateProperty]
public int BrushSize
{
    get => _brushSize;
    set
    {
        if (_brushSize == value) return;
        _brushSize = value; CommitChanges();
    }
}
```

[CreateProperty] and what it means

Many data-source properties in this framework use `Unity.Properties` :

- `[CreateProperty]` marks a property as discoverable by Unity's property/binding infrastructure.
- In practice: **if you want to bind to it, make it a property and mark it.**

Tip: Avoid binding directly to public fields. Prefer properties with `[CreateProperty]` .

Data binding: binding paths + dataSource

Binding model in one diagram

```
graph TD;
    A["UIScreen / UIDocumentView"] --> B["UIDocument.rootVisualElement"];
    B --> C["rootVisualElement.dataSource = viewData"];
    C --> D["UXML elements with binding paths"];
    D --> E["UI Toolkit reads properties via paths"];
    F["UIDataSource.CommitChanges()"] --> G["Version++ / view hash changes"];
    G --> E;
```

Two binding styles you'll see

1 UXML declarative bindings (recommended for simple cases)

In UI Toolkit you typically bind element properties using binding paths set in UXML (exact attribute names vary by element/property).

General idea:

- Set the screen root `dataSource` to some view-data object.
- Bind UI fields to `PropertyName` on that object.

Example (conceptual):

```
<ui:Label binding-path="Title" />
<ui:SliderInt binding-path="BrushSize" />
```

2 Code-driven bindings (used by custom controls)

Some framework elements set up bindings in C# when attached to panel.

Example: `UIButton` binds its own `OnClick` property using `SetBinding(...)` and a data-source path.

Fwt.UIToolkit controls

UIButton: bindable click target

File: `com.freewebtime.uitoolkit/Runtime/UIButton.cs`

`UIButton` is a UI Toolkit `Button` with an additional bindable property:

- `OnClick` (type `object`) — can receive:
 - `Action`
 - `UnityEvent`
 - `UIButtonDataSource` (see below)
- `OnClickPath` (`string`, UXML attribute `onClick`) — property path used to bind `OnClick` at runtime

How it works:

- On `AttachToPanelEvent`, if `OnClickPath` is not empty:
 - `UIButton` calls `SetBinding(...)` to bind its `OnClick` property from `dataSourcePath = OnClickPath`
- On click / navigation submit:
 - It calls `ProcessOnClick()` and invokes whatever was bound into `OnClick`

This enables an MVVM-like flow where the view binds to a view-model “command” without requiring hard-coded callbacks.

UXML usage

Conceptual UXML (namespace setup depends on your project’s UXML settings):

```
<fw:UIButton name="ApplyButton" onClick="Apply" text="Apply" />
```

And your view-data object would expose `Apply` as one of:

- an `Action`
- a `UnityEvent`
- a `UIButtonDataSource` (with `OnClick`)

UIButton binding gotcha

`OnClickPath` defaults to `"OnClick"`. If your data source uses a different property name, set `onClick="YourPropertyName"`.

Built-in data sources

UIButtonDataSource

File: `com.freewebtime.uitoolkit/Runtime/DataSources/UIButtonDataSource.cs`

`UIButtonDataSource : UIDataSource` is a reusable model for "button-like" UI:

- `Text (string)` — calls `CommitChanges()` on set
- `OnClick (Action)` — calls `CommitChanges()` on set
- `IconTexture (Texture2D)` — calls `CommitChanges()` on change
- `IconSprite (Sprite)` — calls `CommitChanges()` on change

`UIButton.ProcessOnClick()` explicitly supports this type:

- if `OnClick` is a `UIButtonDataSource`, it invokes `buttonDataSource.OnClick`

So you can either:

- bind `UIButton.OnClick` to an `Action` property, **or**
- bind it to a `UIButtonDataSource` and keep button data grouped.

ValueEditorDataSource and ValueEditorDataSource<TValue>

File: `com.freewebtime.uitoolkit/Runtime/ValueEditors/DataSources/ValueEditorDataSource.cs`

This is the base abstraction for "editable setting/value" UI models.

Key members:

- `Name` (display name / label)
- `IsVisible` → exposed as `[CreateProperty] DisplayStyle (Flex/None)`
- `IsClampValue + ClampValue(...)` helper
- `ValueChanged` event hook (invoked from `CommitChanges()`)

`ValueEditorDataSource<TValue>` adds the actual value:

- `[CreateProperty] TValue Value` with change detection and `CommitChanges()`

- `ValueType` returns `typeof(TValue)`

This makes it possible to build generic “value editor” UIs where:

- the UI displays a list of `ValueEditorDataSource`
- the concrete editor type is chosen by `ValueType` (`int/float/bool/enum/etc.`)
- visibility is driven by `DisplayStyle`

Note: The framework’s UI layer typically consumes these via tool settings screens (see below).

Tool settings UI in Hex Terrains

Hex Terrains tools commonly display a settings screen while active (see `UserTools` documentation for the tool lifecycle).

`ToolSettingsScreen` and `ToolSettingsScreen<TSettings>`

File: `com.freewebtime.hexterrains/Runtime/UserTools/UI/ToolSettingsScreen.cs`

This is a specialization of `UIScreen` meant for tool settings.

`ToolSettingsScreen<TSettings>` :

- Implements `IViewDataReceiver<TSettings>`
- Sets `rootVisualElement.dataSource = viewData` on init / set

`UniversalToolSettingsScreen`

File: `com.freewebtime.hexterrains/Runtime/UserTools/UI/UniversalToolSettingsScreen.cs`

A convenience concrete type:

- `UniversalToolSettingsScreen` : `ToolSettingsScreen<UserToolSettingsDataSource>`

This is the “default” settings screen many tools use.

`UserToolSettingsDataSource`

File: `com.freewebtime.hexterrains/Runtime/UserTools/DataSources/UserToolSettingsDataSource.cs`

This is the standard view-data for tool settings UI:

- `Description` + `ErrorMessage` are `[CreateProperty]`
- Also exposes `[CreateProperty]` `DescriptionDisplayStyle` / `ErrorMessageDisplayStyle`
 - automatically hides UI blocks if strings are empty
- `Values` : `List<ValueEditorDataSource>`
 - collection of setting entries shown by the UI (typically via a `ListView`)

Common usage pattern:

1. A tool creates/owns a `UserToolSettingsDataSource` .

2. The tool fills `Values` with `ValueEditorDataSource<T>` entries.
 3. The tool shows `UniversalToolSettingsScreen` and calls `SetViewData(dataSource)`.
-

Putting it together (typical runtime flow)

1 Configure a UI system

Pick one:

- `UIManager` (`MonoBehaviour`)
- `UISystemBase` (`Entities SystemBase`)

Register screen prefabs using `ApplyConfig(...)` or `AddScreenPrefab(...)`.

2 Create or get a screen

Via `IUISystemAPI`:

- `var screen = uiSystemApi.GetOrCreateScreen<MyScreen>();`

Or via `IHexTerrainAPI`:

- `var screen = terrainApi.GetOrCreateUIScreen<UniversalToolSettingsScreen>();`

3 Provide view-data

- Use `UIScreen<TViewData>` / `ToolSettingsScreen<TSettings>` patterns where possible.
- Call `SetViewData(...)` with a view-data instance (often a `UIDataSource`).

4 Bind in UXML and/or via custom elements

- In UXML: bind label/text/values by binding paths.
- For command-like actions: use `Fwt.UIToolkit.UIButton` with `onClick="SomeProperty"`.

5 When data changes, call `CommitChanges()`

- Data sources derived from `UIDataSource` should call `CommitChanges()` in setters.
 - This increments `Version` so the UI binding system can refresh.
-

Practical guidelines / gotchas

- **Keep the view-data instance stable** while the screen is shown.
 - Prefer mutating properties + `CommitChanges()` rather than replacing the whole data source repeatedly.
- **Use** `[CreateProperty]` on anything you want to bind to.
- **Always call** `CommitChanges()` when a bound value changes (or `MarkDirty()` if you intentionally only signal "something changed").
- **Binding paths must match property names** exactly (case-sensitive in most binding contexts).

- **Prefer** `UIScreen<TViewData>` (or `ToolSettingsScreen<TSettings>`) for consistent “assign `dataSource`” behavior.
 - When using `UIButton` :
 - Set `onClick` to the correct property path
 - Provide `Action / UnityEvent / UIButtonDataSource` at that path
-

Related docs

- [User Tools \(user-tools.html\)](#) (how tools show/hide settings screens during tool activation)